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THE POLITIC

YALE COLLEGE'S JOURNAL OF POLITICS

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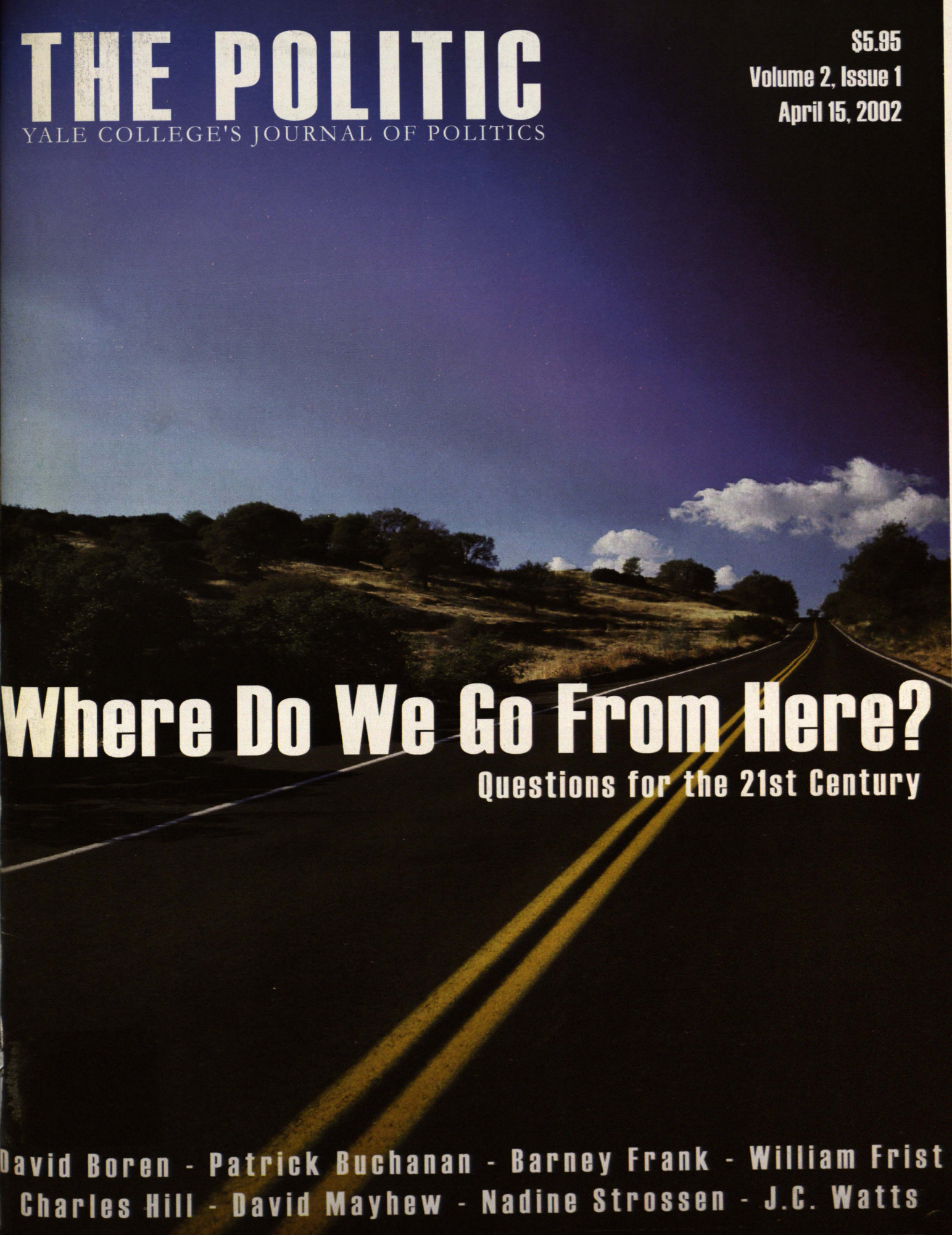


Where Do We Go From Here?

Questions for the 21st Century

David Boren - Patrick Buchanan - Barney Frank - William Frist
Charles Hill - David Mayhew - Nadine Strossen - J.C. Watts

THE POLITIC

Yale College's Journal of Politics

This publication was made possible in part by the Castle Publications Fund. John K. Castle endowed the Fund in memory of his ancestor, James Pierpont, one of Yale's original founders. It is intended to promote disciplined reflection on ethical issues facing individuals in our complex modern society.

This publication was also partly endowed by the Class of 1959 Fund which is administered by Calhoun College. This fund is reserved for Calhoun students for worthy extracurricular endeavors. Thank you to Master Sledge and the rest of the award committee.

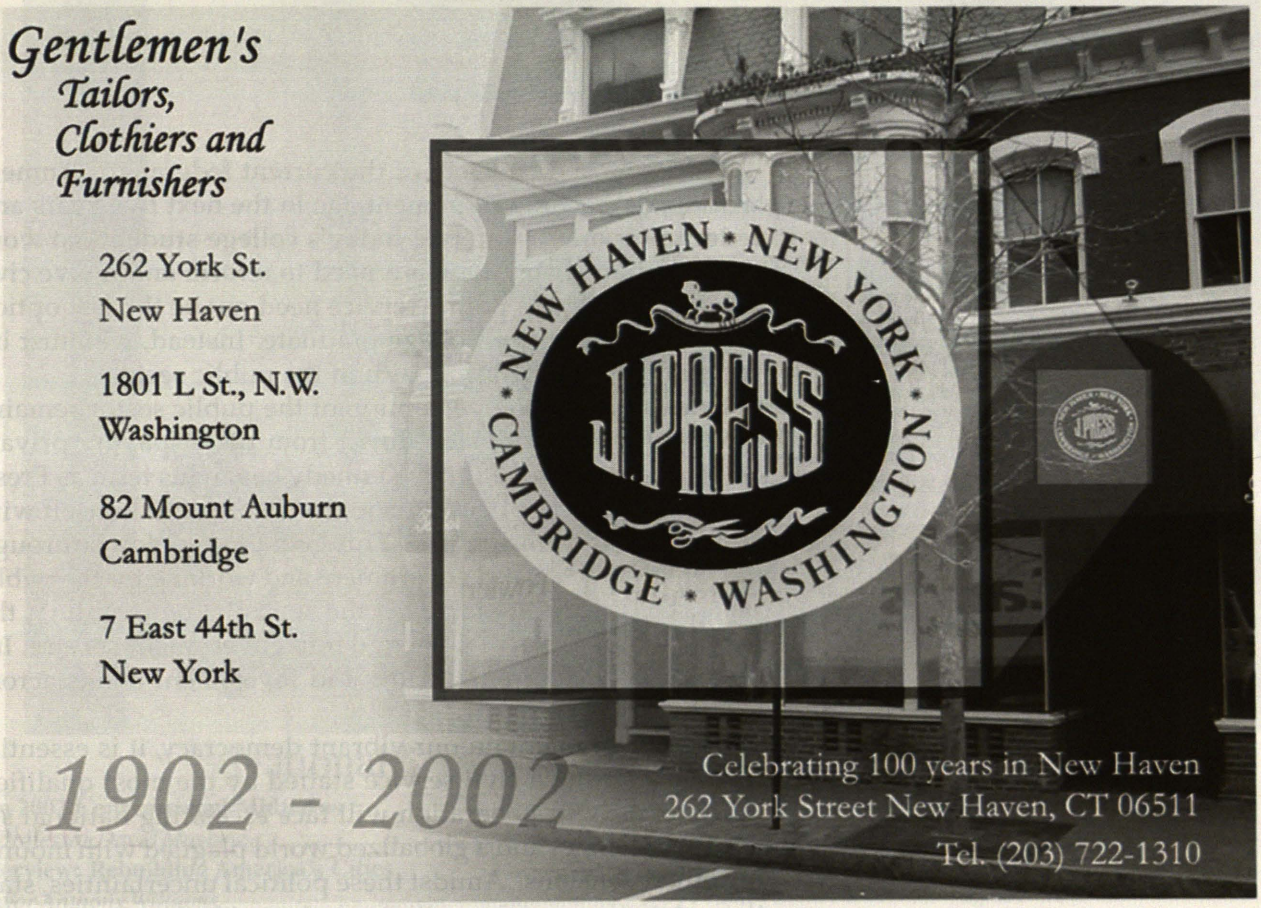
The Politic sincerely thanks the Yale Daily News for its generosity in letting *The Politic* staff use the Briton Hadden Memorial Building and its resources during the production of this issue.

We would also like to express our sincerest gratitude to our Board of Advisors and our distinguished contributers.

Furthermore, the staff of *The Politic* would like to honor the memory of Nobel-Prize winning economist James Tobin, who passed away March 11. A contributor to the first issue of *The Politic*, one of the most respected economists of his time, and an invaluable asset to the entire Yale community, Dr. Tobin left behind an indelible mark.

We would like to dedicate this issue of *The Politic* to the memory of Paul G. Wallach.

For information regarding subscriptions, advertisements, or contributions, please visit our website at www.thepolitic.org, write us at PO Box 201452, New Haven, CT 06520, or email us at thepolitic1@hotmail.com. We welcome letters to the editor and any other feedback you may have. In addition, the cover photo is courtesy of PICTOR and the back inside cover photo is courtesy of Stephen Jaffe.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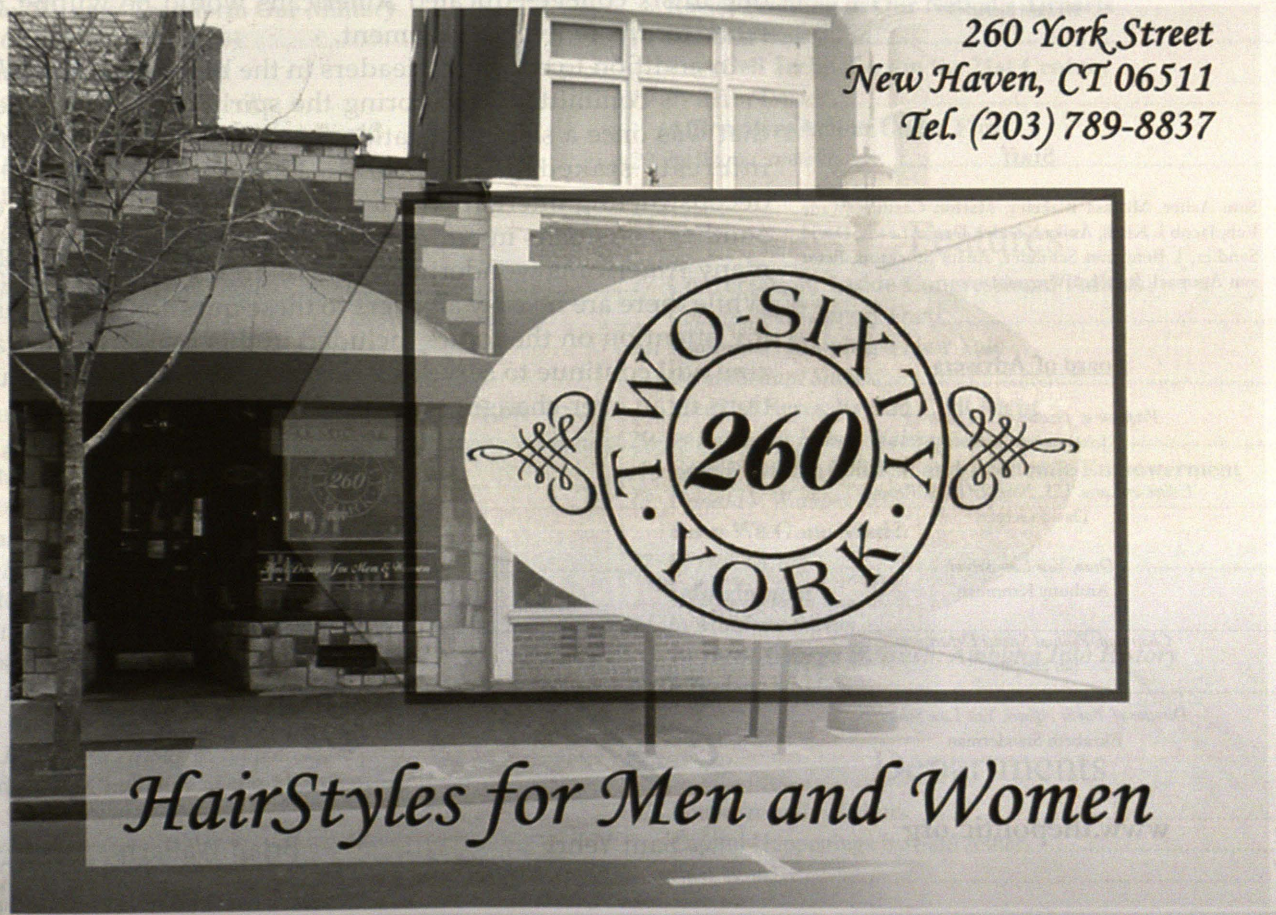
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Dear reader,

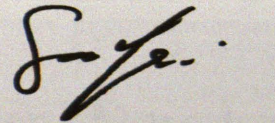
With almost 50 percent of the current federal government workforce reaching retirement age in the next five years and a declining interest among today's college students to work in the public sector, there is a need to reform and revive civil service. A career in public service need not be the last option for a Phi Beta Kappa college graduate. Instead, we must inspire in a new generation faith in the public sector.

Unfortunately, the perception of the public sector remains a bureaucratic, inept step down from better paying private corporations. When John F. Kennedy began his term as President of the Unites States, he sought to surround himself with "the best and the brightest." This goal filtered down through the ranks of the federal government and working for the public sector became fashionable. At the start of a new century, the best and the brightest do not go into government service. Instead, they work in law firms and investment banks across the country.

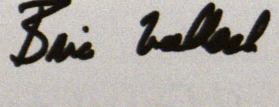
In order to maintain our vibrant democracy, it is essential to have a strong a civil service staffed by the most qualified individuals. Our generation will face escalating national security challenges and a globalized world plagued with mounting ethnic tensions. Amidst these political uncertainties, startling statistics remain: polling conducted by the Partnership for Public Service after September 11 still showed that only one in six college-educated Americans would be willing to work for the federal government.

In addition to educating leaders in the broadest sense, *The Politic* is committed to restoring the spirit of public service that was once a source of national pride. With government interests staked in the Middle East, Afghanistan and deconstructing international terrorism, we have come to yet another crossroads in our political development that has left many Americans wondering, "Where do we go from here?" While there are no easy answers to these questions, by focusing attention on the topics included in this issue, our magazine will continue to serve as a medium for debate and solutions in an ever-changing world.

Sincerely,



Sam Yebri



Brian Wallach

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CAPITOL HAPPENINGS

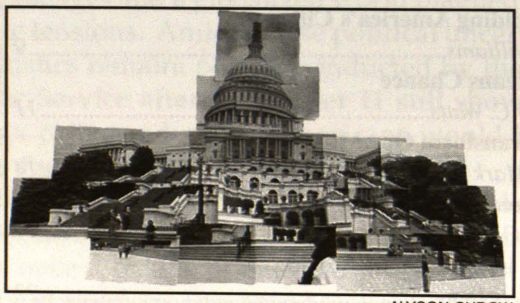
A PLAIN-ENGLISH ACCOUNT OF THE 107TH CONGRESS

By Sam Asher

From the outset, before 9/11 and the Enron implosion, the 107th Congress was looking to be an unusual one. The Senate was perfectly divided, though Republican control was ensured by the Vice President's tie–breaking vote. The GOP also controlled the House, although the split was close as well. With a Republican White House to back the GOP's majority in both houses, the "compassionate conservative" agenda of Bush's campaign seemed likely to become law, with a Democratic filibuster in the Senate being the only possible roadblock. The actual events could not have been more differently.

Looking back from our current vantage point, the one–and–one–half sessions of Congress since then seem more like four distinct bodies. The first session was characterized by the initial Republican monopoly in Washington. Despite the slim majority in both the House and the Senate, the Republicans were able to push through the new President's first legislative priority: the tax cut. Senate rules allow for a circumvention of a minority filibuster on bills relating to the budget, effectively cutting the Democrats out of the debate and passing the little–changed White House tax cut back to the President to be signed on June 7, 2001.

The "Jeffords jump" demonstrated the real precariousness of this balance of power. Dissatisfied with the Republican Party's failure to accommodate its moderates, Senator James Jeffords of Vermont decided on May 24, 2001 to defect from the GOP, instead caucusing with the Democrats and giving them a majority in the Senate. While this did not disrupt passage of the tax cut (as explained by the peculiar Senate budget rules), this shift of control abruptly empowered the Democrats in debate and threw a wrench into the machinery of the seemingly inevitable Bush agenda. All of a sudden, drilling in the Arctic National Wildlife Refuge did not seem so probable and school vouchers became less of an impending reality.



ALYSON SUDOW

Nor was productive lawmaking a reality. The Senate was too caught up in the transition of power to worry about legislating. Partisan bickering peaked during this second phase of Congress. It was only eradicated by the overwhelming terror of September 11, which ushered in a new, if brief, period of bipartisan cooperation. During the month after the terrorist attacks, the President was rarely seen without the company of leadership from both parties and both houses of Congress: Daschle, Lott, Hastert and Gephardt, to name a few. As one would expect in response to a crisis, a number of bills were passed with overwhelming support from both sides of the aisle. Airline security and anti–terrorism legislation led this spate of legislating. As anticipated, however, this solidarity proved artificial and waned as the nation, both inside and outside the beltway, regained its composure.

Although we are back to the usual partisan bickering, significant legislation has managed to gain passage through Congress, especially more recently. With little grace but much compromise, the Senate and the House passed identical economic stimulus bills in early March, forgoing the need for conference and fast–tracking it to the President's desk. Perhaps even more momentous was campaign finance reform, a typically Democratic issue that made it through the legislature only at the insistence of renegade Republican Senator John McCain.

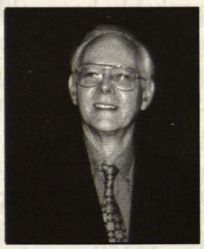
But don't get too excited about these few issues that actually made their way through the obstacle course that is Congress. Many other issues are frozen in various stages along their ways, looking less and less likely to come up for a vote before the elections of this fall. Bankruptcy reform is stuck in conference with no apparent escape. And much like in the Clinton–era, judicial nominations are promising to be slow in an opposition–controlled Senate, if the recent rejection of Charles Pickering by the Senate Judiciary Committee is any indication. What about Enron? Beyond the effect that the fiasco probably had on the passage of campaign finance reform legislation, Enron's impact on Capitol Hill is looking less significant every day. The parties are in such total disagreement over everything from pension plans to accounting regulations that reform is looking less and less likely. At this point, many in Congress are simply looking ahead to the mid-term elections later this year, when both parties will desperately attempt to gain full control of the split legislature. Until then, don't expect much more than partisan rhetoric to come out of Capitol Hill.

Sam Asher is a sophomore in Jonathan Edwards College at Yale University.

WHAT WILL HAPPEN IN THE 2002 CONGRESSIONAL MIDTERMS?

NOVEMBER FORECAST

By David Mayhew



Let me take three cuts at this question, starting with the very general and ending with the particular. For the very general cut, what if our minds were an absolute blank about everything that has happened since January 2001? Suppose we do not posses any knowledge at all.

What would we expect to happen in the 2002 congressional midterm elections? We would probably draw on historical experience, and here is what we would find.

First of all, in the elections for the House of Representatives we would expect modest seat gains for the Democrats, probably in the low double digits. That would be enough to propel them to House majority status and Dick Gephardt to the Speakership, since they are now only 11 seats down suffering a deficit of 223–212. (This plausibly counts the two current House independents as one for each party.) Our expectation would be based, of course, on one of the oldest valid observations about American politics—that the party in control of the presidency loses House seats in a midterm. That generalization has been violated only in 1934 and 1998, the recent impeachment–centered election. The 1998 result has not invalidated the generalization.

More specifically, our prediction for 2002 would be for "modest" rather than "sweeping" outparty House gains since one cause of midterm loss is a withdrawal of the winning presidential candidate's coattails from two years earlier. Bush, in November 2002, did not offer much in the way of party coattails, so that helps, in a sense, incumbent House Republicans this year. But there is another rather mysterious component of midterm loss, which is denominated in the political science trade "midterm penalty." That is the propensity of the electorate to whack the presidential party in a midterm regardless of everything else, including regardless of presidential coattail length two years earlier. "Midterm penalty," which might be expected to apply in 2002 as in any other midterm year, apparently derives from a combination of the electorate's chronic wish to "balance" against the incumbent presidential party and a tendency for the "anti's" to turn out in greater force than the "pro's" in a midterm. The net result this year: modest seat gains for the Democrats.

How about the Senate? There, knowing nothing about post–January 2001 events, we would predict a wash this year. That is because two, not one, recent elections figure in thinking about the Senate realm. One is 1996, when the current crop of senators now up for re–election won their seats last time and benefited, on balance, from Clinton's coattails. Clinton in 1996, with an eight percent lead over Dole, unlike Bush in 2000 probably did have coattail value for Democratic Senate candidates. That is bad news for the Democrats this year. It means that Democratic–held Senate seats will suffer from coattail withdrawal. On the other hand, the 2000 election is also relevant. The fact that the Republicans hold the White House right now is good news for Democratic Senate candidates this year just as for Democratic House candidates. "Midterm penalty," the whack–the–White–House–party–in–the–midterm propensity comes into play on the Senate side as well as on the House side. (This is despite the likelihood that Bush in 2000 lacked coattails. As argued earlier, a modest whack ordinarily occurs anyway because of the electorate's event–invariant "midterm penalty" propensity.) Thus, the withdrawal of Democratic coattails from 1996 cancels out the anti–Republican midterm whack propensity, and we have a wash on the Senate side in November 2002. All this works out in statistical data for the last half century.

But, you might say, we knew in January 2001 that the Republicans would have 20 Senate seats up this year and the Democrats only 14. Doesn't that old information augur well for the Democrats? Well, no. As it happens, only three of the GOP seats at stake are in states carried by Gore (narrowly in all three cases), yet six of the Democratic seats at stake are in states carried by Bush (rather narrowly in five cases). That gives some sense of the relevant states' basic leanings. There is not much information here to move the overall Senate prediction out of

A trans–Atlantic era of center–left governments that included Clinton's in this country may be drawing to a close, although Tony Blair is going strong in his new international role. A poor showing for the Democrats this November would fortify any such trend.

the "wash" category.

Now for the second cut. As of spring 2002, what does the current state of American public opinion suggest about the upcoming November elections? On this front, the news is quite bad for the Democrats. A recent survey gave the Republicans the best edge I have ever seen in party identification. Another survey gave the best results for the Republicans I have ever seen—better than in 1994—on the question of which party do you believe should control Congress. These readings reflect the events of September 2001 and since. Also, it is worth watching electoral politics in Europe. Over there, the left has suffered a notable series of setbacks since September 2001 in Denmark, the city of Hamburg, Portugal and the Netherlands, and more may follow. War, crime and immigration have surged as voter concerns, and that is not favorable issue territory for the left. A trans–Atlantic era of center–left governments that included Clinton's in this country may be drawing to a close, although Tony Blair is going strong in his new international role. A poor showing for the Democrats this November would fortify any such trend.

For a final cut, there are considerations having to do with particular states and districts. On the Senate side, no Democratic incumbents are retiring whereas four Republicans are, all southerners: Phil Gramm in Texas, Jesse Helms in North Carolina, Strom Thurmond in South Carolina and Fred Thompson in Tennessee. That poses risks for the Republicans in all four states, even South Carolina. On the other hand, the Republicans have probably done better this year at nonincumbent candidate recruitment—John Thune against Senator Tim Johnson in South Dakota, Greg Ganske against Senator Tom Harkin in Iowa, Norm Coleman against Senator Paul Wellstone in Minnesota, James Talent against Senator Jean Carnahan in Missouri, Lindsey Graham of impeachment renown for the open seat in South Carolina, Elizabeth Dole (on current evidence) for the open seat in North Carolina, John Cornyn for the open seat in Texas, possibly Lamar Alexander (but will he do better this time?) for the open seat in Tennessee and even John Sununu as a possible replacement through a primary contest for the faltering Republican incumbent Senator Bob Smith in New Hampshire. The counterpart grade–A Democratic list seems to be shorter—Mark Pryor against Senator Tim Hutchinson in Arkansas, Tom Strickland against Senator Wayne Allard in Colorado, Bob Clement for the open seat in Tennessee and Jeanne Shaheen in the murky situation in New Hampshire. The Democratic nomination in Texas is a question mark. In general, this factual structure seems to favor the Republicans if anybody. Only one Republican seat gain is needed for a Senate takeover, and all eyes are on South Dakota for possibly the most expensive per capita Senate race ever.

On the House side, the Republicans had been favored to profit from the post–2000 Census reapportionment and redistricting. In general, they probably have, although not by much. Seats transported from the northeast to the southwest have inherited Hispanic–American voters. Inventive Republican maps in Michigan, Pennsylvania and Florida have been partly countered by inventive Democratic maps in Georgia and Maryland. Open seat statistics favor the Democrats: There are 28 House retirements (a surprisingly low figure for a post–census election year), of which 18 are by Republicans and only 10 by Democrats. It is hard to see an edge or a trend in all this. Only a few dozen districts out of the 435 are being seriously contested at all. The current prospect is for resource–intensive trench warfare in a few selected trenches with little final net gain for either side. That was the now familiar picture in 1996, 1998 and 2000. Since 1994, the Democrats, despite great ambition and mobilization, have not been able to take back the House, and the equally driven Republicans have not been able to improve their holdings there.

With a Republican White House, the 2002 midterm would seem to offer a favorable environment for the Democrats to stay even in the Senate and claw back to a majority in the House. On the evidence of spring 2002, that will be difficult. The Democrats are not getting issue traction and they are not being aided by the not–so–sour economy. The polls are against them. Yet, note that in real political life seven or eight months is a long time. In August 2001, who would have forecast the disasters of last fall or the current political climate?

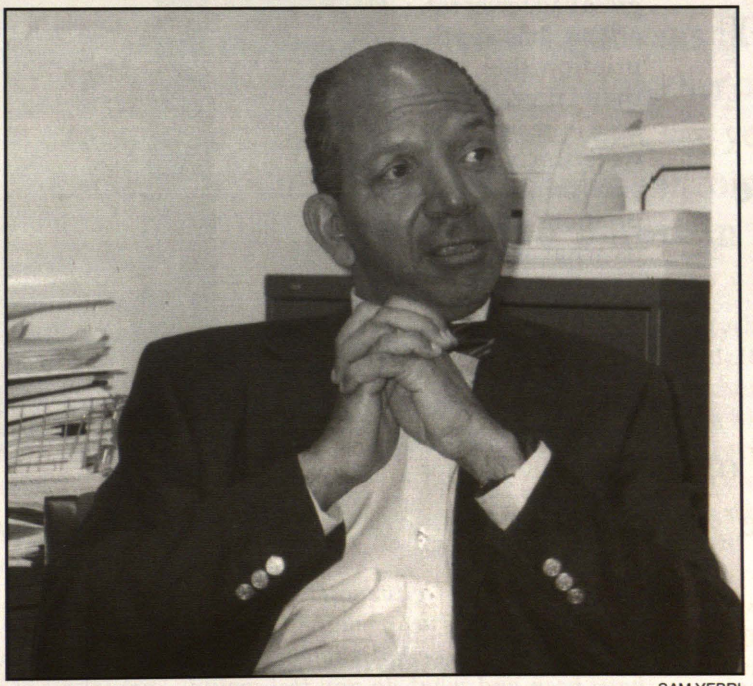
David Mayhew is a Sterling Professor of Political Science at Yale University. He has written numerous articles and books on American politics, including Divided We Govern *and* America's Congress.

ANTHONY WILLIAMS

REBUILDING AMERICA'S CITIES

AN INTERVIEW

Anthony A. Williams began serving as Mayor of the District of Columbia on January 4, 1999. He graduated magna cum laude with a Bachelor of Arts in Political Science from Yale College in 1979, and subsequently earned a juris doctorate from Harvard Law and a master's degree in Public Policy from the Kennedy School of Government. On March 4, 2002, Mayor Williams sat down with **The Politic.**



SAM YEBRI

The Politic: As the Mayor of a large city whose image has been tarnished by years of mismanagement, crime and at times questionable leadership, how do you go about revitalizing this image?

Anthony Williams: Well I think the best way to revise it and the only lasting way to revise it is by restoration of basic services. That's really what people expect in a city and that's what people expect from a Mayor. It's your government operations, it's your public safety, it's your focus on basic education and on economic development.

How do you go about strengthening the city's downtown without displacing large portions of its poor and minority populations?

Well that's why I use the train analogy because the downtown gives the city energy and if the investment downtown is channeled and harnessed, you can use that for the betterment of folks in the neighborhood. In terms of creating jobs in your downtown and in your neighborhood; investment in commercial revitalization in your neighborhood; investment in housing; and by the right kind of funding. That's why I talk about the New museum as an example in which a major investor comes to the city and you tap part of that investment to go to community benefit.

Can you, as a Democratic Mayor in an overwhelmingly Democratic city, get "tough on crime" and enact sweeping changes enhancing your city's image similar to those of former New York Mayor Rudy Giuliani?

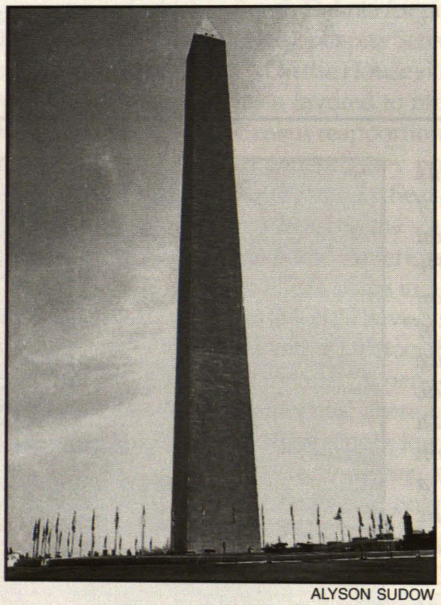
Yes, because we have had a dramatic drop in crime in the city. This is what I mean by the basics changing the image of the city. The District was rated one of the best places to do business in *Forbes*, recognized as a leader in *Fortune* and *Black Enterprise*, and a technology leader in *Newsweek*. That's the kind of progress that the city has made over the years. We went from a city with no website to a city now rated by *Governing Magazine* as the fourth best website in the country. A city that was the murder capital of the world to the only city, or certainly one of the only cities in the United States, that had no increase in crime. We were running 10 percent below this time last year, and last year started exceptionally well and actually got worse at the end of the year because of September 11.

It all comes back to taking care of the basics, focusing on the basics, to change that image. We have achieved a 40 percent reduction in serious crimes over the last three years. Also, this whole notion of if a Republican or Democrat was elected Mayor is meaningless in my mind. There is not a Democrat or Republican way to be a Mayor.

We went from a city with no website to a city now rated by Governing Magazine **as the fourth best website in the country. A city that was the murder capital of the world to the only city, or certainly one of the only cities in the United States, that had no increase in crime.**

With these advancements that you talk about and with the decrease in crime and with the movement towards a unified District of Columbia, do you believe that the Federal Government will relinquish the control that they have appropriated over the years to make the District much more of an autonomous unit than it is right now?

I think more and more they will. The last budget that was passed by the Congress had fewer riders on that appropriation this year than there have been in years. There were thirty provisions on our appropriations that told us what we could do on everything from domestic partnerships to needle exchange that were taken out of the bill, and that is a sign of growing respect for the city that they were taken out of the bill.



ALYSON SUDOW

If you were to leave office at the conclusion of this year, what do you feel your greatest accomplishment would have been and what do you feel would be the greatest challenge left for your successor?

Well, my greatest accomplishment would have been restoring the economy of the city and the basic financial integrity of the city, and even a larger sense of basic sense for respect for the city. The biggest thing left undone was leaving a lasting legacy in terms of a plan for the city, one, and two, a lasting impact on education.

How do you propose to revitalize the areas of the District of Columbia, such as the public school system, that are so crucial to the development of future generations of future leaders?

It's a couple of things. I think you put in better school governance. I fought to get an appointed school board and now at least we have more control than we had in the past. I think you fight to get in a good superintendent; I think you fight to get in better teachers, we have worked with the White House to launch the teaching fellows program; fight for better principals, we are hiring some of the best principals around the country. In think you focus on 9, 10, 15 schools initially to transform them and then work your way out and we are doing that. So we are beginning to make headway and in another four or five years I think we will have a decent school system.

Is this a program that you think can be copied by most major cities regardless of the location or background of the city?

Well, some of the things we are doing other cities are trying to do as well. Get more control of the school structure, more incentives for teachers and principals, focus on transformation of an initial cohort of schools before you expand to system wide change. We have a very successful charter movement in the city, in fact it is one of the most successful in the country and so we are very excited about that.

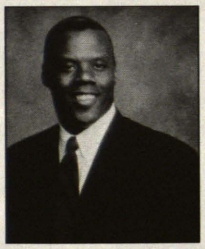
Do you believe that as the economic revitalization takes place and as the population returns that the District should become an actual state?

I'm not sure if it should be a state, but it should have representation in the Senate and the House. However, you can do that without being a state. You would have to change the Constitution anyway I think to fix what needs to be fixed so while you are doing that just say that you have fifty states and the District and that everybody has a vote. The residents of the District are paying taxes and so they should have representation.

A CHOICE THAT MEANS A CHANCE

AN ARGUMENT FOR SCHOOL VOUCHERS

By J.C. Watts



The Supreme Court heard arguments in February for and against school choice in a voucher case involving students in Cleveland. Over the last six years, children coming from families with a median income of $20,000 have had the opportunity to enroll in private and parochial schools because of a successful Ohio program that gives parents a maximum of $2,250 to spend annually on tuition. In a city where only about a third of public school students graduate from high school, this assistance has been welcome.

The decision to be made by the Court of whether to uphold or strike down the constitutionality of parental choice in education will shape the debate for other cities, states and the federal government. It will be a landmark decision, ultimately determining the future of many children.

In addition to bolstering public education and striving to "leave no child behind," Congress is now prepared to support the President and to promote choice in education, beginning with a measure to grant tuition tax credits. Under President Bush's plan, families of children who are locked in a failing public school would be able to enroll in a private or parochial school using a tax credit of up to $2,500 per year, giving them the keys to a more successful future.

Last year, Congress was not able to pass parental choice as part of the No Child Left Behind Act because of special interest pressure, but there are many of us who are hopeful that the Supreme Court will recognize the legitimacy of giving school choice to families and put a legal imprimatur on educational options.

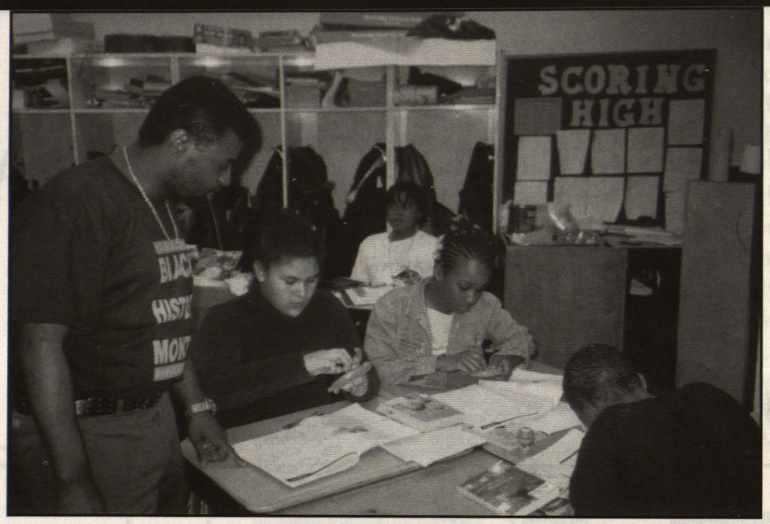
Allowing parents to decide what school best meets their children's needs would strengthen the educational outcome for countless students across the country. "It's basically a G.I. Bill for kids," says Clint Bolick, of the Institute for Justice. Through a truly grassroots and community-based effort, Bolick and others are hard at work defending school choice in Cleveland and other voucher-friendly localities.

The disconnect between higher education and primary and secondary education is quite puzzling to many supporters of school choice. As anyone who has applied for loans, grants or scholarships knows, a huge amount of government dollars flow into private and parochial colleges. Universities across the country, such as Yale, receive tax money in many ways, shapes and forms. Why then, are students in elementary, middle and high schools discriminated against on the issue of choice in education? These children equally deserve the right to attend the schools that fit their needs and offer them the best chance for a brighter future.

The black community would particularly benefit if more programs like Cleveland's were to become a reality. Half of all the participants in the Cleveland voucher system are Americans of African descent. And in most polls on the subject of school choice and expanded parental options in education, two out of three black Americans favor having school choice.

Will the Supreme Court see this issue in the same light as proponents in Cleveland? I have confidence that the Court will recognize the fact that allowing parents to send their children to the school of their choice does not violate the Establishment Clause in the First Amendment. After all, what church or religion does this establish? If someone can answer that question, I would be the first to change my position.

Federal education funding for public schools has doubled during the lifetime of most elementary



DAVID WHITE

Parents ought to have a choice and students ought to have a chance. A monopoly on the future of our children is the wrong recipe for a successful future.

school students. It received the largest increase in the President's budget last year. We can expand parental choice in education while we strengthen public schools. The two concepts are not mutually exclusive. Nobody is proposing to remove funds from public schools in order to pay for private schools. At the same time, there are students in chronically failing schools. The status quo is not working for children trapped on avenues of hopelessness.

Education reform often takes years to enact and even longer to implement. But there are students who need a brighter future now. The Supreme Court should not take away the hopes and dreams of so many youngsters who finally got a break in life. Parental choice in education ought to be expanded, not expelled.

The Supreme Court has a very weighty verdict to make this spring or summer. Some people are even characterizing the case as the Brown versus Board of Education of the new century. Nevertheless, the options the nine justices have before them are quite clear: to continue to allow taxpaying parents to use their tax dollars for the school of their choice, or to force parents to send their children to failing, even violent, schools that happen to be within their neighborhood boundaries.

Parents ought to have a choice and students ought to have a chance. A monopoly on the future of our children is the wrong recipe for a successful future.

America, in the 21st century, should be providing new solutions to old problems. Allowing parents to use their own tax dollars to send their children to schools they choose is a concept that will flourish this year.

J.C. Watts has represented Oklahoma's 4th Congressional District since 1994. He currently serves as Conference Chairmen for the House Republican Leadership and as a member of the Armed Services Committee.

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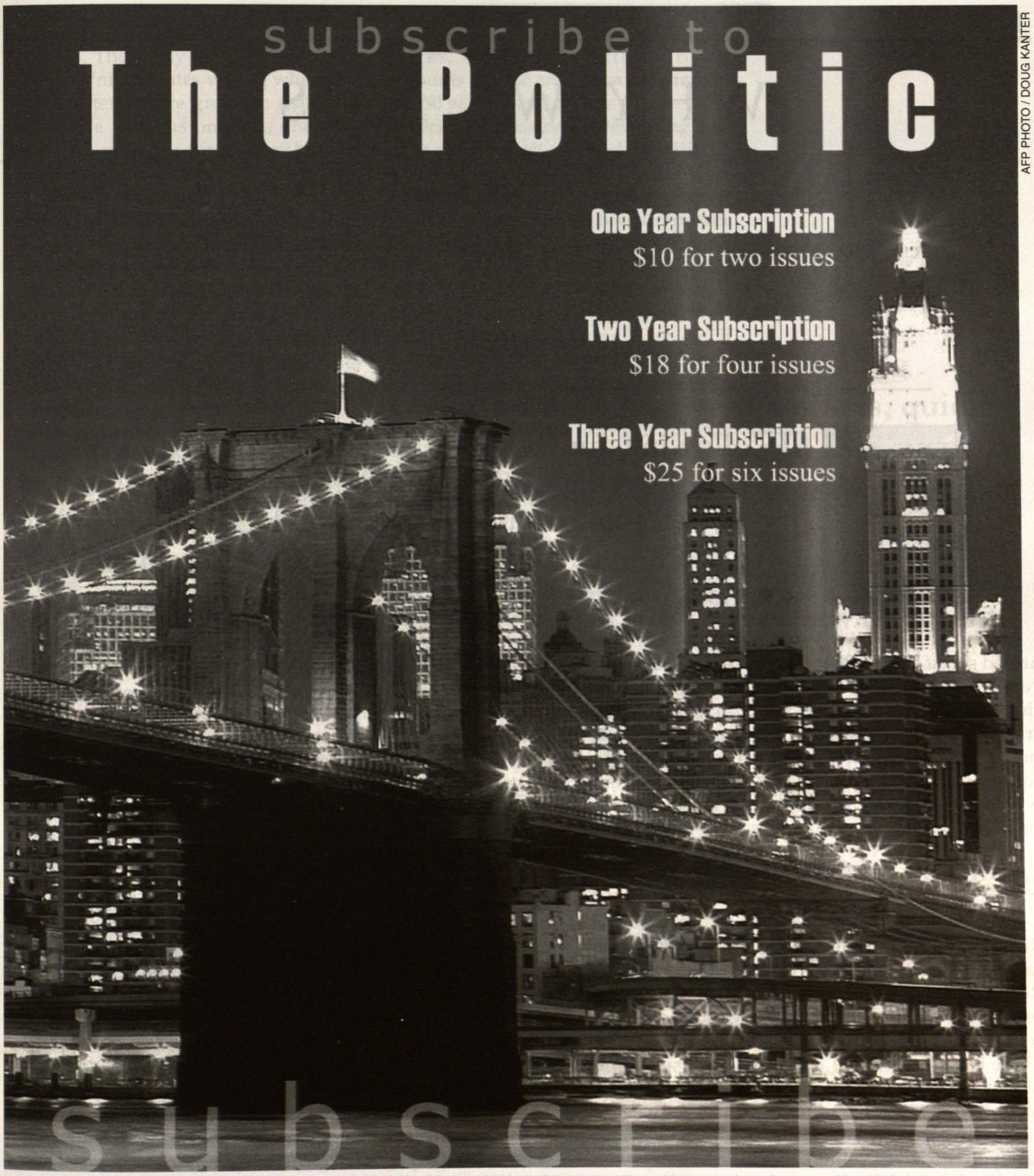

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WHY WE MUST TRANSFORM OUR MILITARY

AN ARMY FOR THE 21ST CENTURY

By Mark Kirk

Following our victory in Afghanistan, the idea of transforming our military might appear to be trying to fix something that is not broken. While we have won great victories in Iraq, Kosovo and Afghanistan, our future depends on modernizing our armed services for a new century. The threats of the new century will be very different than those mastered by the American military in the 20th century. Four key transformations must occur: geography, doctrine, technology and diplomacy. If we succeed with these transformations, we increase the likelihood that Americans will remain safe, secure and in charge of their own destiny in a society that guarantees individual freedom.

Geography

The day after the attack on Pearl Harbor, President Roosevelt made a surprise decision. Although the Japanese destroyed the bulk of our Pacific Fleet, Roosevelt made the defeat of Germany America's priority. Part of Roosevelt's decision was based on America's deep historical and cultural ties with Europe. There was also a more important reason. At the time, we were also far more reliant on trade with Europe than Asia. In 1938, total trade with Europe exceeded $1.7 billion (in constant 1990 dollars) while trade with Asia barely exceeded $1 billion.

After World War II, our foreign policy remained focused on Europe. We founded NATO and placed the alliance at the center of our Cold War struggle against the Soviet Union. Although divided, Germany rearmed and played the key role in the East-West confrontation. For 50 years, European affairs dominated America's strategic planning. During those years, our commitment was regularly reaffirmed by the large-scale REFORGER (Return Forces to Germany) NATO exercises, demonstrating our tangible capability to defend Europe from North America. One change went unnoticed.

In 1981, Asia replaced Europe as America's best trading partner. A fundamental assumption of President Roosevelt's 1941 focus on Europe had disappeared — Asia became more important to the United States' economy than Europe. By 1998, U.S. trade with Asia totaled over $700 billion annually while trade with Europe equaled less than $500 billion.

The last time the U.S. military faced an opponent backed by an economy larger than ours was in 1813 when Britain brought her global power against a new United States. That war led to the destruction of the U.S. capitol. Luckily, that was the last time the U.S. faced an opponent richer than us. That will change with the rise of Asia, especially China. Yet, despite this 20-year old continental shift in our economic and strategic interests, America's military planning remains focused on Europe, not Asia.

The current U.S. command structure for Europe holds a four to one advantage over Asia in flag officers. Nearly 85 percent of American officers in language training are learning European tongues. America's opportunities in this century will largely reside in Asia — so will its threats. However, military reform is very difficult to accomplish. Ironically, defeated armies are easier to reform than successful ones. Russia and Germany's defeated armies of World War I became juggernauts in World War II. Conversely, our military has recently won unprecedented victories in Iraq, Kosovo and Afghanistan. Therefore, the issue of reform will be difficult to present as a pressing need.

Nevertheless, future victories depend on reform. Winning will depend on the command of space, information warfare, missile defense and highly-trained profes-

sionals. The likely focus of any action by the United States will be where our trade interests are greatest: Asia. But, if we are to focus on Asia, one clear problem emerges: our military bases in this region are few and far between. Napoleon once complained "amateurs speak of tactics while professionals speak of logistics." Over the long term, the State Department must seek and develop relationships with Asian nations to improve U.S. access to the region. U.S. alliances in Asia are much less formal than those in Europe. They must be strengthened.

Setting our priority on Asia will require us to change from a military designed to fight and win armored combat in central Europe to one designed to fight over the vast distances of the Pacific. This is the key to future security in Asia.

Doctrine

A change in doctrine can be as important as any technological advance. When France and Germany clashed in 1940, both armies were evenly matched in equipment and personnel. It was the doctrine of blitzkrieg that gave the German army a tragic edge. For the U.S., our doctrine has turned from the focus on attrition that governed World War II and Vietnam operations to a more flexible concept called "land warrior." This flexibility led to the famous 1991 left-hook in the desert that outmaneuvered the Iraqis rather than grinding them up.

Over the medium term, we need to develop weapons and doctrines to carry out our will over very long distances in Asia and elsewhere. This challenge was clear in Afghanistan. Denied entry permission from every country that bordered Afghanistan, U.S. tactical aircraft were launched from 700 miles away aboard aircraft carriers in the Persian Gulf. For many, the size and scope of this task is difficult to understand. If one were to superimpose a map of Central Asia over a map of the eastern United States, our aircraft carriers would be stationed off the coast of Pensacola, Florida and our targets would be outside Milwaukee.

The lack of operating bases poses an even greater challenge to ground forces, which take extraordinary amounts of time and treasure to move. For 50 years, the U.S. Army trained for its primary mission of defending Europe close to well-established military bases and bridges. On the plains of Northern Europe, the primary weapon was the 20-ton tank. Their firepower and amour came at a cost: only some bridges could hold their weight while tank engines burned fuel at the rate of three miles to the gallon. In less developed countries far from bases, such weapons are ill suited for combat. During allied operations against Serbia, the U.S. Army attempted to deploy helicopter and armored forces in Albania along Kosovo's southern frontier. Engineers found that few of the former Albanian Communist government's bridges could hold the weight of NATO's main battle tanks. To reach the front, NATO would have to rebuild dozens of bridges wasting valuable time as winter drew near. In short, we were too heavy to move.

The Army also experienced extraordinary difficulty deploying Task Force Hawk, a small unit intended to support a force of 24 AH-64 Apache attack helicopters, to Albania. What was intended to be a small, rapid deployment of relatively light forces became a significant deployment of heavy forces including armor, artillery and engineering equipment. According to Army Chief of Staff General Eric Shinseki, "the early-arriving units literally had to build an installation in which to then deploy the helicopters." Ultimately, the deployment became a large scale Albanian public works project to upgrade roads and bridges to support heavy equipment needed to secure an area where the Army could build an airbase.

The pace of operations also requires change. Following Pearl Harbor, it took the United States 11 months to mount its first amphibious attack against Japan at Guadalcanal. Desert Storm took over 100 days to assemble the forces needed to mount an attack. In Afghanistan, our forces went into action 30 days after the World Trade Center fell—the blink of an eye in 20th century military terms. In coming conflicts, quick and decisive action will be essential to victory. In its review of re-

In coming conflicts, quick and decisive action will be essential to victory. In its review of recent conflicts, the Pentagon's "lessons learned" include a new focus on lethal, light and mobile forces designed for rapid deployment over great distances.

AFP / LUIS ACOSTA

U.S.–donated helicopters practice anti–narcotics maneuvers in Caqueta, Columbia

A new doctrine of light, mobile forces capable of sustained operations without support will be vital to winning over the vast distances of Asia and the developing world.

cent conflicts, the Pentagon's "lessons learned" include a new focus on lethal, light and mobile forces designed for rapid deployment over great distances.

A model for the Army could be the kind of organization already operating in the Marine Corps. A Marine Expeditionary Unit (MEU) is designed to deploy from the air or sea quickly, with enough supplies and ammunition for 30 days. This unit has its own armored vehicles, aircraft and logistics totaling about 2,000 personnel. Two MEUs became the backbone of U.S. ground forces in Afghanistan. Their key advantage was this: they deployed from ships on the high seas across 700 miles and two international borders before being injected directly into the conflict.

Army Chief of Staff, General Eric Shinseki, is currently working to transform the Army into a lighter fighting force capable of rapid deployments. Shinseki's goal is to deploy a 2,000-man brigade anywhere in the world in 96 hours, a 10,000-man division in 120 hours, and five divisions in 30 days. Unfortunately, this will be very difficult for the Army to do with their current heavy equipment. The task could be harder if currently designed weapons are purchased like the Crusader, a new self-propelled artillery piece. The Crusader is a very heavy, cumbersome vehicle-borne cannon that is difficult to transport, even in a country with a well-developed infrastructure. The overall weight of the Crusader tops 40 tons, not counting additional modules and resupply vehicles. Crusader components add another 74 tons. Because of the substantial size and weight of the Crusader, two huge C-5A Galaxy transport aircraft are needed to move just one Crusader. In the next conflict, we need military forces that are easier and faster to deploy over very long distances. The Crusader takes us in the other direction. A new doctrine of light, mobile forces capable of sustained operations without support will be vital to winning over the vast distances of Asia and the developing world.

Technology

One military revolution already in full bloom focuses on precision-guided munitions. Following World War II, the U.S. Strategic Bombing Survey measured the accuracy of the allied air campaign against Germany and Japan. In sum, they found that only 3 percent of the bombs dropped actually hit their targets. With rudimentary computers, bombs dropped in Vietnam hit at three times the World War II rate but still missed their targets 90 percent of the time. With the introduction of precision-guided munitions, the accuracy of U.S. airpower skyrocketed. Used sparingly in Operation Desert Storm, these munitions fueled the victories in Kosovo and comprised over 80 percent of the munitions used in Afghanistan.

The U.S. military has become the first to hit anything it could find. The problem came in finding appropriate targets. Over Kosovo, U.S. pilots acting as Forward Air Controllers flew 15,000 feet over the battlefield using binoculars to find targets. It rarely happened. Without eyes on the ground,

many aircraft returned home without finding a target.

A change in doctrine solved this problem. Following Vietnam, the United States became reluctant to deploy large ground forces in battles not central to our strategy. Under the "Reagan Doctrine," the U.S. reemerged as a world power by supporting indigenous forces to fight these battles. Outgunned and often lacking air cover, it was still tough going for local forces despite new American supplies. Under a new "Bush Doctrine" in Afghanistan, the United States served as the supply corps, intelligence office and air force for indigenous forces. The application of this new doctrine to Afghanistan was electric. Unlike the slow pace of target identification over Kosovo, local and U.S. Special Forces found hundreds of targets for U.S. aircraft that were quickly destroyed. American and indigenous forces were in Afghanistan's capital of Kabul well before winter, suffering very few casualties.

New technologies also allow the United States to advance this "Bush Doctrine" without risking a single American life. During the Afghan campaign, the U.S. deployed Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs). U.S. military actions in the future will rely more heavily on UAVs to perform vital intelligence, reconnaissance, and even combat missions.

The U.S. made military history when it deployed a classified program to rescue one of America's top supporters in Afghanistan. During an early phase of the campaign, Afghan leader Abdul Haq was surrounded by Taliban and called for help. The only aircraft over Afghanistan at the time was a classified, recently modified Predator unmanned aerial vehicle(UAV), armed with a Hellfire missile. The U.S. attempted to rescue Haq using this armed UAV. Although unsuccessful, this incident opened up a new phase of combat involving UAVs, with American uniformed personnel secure and far from the battle. Northrop Grumman and Boeing are both developing an that will be both stealth and capable of delivering precision guided munitions on targets without endangering the lives of American aircrews.

Another area of transformation is in the esoteric world of electronic warfare. Over the years, air defense systems like the U.S. Patriot or Soviet SA-10 have become quite capable of shooting down aircraft. Most allied air forces simply avoid a well-defended space. Only the U.S. military deploys aircraft capable of blinding such systems. The deployment of such aircraft is the most dangerous part of any air campaign because electronic warfare aircraft are the first to enter enemy airspace. If the mission goes well, all following allied aircrews will return home safely. The success of this strategy has meant that the U.S. public is becoming accustomed to "no casualty" wars. As allied air forces fall technologically behind the U.S., they become completely dependent on the U.S. advantage in this field.

As a reserve naval officer, who flew on missions of this type, I know how important this technology is to the safe return of allied aircrews. Using Rumsfeld's transformational technology of UAVs, the U.S. should deploy unmanned electronic warfare aircraft to eliminate the risks felt by current aircrews. The suppression and destruction of enemy air defenses is one of the first and most important missions to be executed in any successful air campaign. Accomplishing this mission without risk to human life from a great distance, dramatically increases the chances of success for the U.S. and allied militaries.

With all of these transformations of tactical systems, there is one strategic transformation that must happen: missile defense. For many years, only the Soviet Union could hit the U.S. with a nuclear-armed missile. Under the cynical logic of the Cold War, Americans and Soviets agreed to be defenseless under the 1972 Anti-Ballistic Missile treaty. That logic breaks down if many states gain the capability to strike the U.S. Long before Rumsfeld resumed his service as Secretary of Defense, he wrote an intelligence assessment, which reported over a dozen nations, including North Korea, Iran and Iraq, will build missiles capable of hitting the U.S. and our allies. This threat is already clear in Israel, which suffered 41 SCUD missile strikes launched from Iraq during the Gulf War. Israel has staked its security against future at-

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tacks on a joint program with the U.S. to develop the Arrow missile defense system.

Like Israel, the resolve of our allies depends on a defense against missile attack. However, planning for action against a country with weapons of mass destruction and missiles to deliver such weapons becomes impossible without missile defense.

Diplomacy

The United States fought two world wars without military alliances to support our efforts as the battle began. Using NATO, we won the Cold War without open hostilities against the Soviet Union. This lesson should not be lost on the next century and its Asian focus. If Asia is to be our most important region and if China is to be its most important country, then the U.S.-China relationship becomes the central axis of decision making, just as the link between Washington and Moscow governed the last 50 years. Our first priority must be laying the foundations for peace and cooperation with China short of war. History teaches that if China reforms to become an Asian democracy based on private sector growth, much of our military preparations will not be needed. As China's aging Communist leaders move from power, the peaceful transition of China to such a state would be the crowning achievement of U.S. foreign policy.

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The U.S. can repeat its success with NATO by formalizing relations with Asian democracies. Five countries are critical to this strategy of containing a possible Chinese threat: Japan, the Philippines, Indonesia, India and Russia. Japan serves as our traditional ally and is the host to the largest current U.S. military establishment in Asia. As a like-minded democracy off the coast of central Asia, it seems clear that Japan's interest in keeping one central Asian power from domination is similar to Britain's view of Napoleonic Europe. The Philippines share more painful, but profound, ties to the U.S. and would naturally work to prevent one Asian power. Indonesia has emerged as a troubled democracy with enormous potential as an oil-producing nation. It could serve as a weaker southern hinge to a U.S.–Asian security structure.

India offers the most potential to the U.S. As the world's largest democracy, India strongly resists the emergence of a Chinese-centered Asia. As her Russian arms partners fade in technological capability, the Indian military has pushed hard to develop a new relationship with the United States. Finally, Russia faces no threats from the West but multiple threats from her southern and eastern borders. Participation in a U.S. Asian security structure could be a way for the leaders of Russia's smallish economy sharing a huge border with China to pull real weight in the new century.

A formal organization of democracies cooperating on Asian security would be the best way for the U.S. to plan ahead. Success in this area could obviate the need for risky military action. If such action were still necessary, these nations would be essential partners in bringing a quick and successful end to a conflict.

Conclusion

When President Roosevelt chose to commit the bulk of American military assets to the war in Europe he acted to protect critical economic interests. In the 21st Century, however, these critical interests are now found half a world away in Asia. Our military must plan accordingly. The environment of Asia in the next century will also require the doctrinal, technological and diplomatic transformations that I outlined above to improve the odds for the United States. As we commit unprecedented resources to the military budget under President Bush, we must plan along these lines to ensure that resources are not wasted. The lessons of September 11 show that the U.S. must remain engaged in the world to protect our people. Backed by an accurate vision of how that world is changing, we will offer the best chance of making sure our children have the individual freedoms we now enjoy.

U.S. Rep. Mark Kirk (R-IL) serves on the House Armed Services Committee. Rep. Kirk is a Lieutenant Commander in the Naval Reserves. He served on active duty during conflicts in Iraq, Haiti, Bosnia and Kosovo.

THE QUEST FOR PRECISION

THE MILITARY'S CONTINUING EVOLUTION

By Larry D. Welch

The decade following the end of the Cold War has presented the United States with a series of fundamental changes in expectations and capabilities in military support of national security objectives. Three powerful concepts both enable and emanate from these expectations and capabilities. They are capability–based forces, achieved through continuous evolution, underwriting precise effects–based operations. The product of these three concepts is a set of capabilities that, though radiating from an evolutionary process, are revolutionary in effect.

Effects–Based Operations

The concept of effects–based operations is fundamentally output oriented. That is, the relevant measures are not sorties flown, or battalions deployed, or enemies killed or captured. All those may be needed inputs to achieve the desired effect, but the measure is how well the intended effect is achieved–the output.

Military forces are expected to exploit technology, innovative strategies and tactics, and train to enable military operations that generate the level of precision that achieves the intended military effects, with little or no adverse, unintended effects. Further, these capabilities must be relevant across a wide range of contingency situations – from major conflict to peacekeeping operations. In addition, these capabilities are to produce precise tactical effects against specific targets with operations conducted such that the tactical effects support both operational level and strategic level objectives.

The operational level addresses the broader objectives of the military campaign. The strategic level transcends military goals and objectives and provides guidance and constraints designed to ensure that tactical and operational objectives are achieved in ways that also serve the larger strategic objective. The coalition operation in Afghanistan provides a compelling illustration of the importance of effects–based operations at all three levels – strategic, operational, and tactical.

At the top of the strategic objectives is strengthening the worldwide coalition against terrorism. The contingency operation in Afghanistan is not a war to be won. It is an early battle in a long campaign to make terrorism, and governments who support or tolerate terrorist organizations globally unacceptable. In application, the strategic intended effects require that operations be highly discriminate with little unintended damage, and that it be clearly evident to coalition partners that there is careful attention to making the conduct of the counter–terrorist campaign also serve the needs of populations in areas of operations.

The operational intended effects include eliminating the al Qaeda infrastructure, organization, and leadership in Afghanistan. Again, strategic considerations constrain the manner of pursuing the operational effects. Hence, there is inevitable tension between the desired operational and strategic effects. For example, it has inevitably proven difficult in the Afghanistan environment to find the al Qaeda leadership, and even more difficult to distinguish and separate them from innocent non–combatants. The difficulty in finding them puts a high premium on immediate attacks once located to serve the operational objective. The difficulty in distinguishing and separating them from innocent non–combatants puts a high premium on accurate identification of the target to avoid collateral damage.

Operations at the tactical level in this contingency focus on destroying or disabling selected fixed targets and on support of ground force operations against al Qaeda and Taliban military forces. Again, both purposes demand high precision.

Capability-Based Forces

This focus on multi–level effects is not a new phenomenon. Operations at both the tactical and operational levels in Vietnam were strongly driven by the strategic objective of keeping China out of the conflict. Sensitivity to the issue was heightened by memories of the Chinese intervention in the Korean War. The resulting restraints on tactical operations have often been accorded a major

AFP / US NAVY

During the Cold War, we compensated for the deficiency in specific threat prediction by choosing a set of scenarios and then measuring our aggregate capabilities against that aggregate threat. But, with the end of the Cold War, it became impractical to conceive a representative set of threats.

share of the blame for the military failure in Vietnam. Constraints on attacks against military and leadership targets in North Vietnam and Cambodia undoubtedly had adverse effects. Still, it would be a dubious conclusion to consider these as fundamental reasons for the failure. Fortunately, such a conclusion was not embraced by the generations of civilian and military leaders who understood and corrected the underlying causes of that failure. The causes were inadequate military capabilities–in equipment, in training, and in operational concepts.

Like the effects–based concept, the enabling capabilities–based concept is output oriented. It replaces a threat–based approach. That approach developed at least two fatal flaws. The first is that we are unable to identify the next likely set of threats with anything like the level of specificity needed to define force needs. During the Cold War, we compensated for the deficiency in specific threat prediction by choosing a set of scenarios and then measuring our aggregate capabilities against that aggregate threat. The theory, which worked in a reasonably static world security environment, was that this would provide a set of capabilities that handled the identified scenarios and that could adapt to others. But, with the end of the Cold War, it became impractical to conceive a representative set of threats.

The second fatal flaw stems from the concept that being incrementally better than a given opponent would lead to success in a campaign, although there would be successes and failures in individual battles. That is no longer an acceptable criterion. The goal for our military forces today is to be able to dominate any contingency situation from the outset.

To further illustrate the need for a capabilities–based approach, it is useful to briefly examine four deficiencies that were particularly debilitating in Vietnam.

- The adversary had the advantage of information superiority–that is, they consistently knew more about what we were doing than vice–versa. Hence we were often–perhaps usually–in a reactive mode.

- Night provided a sanctuary for the adversary. Low effectiveness at night (particularly from the air–our greatest advantage) limited the pace and intensity of operations and provided the adversary a time to reconstitute, regroup, and repair with little interference.

- Low lethality per combat platform required that we mass platforms to aggregate enough lethality to do anything militarily useful against a target set. In fact, low lethality per platform, combined with the constrained pace of operations imposed by the night limitation, often meant that the adversary could repair damage faster than we could inflict it, making it virtually impossible to achieve operational objectives with available capabilities.

- The command and control structure and the lack of operational-level focus greatly diminished the effectiveness of tactical operations using available capabilities.

Integrating Capability Sets to Achieve Precision Effects

In the years between Vietnam and the Gulf War solutions to these capability gaps were pursued resolutely and successfully. When next called on for large–scale military operations–the Gulf War–U..S. forces gained information superiority in hours, and near information supremacy in days. Night became a time of maximum advantage for U.S. air and armored forces, with an unbroken pace of operations that allowed the adversary no sanctuary and no recovery. Targets requiring squadrons of effort in Vietnam required only a single sortie using precision weapons.

There were clear strategic and operational objectives directed by the President, the Secretary of Defense, and the Joint Forces Commander. Tactical operations were focused on defined operational and strategic objectives. The result was that 100 days of air operations and 100 hours of ground operations achieved the objective of expelling Iraqi forces from Kuwait. Judgments about the strategic objective of increased stability would be premature.

The continuing progression of enabling capabilities following the Gulf War provided highly flexible, adaptive, and effective capability sets that could be rapidly integrated to support intended effects at the three levels—strategic, operational, and tactical—in Afghanistan.

Continuous Evolution

The Afghanistan experience is not a model for future challenges, or solutions to those challenges. There is no such model. Still, it can serve as a compelling example of the power of rapidly integrating sets of capabilities to produce

precision effects. These capabilities were not, in themselves, designed or tailored for anything like the Afghanistan operation. In fact, the capability–based approach, by definition, is not designed or tailored for a specific threat or a specific scenario. Rather, the capabilities are intended to have application to a wide range of situations. The concept of capability–based forces to produce precise effects depends, as does transformation of forces, first and foremost on a change in mind–set from threat–based thinking to capability–based thinking, from scenario–based planning to adaptive planning, from focus on inputs to effects achieved. For Operation Enduring Freedom in Afghanistan, six diverse sets of capabilities were integrated to produce precision effects at all three levels – strategic, operational, and tactical:

- Small U.S. units on the ground that direct airpower in support of indigenous ground forces and to influence those forces.
- Surveillance and reconnaissance systems—space-based, manned aircraft, and unmanned aerial vehicles—that provide a continuous and, where needed, detailed picture of the battlespace.
- Combat platforms that cannot be denied the access needed to deliver the needed range of precise firepower. Long-range bombers – old long-range bombers, by the way – delivered about 75 percent of air-delivered firepower; carrier-based fighter aircraft supported by large-scale aerial refueling and a few unmanned aerial vehicles delivered the rest. Hence, the long distance from bases to targets—about 750 nautical miles for the closest aircraft carrier—increased the difficulty, but did not decrease the effectiveness.
- Munitions that are guided with great precision to hit designated targets, and only designated targets. In the Gulf War, 7 percent of the munitions were precision guided. In Kosovo, 30 percent were precision munitions. In Afghanistan—66 percent.
- Communications and networks that make it possible to integrate these capability sets to achieve the intended effects. Much of this connectivity was achieved with innovation on the fly.
- A command and control system and practitioners at all levels of command that welcome innovation and new approaches while directing operations.

There has been much talk in recent years about a revolution in military affairs. Many experienced military leaders are skeptical about revolutions in military capability while also believing strongly that continuous evolution produces revolutionary capabilities, underwriting highly effective new force capabilities. The key to transformation is delivering new and more relevant concepts and capabilities to deal with an ever–changing set of real–world demands.

None of the capabilities being employed in Operation Enduring Freedom is, in themselves, revolutionary.

- The small units on the ground operate frequently on foot and on horseback, as do the indigenous ground forces they support.
- The attacking platforms are dominated by B–52s that entered service about the same year as the author; also, 15–year–old B–1 bombers and 10–to 20–year old carrier-based fighter aircraft.
- We first used precision munitions at the end of the Vietnam War.
- We have been developing UAVs since the middle years of the Vietnam War. Most of the surveillance and reconnaissance assets used in this operation are Cold War vintage.

The revolutionary aspect is the paramount attention to both near and long–term effects, and the integration of these sets of capabilities into the means of achieving those effects.

Conclusion

Transformation is, first and foremost, the product of a change in mindset. Three revolutionary concepts–capability–based forces, effects–based operations, and continuous evolution–are producing revolutionary effects from new ways to fight. An imperative that is driving capabilities and effects is the need for precision effects—at the strategic level, the operational level and the tactical level.

The demands for resolving the vast majority of contingencies impacting U.S. national security today are incompatible with extensive unintended effects. Thanks to a long–term commitment to continuous evolution and open–minded conceptual thinking, we are increasingly able to cope with these very demanding realities. Continuous means just that. There is no stopping point. There is no destination. There is, instead, the continuous drive toward increasing flexibility and relevance.

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Night became a time of maximum advantage for U.S. air and armored forces, with an unbroken pace of operations that allowed the adversary no sanctuary and no recovery. Targets requiring squadrons of effort in Vietnam required only a single sortie using precision weapons.

U.S. LEADERSHIP IN A CHANGING WORLD

THE MORAL RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE GLOBE'S SOLE SUPERPOWER

By Francis Mading Deng

Most people around the world would agree that the horrific events of September 11, 2001, reshaped the world dramatically, and that U.S. leadership in responding to the global threat of terrorism has been overwhelmingly asserted. By the same token, the leadership of the United States in the world has been unequivocally reaffirmed. But some critical questions still need to be addressed. First, to what extent do the American people, who wield the ultimate power in the democratic system, understand and accept the role of global leadership for their country? Second, what does global leadership entail and, in particular, what are the values and objectives that the United States is prepared to promote and defend around the world? Third, what are the modalities for pursuing these values and objectives?

The Challenge of Leadership for the United States

Americans generally believe that their country is the most powerful, wealthiest and most envied in the world. They even acknowledge that this is the root of the ambivalence toward the United States – admiration for their system and hatred for their alleged arrogance. September 11 made it clear where America draws the line: You are either with us in the war against terrorism, in which case you are an ally and a friend, or you are not with us, in which case you are with the terrorists, an enemy and a target of our onslaught on terrorism.

This is all understandable. What is not so understandable is what we mean by terrorism and what is precisely the best way to fight it. The horrific strike against the Twin Towers of the World Trade Center is an obvious act of terrorism at its worst. And so was the strike against the Pentagon. Even the abortive targeting of the White House or the Capitol Building was an equally outrageous attempt at terrorism. But terrorism has multiple faces, many of which are either too complex or removed to be understandable to the people of the United States.

If terrorism is defined in broad terms to embrace a wide variety of unscrupulous infliction of physical and psychological insecurity on masses of innocent civilians, then the challenge of countering it becomes quite extreme and formidable. Ultimately it means not only responding to the immediate acts of wonton violence, but also addressing the underlying problems, which may not be the direct causes of terrorism, but which provide the breeding ground for terrorist activities. Viewed from this perspective, the challenge becomes truly global and should aim at the pursuit of human security in all its facets and phases.

The framework for such pursuit should be prevention, response and solutions. Prevention entails creating conditions that foster peace, security and the general welfare of the people and under which a threat to security could be anticipated and prevented. Response means that when a crisis erupts- destroying or endangering the security of people–appropriate action will be taken promptly to provide adequate protection and humanitarian assistance. Solution entails not only restoring conditions of security and stability, but addressing the underlying causes that generated or contributed to the crisis in the first place. In a sense then, addressing the underlying causes becomes prevention.

Sovereignty and State Responsibilty

Since confronting terrorism on a global scale would mean acting at the global, the national and the local levels simultaneously, issues of sovereignty are bound to arise. It then becomes essential to conceptualize sovereignty not as a barricade against international solidarity for global security, but as a normative principle of responsibility to ensure the safety and general welfare of all those under state jurisdiction. If a state lacks the capacity to provide protection, then it should invite, or at least welcome, international support. But where a state lacks the capacity and/or the will to address the problem unilaterally or collaboratively, it cannot expect the international community to watch and do nothing in the face of the massive suffering or death of innocent people. This means that the best way to protect national sovereignty is to discharge the responsibility associated with it.

This is not a new approach to sovereignty, but a reaffirmation of the normative principles that have always been part of sovereignty. Since its inception, the concept was meant to empower a state to establish order within its jurisdiction and thereby facilitate peaceful and cooperative relations among nations. While this initially connoted unfettered control and authority over territory and population by a sovereign, with democracy and universal respect for human rights, the doors became increasingly open to international monitoring and scrutiny. The will and welfare of the people increasingly superceded the dictates of the sovereign.

Today, no self-respecting government or national leader can argue that what occurs within a state is the exclusive responsibility of the state, whatever its consequences on the security and welfare of the population involved. Quite the contrary, every nation sees it in its best interest to project a positive image of its responsibilities, even if the realities on the ground conflict with its claims.

The Challenge of Displacement

One of the crises of the 21st century that will increasingly challenge state sovereignty, and the role of the international community in which the leadership of the United States is central, is the global crisis of internal displacement. The international community is familiar with the notion of a refugee, a person who has been forced by persecution or violence to flee across internationally recognized borders and therefore has lost the protection and assistance of his or her government. The phenomenon became most pronounced during and after World War II, which propelled the international community to create a legal and institutional framework for their protection and assistance.

Today, the world is witnessing a crisis involving numbers far greater than those of refugees. This new crisis involves people who have been uprooted from their homes and areas of normal residence by internal conflicts, gross violations of human rights and other human-made or natural disasters, but who have nevertheless remained within the borders of their own countries. There are some 25 million internally displaced persons in over 40 countries. And although some areas are more affected than others- with Africa being the worst hit continent- the crisis is truly global and is likely to become one of the most traumatic tragedies of the century.

The internally displaced face severe problems. They are in desperate need of shelter, food, potable water, medicine, education and gainful employment, and are the most vulnerable to human rights abuses. So far, the problem has been perceived as primarily a humanitarian crisis and, to a more controversial extent, a human rights issue. It is, however, becoming increasingly apparent that what is involved in most cases is a fundamental crisis of national identity that goes to the heart of social, ethnic, cultural and religious cleavages within a country. These cleavages determine who is "in" as a recognized citizen, and who is "out", and thus denied a sense of belonging on equal footing with dignity and pride in the national identity framework.

The challenge this situation poses for the affected countries demands a fundamental restructuring of the equations of power sharing and resource allocation. What is required is a framework of peace with justice and a mutual sense of belonging and participation on equitable bases. Beyond the pressing need for protection and assistance, this is a long-term challenge of human security and nation-building that ultimately must be confronted by the nationals of the country in question, but in which the international community can and should play a constructive role in accordance with the universalizing norms of human dignity.

The Challenge in Perspective

As the leader of the world, the United States can no longer be concerned with its own national interests and the security of its citizens alone. Instead, it must rise to the challenge of being the global protector of humanity. This does not mean that the United States is called upon to be the policeman of the world or that it alone will provide international protection for all those in need. Rather, what is intended is that the U.S. should play a catalytic role in fostering a more responsive world order, in which states discharge the responsibilities of sovereignty or expect remedial response from the international community, preferably within the framework of the United Nations.

The American people should realize that leadership carries both privileges and responsibilities. At present, they are reluctant to assume the responsibility of global leadership, except where such leadership involves U.S. national interests or evokes humanitarian compassion. Global leadership calls for forging international partnerships in pursuit of the unifying ideals of humanity: physical and psychological security, democratic participation, respect for fundamental rights and freedoms, and equitable opportunities for sustainable development. This may be a tall order, but the peoples of the world cannot expect less from the leadership of the United States of America at this challenging juncture of global transformation.

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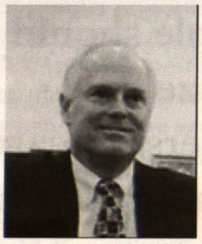
IT TAKES MORE THAN THREE BRANCHES

AN INSIDE PERSPECTIVE ON THE WORKINGS OF GOVERNMENT

By James K. Coyne



A generation ago, the best and brightest with budding political ambitions on America's college campuses presumed that there was a lofty limb somewhere on the great tree of public service that destiny had reserved for each of them. Fulfilling this purposeful goal was not rocket science—perhaps not that lofty—but it was doctrinal 'political science' of that era, and everyone knew what their career objectives were: to join, possibly even to lead, one of the three central branches of our government that shape and define power in America.

Those who preferred politics with a pen in their hand wanted instead to join "the Fourth Estate" and unsheathe their swift swords from the pinnacles of powerful mastheads, hoping to amplify a solitary voice into a whirlwind of empowered voters whose opinions could buffet those noble, constitutional branches as they saw fit. More typically, public service meant working directly for the public as a component of various Legislative, Executive, or Judicial branches. The federal, state and local governments needed thousands and thousands of young, new "leaders" every year and we were told that "the torch had been passed to a new generation of Americans"—namely us. It all looked rather straightforward.

But then it changed. America was getting bigger and more complex, and the duties and responsibilities that our founding fathers had assigned to these three, discrete branches of government swelled beyond recognition. America had grown steadily for two hundred years, but public awareness and political expectations had grown exponentially. At the same time, becoming a public servant no longer looked so attractive, rewarding or even endurable to millions of otherwise patriotic citizens. For many, it was not really where the action was.

In the years after college, my own political fortunes and misfortunes exposed me, somewhat more than most of my colleagues, to all three classical branches. After a brief stint in local government, I was elected to Congress from Pennsylvania in 1980, joined the Reagan White House in 1983, and wandered into the judicial swamps in 1986 as the founder of the American Tort Reform Association. In each venue, I saw our new, 'modern' government trapped in a framework of growing complexity and rising public expectations.

But something dramatic has happened since then as thousands of new people are working to solve our contemporary public policy dilemmas– but people with very different titles, roles and priorities. It is almost as though we have finally seen that there is more to the tree of public governance than just its branches. Maybe we just needed a botanist to explain that a tree, with all its parts, is a better metaphor for government than just those three big old branches.

As I look at the trees out my window on this blustery winter's day, it is instantly obvious what those branches are missing metaphorically: leaves– something hanging on the branches, attracting sunlight, transforming it into energy and nourishing our government. Sure, you say, that improves the metaphor, but what do those leaves really represent?

Would I surprise you if I said they were lobbyists? Or to put it more precisely, they stand for thousands of representatives from trade associations, unions, public interest groups, corporations, non–profit groups, and hundreds of other "associations" in Alexis de Tocqueville's grand sense of the word, that truly make our government and each of its branches work– the people that bring government to life! Would that be too much for you to accept in these

politically correct times?

Does the word "lobbyist" bring to mind the wrong kind of person–someone you would rather have hanging from a tree than on it? Fairly or not, the term suggests a sleazy Washington Fat Cat who turns political promises into profitable pieces of pork for his unprincipled patrons. Despite the mundane reality of who these people are (me, for instance), it would be better if our tree of governance's lovely leaves symbolized a more savory class of Americans. Tocqueville might simply call them "citizens," but these days an essayist needs a clever acronym, so allow me to offer the term "Civic Action Unit," or CAU, to represent the wide variety of leaves (lobbyists and other similar institutions) that I have come to know and respect in over two decades in Washington.

These are the people who make things happen in 21st century American government. Without them, of course, legislators would still legislate, regulators would regulate, and judges would judge; but most of the important things that we expect our government to do would not get done, because no one would be making the case, pushing the envelope, coaching the staff, and following every bill through the legislative process, around the lawyers, and through the endless bureaucratic labyrinths. That is why the most rewarding careers in Washington today are those where you function as a Civic Action Unit.

Admittedly, some of these 'units' are pretty big organizations, like the AFL–CIO, AARP and NRA, but most are tiny, especially in comparison to the government agencies they serve or shape. An effective CAU is usually 25 people or less who have developed the resources and achieved the recognition to actively make policy. They drill down into a narrow, focused segment of the body politic where their expertise, contacts, national alliances or membership and passion persuade others to call them "the authority." Like a single leaf on a giant tree, its position exposes it to just enough public sunlight to get the energy it needs, while relying on a distant root structure for essential nutrients that help turn its best face toward the outside world, even as it induces the tree's branches to grow more in its own direction and closer to the sunnier side of its world.

Most people suppose that a CAU's primary job is to get legislation written, regulations reformed, or favorable judicial decisions rendered. That certainly gets the headlines, but most of their time is spent connecting to their constituents, just like politicians are supposed to do. But CAUs work with a much more civil constituency than most politicians. After all, a CAU's constituents, whether they are clients, members, or specific businesses and their management, are happy to have a CAU in the national or state capital representing their interests, and not many of these constituents ever oppose the CAU's political agenda. Few politicians can imagine such harmony.

Work in a CAU is especially rewarding because it offers the best of what politics is supposed to be without many of the hardships. CAUs are often the most creative places in Washington. They are the early–adopters of new ideas, offering specific solutions to the latest problems long before they appear on the typical politician's radar screen. Then, when society asks for action, they are ready with answers and know–how that no one else has.

Another rewarding part of life with a CAU is educating your constituents and members. Our federal, state, and local government is so vast that even if it made a serious effort to educate our fellow countrymen about what they were doing for and to us, it would be nearly impossible. Unfortunately, much of government only gives lip service to educating the public about what they are doing. When's the last time you got a truly informative message of any kind from Uncle Sam?

CAUs are responsible for almost everything you know about the actions of government on a day–to–day basis. You might read about something in the press, but more than likely, a CAU's PR department was the source of the information. More

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typically, if you have a real need to know about some government program or action, especially at a preliminary stage, the only reliable source is an association, union, public interest or trade group– in other words, a CAU.

Another advantage of working for a CAU is simply economic. The salaries there usually exceed their public sector counterparts, the benefits are more generous, the travel and other perquisites are typically much more rewarding, and the job security is certainly higher than for top positions in government. There are traditional profit–making activities associated with most CAUs (seminars, publications, real estate, insurance, conventions and trade shows, as well as specialized goods and services) that also provide entrepreneurial and investment opportunities.

For those with a technological bent, it should be noted that CAUs have developed some of the most advanced web sites on the Internet, with cutting–edge capabilities and the resources to support them. A few ambitious souls have also used their CAU career as a launching pad for other careers in journalism, public speaking, teaching, writing, and even entertainment. Lastly, but far from least, the private lives of CAU professionals are much less hectic, free from the public inquiries that often harass public officials, and full, it seems to me, of much more "quality time" for family and friends.

In the final analysis, CAUs get results and, for most of us, that is what matters. I can hardly think of a single federal policy issue over the past decade that was not primarily shaped by the persistent efforts of adversarial CAUs who, as the decision process moved forward, negotiated primarily among themselves to find the common ground that became the basis of public action. From massive campaigns that shape national policies and political agendas to individual efforts that bring relief to a small group of citizens with a cause, CAUs are involved in every cause– always looking for an angle, an injustice, or an opportunity.

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Beyond these personal and professional rewards, beyond the satisfaction of making something happen, beyond even the pride in shaping legislation or helping a President advance his agenda, there is the special excitement of being a warrior leading the charge for your cause. Like a general at the head of an army, you occasionally find yourself staring across an ideological battlefield at "the enemy" (usually another CAU leader) as you each plan your final assault. Historians recall a time when nations relied on CAUs to fight their military battles, in the guise of privateers and mercenaries. Today, we settle most arguments with a very different arsenal of persuasive rather than deadly weapons, and much of this contemporary fighting is done by non–violent CAUs– legislative legionnaires who take no prisoners and win no medals.

Perhaps we should think of the leaves on our branches of government more as needles on an evergreen, and ever ready to defend, to challenge and to prickle. Sometimes that is all it takes, a tiny prick on the sensibilities of a slumbering citizenry, to call our government to action, whether at times of prosperity, or challenge, or even in the face of crisis. Many of today's best and brightest, I hope, will understand that these "Civic Action Units," the countless associations, organizations, and yes, even lobbying firms, are a vital part of our national tree of governance. A very important part that helps the tree grow, bear fruit and shine.

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A RARE SECOND CHANCE

AMERICA'S OPPORTUNITY TO ESTABLISH A NEW WORLD ORDER

By David Boren

At the end of the Persian Gulf War, then President George Bush argued that there was a real chance to create a new world order. With the Cold War behind us, he proposed that the leading nations of the world should come together to create a coalition to stop the spread of weapons of mass destruction, to reduce the threat of terrorism and to deal with regional conflicts. He even discussed the possibility of using Fort Dix as a training center for troops from many nations to train together to create a common force, which could be deployed in case of international emergencies or to back up the international inspection team.

The new world order never materialized for various reasons and the opportunity to create a safer and more secure world was missed. The ad hoc coalition, which fought the Gulf War, was never institutionalized to make it permanent. Instead, as the events of September 11 drastically demonstrated, the world has become an increasingly dangerous place for all people, including Americans. The tools of destruction are more widely disbursed than ever and they are often held in the hands of the least responsible members of world society.

Crises often create opportunities and wars often lead to new alliances. It is now clear that the current situation has given our leaders a second chance to create new institutional arrangements, which could literally change the course of history in the 21st century. Second chances are rare. This one must not be missed.

It has often been written that the world changed after September 11. It would be more accurate to say that the American perception of the world changed after September 11. The world was already a dangerous place prior to the terrorist attacks in New York and Washington. Americans, however, had a false sense of security believing that we were somehow immune to the threats, which were already very real to most other nations. We now realize that we cannot isolate ourselves from those threats. We can never wall out the rest of the world especially in a nation with only a few thousand members of the Border Patrol and 400 million legal entries by visitors each year. The only way to make America secure is to make our world neighborhood more safe and secure.

What should we do? Some needed actions are more limited and focused. Others are more sweeping and will require a change in the mindset of some policymakers.

First, we must focus more of our intelligence resources on human source intelligence. Technical collection systems cannot penetrate tiny terrorist cells in which information is closely held. Only human agents can penetrate them. To his credit, CIA Director George Tenet has placed emphasis in human intelligence. Rebuilding human intelligence requires a long lead time. People with the right ethnic background have to be recruited and then go through a long training program that includes cultural and language training as well as needed professional skills for very dangerous jobs. Then they must become established in the target area. This process can take several years. We are fortunate that this year, the CIA had its largest graduating class of human intelligence officers in years.

Second, we must create a much larger pool of people in our country who have knowledge of the languages, history and culture of many areas of the world where few Americans have been involved in the past. We have a strategic minerals reserve of items that might be in short supply in case they are needed in wartime or national emergency. We need a similar strategic talent reserve of people who will give us expertise in all regions of the world. Any area, no matter how remote, can become strategically important overnight. Fifty times as many international students from the third world come to the U.S. to study as we send Americans to study abroad. We should welcome these international students because they come to understand us and become our best friends overseas. At the same time, we should massively in-

crease funding for the National Security Education Act scholarships that send American students to study in areas where few Americans have gone before. In the past six years, 2000 American students have gone to such areas where 50 different languages that are rarely taught in the U.S. are spoken. We should have provided scholarships for ten times that many.

The first two actions are limited and focused. The rest are far more sweeping and are of crucial importance.

We must change our attitude about collaboration with the rest of the world. We must not lull ourselves into thinking that a stable world order can be built on American military might alone.

Third, we must change our attitude about collaboration with the rest of the world. It is important for the United States to have sufficient military power to act unilaterally, if necessary. It is vital to our national security that we remain a military superpower. However, we must not lull ourselves into thinking that a stable world order can be built on American military might alone. To make this mistake would leave a legacy of bitterness toward perceived American arrogance all over the world. A stable world order can only be built on a broad international consensus that allows for shared intelligence, worldwide inspection regimes and shared military burdens. The participation of others as we learned in Afghanistan is crucial. Russia, Pakistan and surrounding states have played a major role in our success in the area. For these practical reasons, the interests of other nations cannot be ignored. We must listen to them with respect and involve them in the decision–making process so that they will share ownership with us in the final decision.

Fourth, we must look not only at combating terrorism, but we must also begin to better understand and attack its root causes. A disease cannot be cured by treating only its symptoms. We are fortunate that at the end of World War II we had wise policymakers who not only set up mechanisms like NATO to combat the communist military threat to Europe, but also established the Marshall Plan to combat the economic, social and political instability that made communism appear attractive to desperate people.

Finally, for any series of actions to work they must be institutionalized. NATO played a leading role in ending the Cold War because it was not just a temporary coalition. The coalition was made permanent by institutionalizing it. The current coalition that has helped us in Afghanistan must not vanish like the Persian Gulf coalition disintegrated when the immediate crisis was passed. A permanent and formal structure should be established for ongoing consultation and decision–making. The Russians can play a key role. President Putin clearly believes that it is in Russia's national interest to align itself with the United States and Europe. He needs international investment and protection against terrorist and extremist threats to his borders. Because we were once enemies in the Cold War, Russia can bring other nations to the coalition that the U.S. could not reach. It is an irony of history that a friendship between past enemies could be a major force for creating a much safer world.

The coalition should be expanded to include other leading nations like China, for example. Chinese membership is important if the coalition is to reach its full potential. Hopefully, the role of the coalition will be expanded to create an international inspection team to find and destroy terrorist command posts and facilities for making dangerous weapons. It will also be important to establish an international police force or rapid response force as President Bush Sr. envisioned it at the time of the Gulf War.

The tragedy of September 11 has helped Americans see the world more clearly and realistically. We have learned that as much as we might desire it, we cannot isolate ourselves from the world's dangers and challenges. We can only hope that like those leaders, who wisely developed a new architecture for American foreign policy after the end of World War II, our current leaders in both political parties will have the courage and wisdom to do the same. For better or for worse, their decisions during this critical period will largely determine the safety and stability of the world in the 21st Century.

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MUHAMMAD ATTA, MODERNITY, AND THE SECULAR STATE

HOW IMPORTANT WILL MUSLIM FUNDAMENTALISM BE FOR THE 21ST CENTURY?

By Frank Griffel

For all we know, Muhammad Atta was both the ringleader of the 19 terrorists and the mastermind of the attack of last September. A shy, soft–spoken Egyptian, 33 years old, he had studied urban development in Germany since 1992. Around 1997, he began to organize a Muslim study group at his college in Hamburg and from there we can only suspect which course the group took. In May 2000, three of the groups members came to the U.S. in order to take flight lessons, and recently a video of the fourth member, Atta's roommate in the flat in Hamburg whose visa applications had been repeatedly rejected, popped up in a house in Kabul. In this video he declared his willingness to give up his life in service of God.

AFP / ABBAS MOMANI

Apart from this short video, still very little material is available in order to examine the beliefs and convictions of Muhammad Atta and his accomplices. There is only one document that gives something like a clue about the ideas of this group. A five–page Arabic epistle was found in three handwritten copies, one in the wreckage of the airplane that crashed in Pennsylvania and one in Muhammad Atta's luggage that didn't make it on his deadly flight from Logan Airport. The strange and bewildering content of this letter can only be explained by assuming that it aimed to keep the perpetrators' bodies and souls together on this day in September. It contains mainly imperatives about how to conduct oneself on this murderous mission and what to do in which order. More importantly, it evokes the memory of Islamic history and refers to the overall goal of the whole act, "Remember the battle of the Prophet Muhammad…against the infidels, as he went on building the Islamic State." Those who opposed the Prophet during the creation of the first Muslim society at the beginning of the 7th century AD are seen as the same forces that Atta and his 18 accomplices attacked on September 11. Those are "the followers of Satan, (...) the admirers of Western civilization." The document wraps the indiscriminate killing of thousands in the centuries old language of religious ritual, "If God grant you a sacrificial slaughter, perform it as in offering on behalf of your father and mother."

But apart from the reference to Western civilization, the letter contains no program of action, no justification for the murder of thousands, and no real clue for those who seek to understand. It is directed to the *illuminati*, and it fails to speak to the outsider. And even if it would, did anybody understand Osama bin Laden when he addresses the world in a video October 8 and declared that "hypocrisy supports the head of international infidels", and that America was the symbol for "the modern world's paganism"? Did Osama bin Laden not see the pictures of crowded parking lots surrounding the churches of this country immediately after September 11? Did nobody show him the bumper stickers that God may bless this country?

The words these terrorists use seem to be full of meaning for them, and yet say almost nothing to us. But similarly, our language evokes the memory of previous battles so meaningful to this country, yet alienating to those who did not take part in these fights. President Bush used the words "crusade" and "axis of evil" and called Islamic fundamentalism a "distorted lie of history." Of all his metaphors, the latter description expresses the sentiments of the American people most. Islamic fundamentalism is

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viewed as a religious and thus out–dated ideology that somehow managed to jump off the dust–cart of history on its way to the dumpyard. Since then it lurks around the shady corners of this world, showing its ugly face only when it strikes violently against the forces that drive this world towards a brighter future. Such a view, however, belittles the political significance of Islamic fundamentalism. It is indeed not a shadow of the past, but an idea that only developed during the 20th century and that may gain its full momentum in the 21st. Arab politicians who have dealt with fundamentalist groups since the 1940s learned that these ideas are very much like Pandora's box. Actions by countries like Egypt or Algeria have shown that, in the past relatively small concessions towards the political activity of Muslim fundamentalist groups have, over the years resulted in tremendous political instabi-lity. This illustrates how powerful a force political Islam is. Thus countries in which we now assume little infection by these ideas, like Syria or Iraq, for instance, may become hotspots of this movement in the 21st century. Others, like Jordan or the above mentioned Egypt and Algeria, have already come past the first round of a probably longer lasting political match. Here, the militant organizations are in steady decline and seem to give way to a new generation of Islamic fundamentalists that pick their fight at the ballot box.

Whoever wrote the document found with the terrorists of September 11 was convinced that admiration of Western civilization is nothing else than following Satan. Such words are often taken to mean that Muslim fundamentalism opposes the whole project of modernity. Even some experts assume that Muslim fundamentalism is nothing more than a temporal problem that will go away once modernity has gained full momentum in the Middle East. When the BBC recently asked an American journalist and commentator how to best resolve Afghanistan's decade long problems of political instability and minority rule, he recommended—seriously—the installation of satellite dishes on every Afghan house. Once Afghans could take a first-hand look at American TV and American lifestyle, they would rush to get the real thing and import American products and American democracy.

The rejection by fundamentalist Muslims of changes that we who live in a modern world find reasonable and attractive is often characterized as irrational and distasteful. It is true, Muslim fundamentalists despise American films or TV series just as much as the import of Western consumer goods that need payment in hard–earned foreign currency. But is such a rejection really irrational or a rejection of modernity? During the 1970s, many Americans supported a campaign to "buy American," because it seems indeed more rational to support workers in Detroit or Pittsburgh, rather than in Kobe or Wolfsburg. And, even in some quite civilized countries abroad, American films and TV series are regarded as the epitome of irrationality and distaste. There is a general consensus in France, for instance, that American films are all questionable in their message because of their immature treatment of sexuality (less tolerant) and violence (too tolerant). There are few people in France who are not convinced that their country's cinema production is far more modern than Hollywood. Many people in Europe openly reject the path modernity has taken in this country without considering themselves in any way hostile towards the U.S.

These disagreements document that there is a dispute in this world about what modernity really means. In the U.S., modernity is the development of liberalism, rationality, and productivity within the frame of a strong but non–interventionist, democratic and secular state. In fact, many people see secularism as the key to an understanding of the rise of Muslim fundamentalism. But the lack of secularism in the ideal "fundamentalist" state only yields limited clues for understanding the singularity of this political phenomenon. Having grown up in a society that clearly distinguishes between one's faith and one's citizenship, most Americans believe that this is true for all modern societies, and that those societies who do not follow this example cannot be called modern. But again, if we look at leading European nations, we find that in England the head of state is the same as the head of the English Protestant church, that in Germany the IRS forwards taxes to the two main Christian denominations (but not to any others), and that in Italy hardly

any decision of the state run school system can be made without the support of the Catholic clergy. For much of the past 60 years, parties that regard themselves explicitly as Christian ruled both Germany and Italy. Most European nations keep public records of their citizens' denomination, and there are hardly any voices that call for a change of this situation. Where Americans distinguish sharply between the idea of citizenship and membership in a religious community, most Europeans assume a relationship of mutual benefit between the two. These countries went through a period of Enlightenment just as America did. But secularism in these countries is understood only in terms of the disentanglement of the church's and the state's authority to rule. When it comes to the moral guidance of the society, the participation of the church and other denominations even in matters of legislation is still welcomed.

The historical situation of Muslim countries cannot be compared to this process of secularization. Except for the somehow exceptional case of Iran, there has never been a "church" in Muslim countries, and there has never been a religious institution similar to it that ruled over its subjects in the stately manner of many pre–modern European societies. For the last five centuries, the clergy in most Muslim countries has been extremely weak and incapable of even challenging the authority of the rulers. They did not provide guidance in vital moral questions and did not participate in legislation. Enter the new preachers of Muslim fundamentalism during the 20th century who claim precisely these two spheres. In fact, they argue that the most successful modern state of the second half on the 20th century, Israel, is one where the idea of the state is most closely connected to the one of religion. Muslim fundamentalists who do not belong to the mostly Iranian Shi'i branch of Islam despise the rule of clergymen. They nevertheless aim to establish a society that follows the moral and political guidance which in their view only religion can provide.

The Muslim fundamentalists' fusion of religion and state has little to do with the pre–secular European state that the Pilgrim Fathers left when they boarded the Mayflower. It bears more similarity with the state the Pilgrims created after they hit Plymouth Rock. A state whose institutions are not attached to any "church" aristocracy, indeed whose organization is independent of religious institutions. Nevertheless, all members of these state institutions will acknowledge that the law of the land is a religious one and that it follows God's commandments. And here is the important difference between many contemporary Muslim fundamentalists and the Pilgrims' vision. While the Pilgrim's believed that God's will is expressed in both the book of revelation and in the will of the congregation, most Muslim fundamentalists are adamant in their view that the primary source of God's will is revelation and that the congregation's right to interpret is narrow. And while the institutions that the Pilgrims created in order to find the will of the congregation eventually lead to the establishment of democracy, Muslim fundamentalists aim to enforce God's law verbatim according to the letter of revelation. In fact, the most influential ideologist of Muslim fundamentalism, the Egyptian Sayyid Qutb, stressed that the ideal Muslim state is not ruled by groups of men or women, nor its citizens as a whole, but it is ruled by God himself through the voice of his revelation.

Does such a vision have a future for the 21st century? Do we not live in an increasingly modern world where modernity is connected to secular culture? Since the number of people who regard themselves as believers of a religion constantly diminished since the beginning of Enlightenment, one might argue that religion has less and less significance in a future political culture. This, however, is not what we should expect. I believe that religion will play a more important role in the political culture of the 21st century both in the developed countries but even more so in the developing ones. For most developing countries, modernity is less a force of liberalization and democratization, but most of all the process of rationalization and increasing productivity. This almost calls for religion in order to balance the experience of meaninglessness in a more and more rationalized society. When Sayyid Qutb, between 1948 and 1950, visited the U.S., he criticized this society for its materialism and its lack of guidance. America,

When the BBC recently asked an American journalist and commentator how to best resolve Afghanistan's decade long problems of political instability and minority rule, he recommended —seriously—the installation of satellite dishes on every Afghan house.

he wrote, was a country that could produce great riches and great strength and that must be admired for these capacities. But he felt that there was a lack of guidance and that the strength of the American society was used for nothing else than the production of material riches. "The American virtues are those of productivity and governance," he wrote in 1951, "and not the virtues of humanity's and society's guidance. Theirs are the virtues of the intellect and the hand, and not virtues of sensibility and perceptiveness." Sayyid Qutb saw the weak Egyptian State following in the footsteps of the American model of modernization. In opposition to this version of a modern society, he propagated his own idea of modernity. His vision was one that would combine the virtues of American modernity, i.e. the achievement of productivity and governance through strong state institutions, with the moral guidance that according to his vision only God's law can provide. This state would fully benefit from the most important event in humankind's history, the revelation of God's law to his Prophet Muhammad in the 7th century, and it would also benefit from the achievements of a modern technological society that creates material riches for its members.

Islamic fundamentalism is first and foremost a political ideology and the conflict I see ahead of us is one about the democratic society against the non–democratic.

Such a vision is indeed powerful. For many people in the developing countries it seems to combine the best of both worlds, the material temptations of a "foreign" American–led culture with the guidance and meaningfulness that traditional "own" ways of life have provided for centuries. In fact, it would even increase the meaningfulness of the traditional lifestyle, since this new life is conducted according to God's will, and thus towards whatever meaning God has intended by creating this world. This meaning may be unbeknown for us humans, but it is, according to this view, clearly our destiny to follow God's commandment. Such a political vision offers escape into supposed meaningfulness for those who regard their individual's fate in this world as utterly insignificant. Many analysts voiced their surprise when it became clear that the perpetrators of September 11 were from well–to–do middle class families, and that some like Muhammad Atta had studied for many years in Europe, thus creating opportunities for a successful life in their home countries. But the disentanglement from traditional ways that give meaning to an individual life in, for instance, middle class Cairo, led these Arab foreign students feel the same individual insignificance that lead poor inhabitants of Palestinian refugee camps to give up their future expectations. Or, as one British Arab immigrant put it before he left his hometown near Birmingham to join the Taliban in Afghanistan, "I want to be somebody, and not die in a dump like this."

Certainly, modernity and its cruel uprooting of traditional ways to find meaning in life has often produced the likes of Muhammad Atta. But, if intelligent and highly educated young men, who spend much time in Western societies and, who got to know them and their rules well, become convinced of Sayyid Qutb's arguments for the superiority of a society governed by God's law, these arguments are indeed powerful. The idea that God's society is superior to any kind of human rule looks right now as the great challenge of the 21st century. We should, however, not be mistaken over where the frontier runs. This is not the challenge of secularism versus the religious state just as it is not the one about Islam versus the West. Islamic fundamentalism is first and foremost a political ideology and the conflict I see ahead of us is one about the democratic society against the non–democratic. Muslim fundamentalist groups find themselves inevitably entangled between two forces, the idea that God's revelation shall rule and various concepts of how humans shall interpret God's law. Not all fundamentalists are as one–sided as Sayyid Qutb in this conflict and reject human interpretation. In fact, just like the Pilgrim Fathers who found democracy in their quest for God's commonwealth, we might see–we *might* see–important and promising developments come out of Muslim fundamentalism during the 21st century.

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CHARLES HILL

THE UNRESOLVED QUESTIONS OF THE MIDDLE EAST

AN INTERVIEW

Charles Hill, a career minister in the U.S. Foreign Service, is a research fellow at the Hoover Institution. He was executive aide to former U.S. Secretary of State George P. Shultz (1985 – 89) and served as special consultant on policy to the Secretary–General of the United Nations from 1992 to 1996. Mr. Hill is also a diplomat in residence and lecturer in International Studies at Yale University. On February 19, 2002, Charles Hill spoke with The Politic *about the crisis in the Middle East.*

ALYSON SUDOW

The Politic: In the essay that you wrote for* The Age of Terror, *you quoted Princeton scholar Bernard Lewis, "Why has the Islamic world not been able to parallel the economic and political modernizations of other non–Western civilizations?" What do you see as the answer to this question?

Charles Hill: I think it has been brought out recently in a number of articles by people who have followed it for a long time, realizing now that there is no separation of church and state in the Islamic world. Thus, religion can be brought into anything, and anything that does not have a dimension of religion in it that is political can be challenged on religious grounds. That also means that there is not any comfortable political system for the Islamic world other than the Caliphate.

The Caliphate was possessed by the Ottoman Empire up until 1922 and when they gave it up, there was no uniformly accepted or legitimate Islamic–wide political system. Then there was a dispute as to where that Caliphate would go. Egypt wanted it and Saudi Arabia wanted it, but the fact that more than one wanted it meant that nobody would get it, and so it went into abeyance. If it exists anywhere today, it exists in the organization of the Arab Conference. That Caliphate was a pre–modern system in many political ways, whereas what has become the world's international system is the system of states. States are what make up the United Nations and states make up the entire world. Wherever you are, whether you are in New Zealand or Burma or Venezuela, we are thinking in terms of states.

But the Islamic world has never really been comfortable with the fact that they are states. It goes back to the fact that you do not have a separation of church and state. This has brought about regimes in the Arab–Islamic world that are just not effective. None of them is a democracy. None of them has been able to deliver the goods for their people. That has caused a large number of the people to be disaffected, to feel that they have been marginalized, that they do not have any openings for the future. They see the outside world as being much more effective in terms of economic progress, political liberties, and they are resentful, leading them to turn away from the general international system.

You have mentioned the fall of the Ottoman Empire and the disunity in the Arab world that followed. In an age where the Arab world is divided into, as you say, 21 different nations with different regimes, different loyalties, and different national interests, can we expect to see a revival of Arab nationalism, and if so, how would that affect the relationship between the Arab world and the West?

The September attacks and the American war on terrorism have really thrown every part of the Arab–Islamic world into a new stage in which every country, every leader, and every regime must make some basic decisions. You can go across the entire region and look at what they are doing. Every case will be individual, but it is kind of like a gunshot that causes a row of birds to fly up in the air. Whether they come down on the same wire or come down on trees or some place else

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It is significant that Crown Prince Abdullah has taken this initiative. Iran and Iraq and a couple others will never agree with this, but if Saudi Arabia joins the two Arab states that have made peace with Israel—Egypt and Jordan—that creates a block in the eastern Mediterranean that can transform the whole matter.

we do not know, they are up in the air now. So, there is no answer to the question.

If you look at Pakistan—when President Bush asked if you were with us or against us—Pakistan, under General Musharraf, has clearly said they are with us. That is a major change for Pakistan and is very risky for Musharraf and for the Pakistani government. But he did it right away because he recognized that if he did not, there would not be a Pakistan. The terrorists were in control of large parts of the country. They had infiltrated into the military and the intelligence services. He had either to give the country to the terrorists or decide that this was an opportunity to clean this mess up and he decided to clean it up.

So, it was definitely a bold and brave thing for him to do and the United States is supporting him and Pakistan very much right now. You can go right down the line. You can go to Yemen where something similar has happened. The President of Yemen has made some similar decisions. You get the Yemeni in clashes with terrorists or with groups that they have not been able to control in the past, but now they have been emboldened by this American movement. They have recognized that there is a network of terrorism internationally and they are going after it. You can see changes in Syria and Libya, even though we do not know where they are going to go.

The decision of Saudi Arabia to proffer that positive initiative for the peace process is another thing. Entire regimes are in flux. Generally, it seems to be going in the right direction, but you cannot tell if it is going to continue at this point.

You mentioned Prince Abdullah's recent peace proposal. Do you see this proposal as a legitimate proposal that both sides would pursue and other Arab nations would mobilize to accept, despite the historical Arab enmity towards Israel and the widespread use of the Palestinian cause as a rallying cry for some of these regimes?

It is potentially extremely significant because this is the missing piece. The media and the Europeans and people who do not follow this closely have for years really misunderstood the whole question of the Israeli–Palestinian matter. They have regarded it as being these nasty Israelis who will not give the Palestinians a state, but in recent years, this simply has not been the case. The Israelis have accepted the necessity of a Palestinian state. Even the hardest of hardliners, Ariel Sharon, has said that this process will produce a Palestinian state. The problem has been that the Arabs will not accept an Israeli state. So, the negotiations really cannot succeed as long as that is the case.

Without the media really catching on to it, over the last couple of years, the terrorists have taken over the Palestinian side of the problem, pushing Arafat out or terrifying Arafat so that he cannot make decisions. This is the reason why Arafat could not respond to immensely far–reaching concessions made at Camp David in July of 2000. He simply would not talk because if he did anything, the terrorists were going to get him.

The Israeli–Palestinian struggle that is going on is the main active front of the war on terrorism because the terrorists will not accept any Israeli state. Their goal is the eradication of the Jews from Israel and the

eradication of Israel itself. So, until the terrorists are suppressed, there cannot be any successful negotiations.

It is significant that Crown Prince Abdullah has taken this initiative. Then again, we don't know how much of an initiative it is yet. It is still very amorphous, but it is the key part—though it will probably never be a position that will be subscribed to by the entire Arab–Islamic world. I expect we are going to see Iran and Iraq and a couple others say we will never agree with this, but if Saudi Arabia joins the two Arab states that have made peace with Israel—Egypt and Jordan—that creates a block in the eastern Mediterranean that can transform the whole matter. But it's still a very tricky thing to do. How do you structure it? How do you phase it? What are the details of it? In itself, it is the missing piece. I have been saying this for years now, and people would tell me I am crazy, but this is the missing piece and it has come forward. So, it has to be worked with great care and great energy.

In Pakistan, you mentioned that the balance of power has shifted from the terrorists to General Musharraf. Can this balance of power also shift from the terrorists to the Palestinian Authority?

The terrorists have to be defeated. That is the key point. So, if you look at Musharraf, he is now out to defeat the terrorists in Pakistan. We have defeated the terrorists in Afghanistan, but there are other levels and kinds of terrorism that need to be suppressed, and one of them, perhaps the most significant, is to defeat the terrorists in the West Bank and Gaza. That means the worst possible thing is a cease–fire. If there is a cease–fire, it will just give the terrorists time to reorganize and gain strength again because right now, they are pretty much on the run. They are still initiating fighting in a violent way, but as this goes on over the weeks, the Israeli forces are winning. They are running a lot of long–range patrols into the territories and reining in and killing a lot of people. They have to kill more people because if you do not kill these people they will go underground and come back at you later. So, this is as much a war against terrorism as the war in Afghanistan against Al–Qaida and the Taliban.

The second thing is that the Saudis must stop funding terrorist incubators, which they have been doing for years and years. The same is true in a similar sense with Iran. There is been sort of an informal competition between Saudi Sunni–Wahabbe Islam and Iranian Shia Islam. These two countries have spent a lot of money to spread their particular version of Islam around the region and around the world.

The Iranians have primarily focused on areas where there are Shiites: Lebanon, primarily with the Hezbollah. The Iranians have been supporting that in ways that we have to simply find ways to stop. The Saudis have a much wider net, building mosques and madrassas for kids essentially in Pakistan and Afghanistan, and also supporting mosques in Hamburg, in England, in Galveston, in Oakland, and in Baltimore, which are breeding grounds for terrorists.

The Saudis run a bad regime. It is not a representative regime. It is a regime that if there were no oil—as is true in the Arab world in general—would rank below Africa on the development scale. So, the regimes they have run have not been in any way effective, and they know that. There has been resistance to them, but they have used massive propaganda and funds to direct their own population's animosity outwards.

This is true in several Arab countries, which get rid of a lot of the most troublesome people, but then they go off to the communities in northern Europe or in Britain, where they are supported indirectly by subsidies from the Saudis. So, that has got to stop. That is something that generates one generation after another of terrorists—young men who have no skills, no knowledge, and no breadth of understanding of anything except the Koran and

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killing people. And third, the liberal and lovely democracies of Western Europe and North America have got to get their own situations under control and not let these kind of people come in at will to set up these cells inside these countries.

You mention some of the more moderate governments, such as Abdullah's Jordan and Mubarak's Egypt, which seem worlds apart from the radical Islamic governments like that of Iran. With the idea of a Palestinian state being seriously discussed, do you predict the future Palestinian government to resemble more closely the former or the latter? In other words, do you believe a future Palestinian state will be governed by a legitimate, moderate government or do see Hamas or Islamic Jihad continuing to exert their collective wills?

If Hamas or Islamic Jihad takes over, there will just be war. The Israelis will invade and just crush them. So, the Palestinian state must be run by responsible people who want to be part of the approach that has been taken by Jordan, Egypt and, we hope, Saudi Arabia in the future. That state has to be under certain self–accepted restrictions. It cannot have a major military. It also has to be given tremendous economic and developmental support. Just pour it in there, so it can be a place where young people can really have a future chance to better themselves and their children.

What needs to be done is to declare a Palestinian state upfront right away and then negotiate the details of it because that state would then have the pressures to be a good international citizen.

Right now Palestine is not a state, and, therefore, it is not accountable. It is just several groups vying for control over their attitude towards Israel. Going back to the first question, the most radical, the most Islamic, wins the argument because Islam gets into the politics. So, in that situation, moderation is almost impossible because any time anybody says you are not Islamic enough for me, that person wins the argument.

A state that is recognized by the U.S. and the Europeans and the Israelis and the Saudis would become the unit of accountability and that is where we get back to the international system that the world works on, which is a system of states. The state is the unit of accountability that would take away the Islamic confusion about what the politics of all this will be. It will then, I think, be better able to negotiate on a level of equality with Israel.

With the amount of money generated from oil revenue, we would have expected prosperity to lead the Arab nations to enter the first world. Without a culture of democracy, however, is that ever possible?

Democracy would really induce and compel the regimes to put the money into their own development. Oil revenues are going down. Saudi Arabia feels really squeezed now, because they have established with their money such a gigantic welfare state. It is been kind of a giant bribe, but that money has been going down. They do not invest really in their own country, and they do not let foreign investment come in because it is not Islamic.

We always hear from scholars of Islam that democracy is perfectly compatible with Islam, but it never happens. The only way out of this is the way Turkey has done it. It says it is Islamic, but it does not let Islam get into the politics. Turkey is not by any means a perfect democracy, but it is certainly tilting in that direction. If you can follow the Turkish example throughout the Arab–Islamic world, then there is hope for it. If you cannot, there is no hope for it and then I think the whole region will subside into chaos and more failure. These countries in the Arab world have to come to their senses and realize that they have a very deleterious cultural set of factors to contend with.

Primarily, there are conspiracy theories where everything that happens is a conspiracy. Everything that happens is somebody else's fault. Whether it is good or bad, it is not me, it is somebody else out there that is doing it. You can see that in some countries, and when it takes hold, it will absolutely ruin a country and its culture. There is a conspiracy belt in the world, and the conspiracy belt goes along the Mediterranean, all the way across this area that runs from North Africa to the South East Asian islands. It is a mental disease and they just have to get out of it because as long as any people think that is the answer to any problem– that it is somebody else's fault—they have no hope.

We always hear from scholars of Islam that democracy is perfectly compatible with Islam, but it never happens. The only way out of this is the way Turkey has done it. It says it is Islamic, but it does not let Islam get into the politics.

THE MYTH OF REFORM IN IRAN

DEBUNKING THE KHATAMI MIRAGE

By Michael Rubin

On May 26, 1997, Iranians overwhelmingly elected Muhammad Khatami to be the fifth president of the Islamic Republic. Khatami won nearly 70 percent of the vote in elections marked by 80 percent turnout. *The New York Times* was euphoric, declaring in an editorial that same day that Khatami was "dedicated to relaxing or eliminating the political and religious repression that has long disfigured" Iran.

Such a characterization of Khatami has stuck. Today, a number of present and former officials, as well as prominent academics and commentators, describe Khatami as a reformist and the Islamic Republic as moderating. On February 12, 2002, Robin Wright, the staff writer for the

Los Angeles Times labeled the Iranian president "the country's leading reformer." Senator Chuck Hagel (R–Ne.) told CNBC's *Hardball* the following week that George Bush's "Axis of Evil" speech "made it more difficult for Khatami and the reformist forces in Iran." A public myth has developed that the United States has a reliable partner for discussion in Iran. In an essay published in *The Age of Terror: America and the World after September 11*, eminent Yale diplomatic historian John Lewis Gaddis declared that Iran has been "moving toward free elections and a parliamentary system." Unfortunately, Gaddis ignored the fact that the Iranian government had disqualified 234 out of 238 candidates prior to the election because they were too secular or pro–reform. Nevertheless, Gaddis criticized the United States for doing "nothing to adjust policy."

But, does the myth of top–down reform in Iran have any basis in fact? There is no doubt that among the vast majority of the Iranian population, people crave true reform. But is the reform versus hardline dichotomy within the Islamic Republic real, or more a creation of the Western media? After all, almost five years into Khatami's rule, there have been no substantive reforms. Indeed, freedom in many ways has diminished. Perhaps rather than being a true reformer, Khatami is merely engaged in a carefully choreographed dance with Supreme Leader Ayatollah 'Ali Khamenei to win the Islamic Republic diplomatic and domestic space from audiences willing to accept rhetoric over reality.

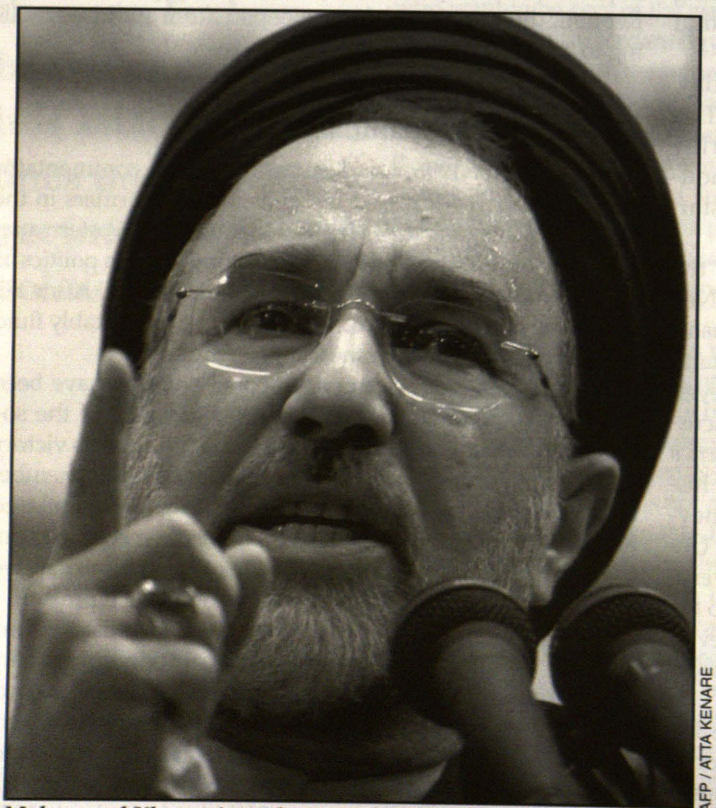
The Myth of Muhammad Khatami

In December 1996, London–based Iranian commentator Ali Nourizadeh addressed the question of reformers in the Saudi news magazine *al–Majalla*. He cautioned Western analysts and journalists to be wary of viewing Iranian politics as a dichotomy between hardliners and reformers. After all, within the Iranian discourse, such terms are remarkably fluid and often devoid of clear meaning, he argued.

Nevertheless, many American commentators have been less than cautious in their enthusiastic embrace of the so–called reformists like Khatami. Following the election victory of Khatami, former National Security Council staff member and Columbia University professor Gary Sick declared Khatami to be "a reformer with an outspoken commitment to civil society, social justice, the rule of law and expanded freedom."[1] Is Khatami's record deserving of such praise?

Between 1982 and 1992, Khatami served as Minister of Culture and Islamic Guidance, and so was among the primary ideologues shaping the Islamic Revolution. While Sick commented that "Khatami permitted the introduction of hundreds of original and provocative publications," the fact remains that Khatami censored over 600 publications.[2] Is Khatami a supporter of democracy? Writing in *Keyhan* in 1980, Khatami declared, "Knowledge of God's commandment must be the foundation of individual and collective life...People are not able to comprehend God's will through the explanations contained in the Quran and Sunna. Acquiring such comprehension requires several years of studies and

In October, hundreds of thousands of Iranians took to the streets in worst anti–government riots since 1979. "Death to Khatami" and "We love the U.S.A." were among the chants.



AFP / ATTA KENARE

Muhammed Khatami speaks to students at Tehran University.

much effort."[3] In other words, democracy is fine so long as power is limited to the mullahs and ayatollahs. While words may translate nicely from language to language, analysts must take care that the intentions behind the words are not different.

But, even if the vast majority of viewpoints are excluded from political discourse in Iran (such is one purpose of the Council of Guardians), does Khatami truly support the rule of law? In his recently published memoirs, Grand Ayatollah Husayn 'Ali Montazeri described a 1988 purge of political prisoners, which resulted in the deaths of several thousands. Khatami was a member of the ruling council at the time, and intimately involved in passing the death sentences.

Khatami's record post–1997 is little better. Under Khatami, more than 50 newspapers have been banned and satellite dishes confiscated. In November, Iran's judiciary began the largest trial of political dissidents in over two decades. Public executions and stoning of women are on the increase. The legal age of marriage remains nine years old for females. Khatami does little to even speak on behalf of the oppressed. It should come as no surprise then, that in October 2001, hundreds of thousands of Iranians took to the streets in the worst anti–government riots since 1979. "Death to Khatami" and "We love the U.S.A." were among the chants. Iranians no longer trust Khatami's sincerity; it is ironic that Western policymakers do. While some commentators argue that the Iranian president is powerless to act because he does not control the centers of power, the sad fact is that Khatami has refused to exercise what powers he does have to speak up as his closest supporters are hauled off to prison. It should be no surprise that in December, reformist students at Tehran University heckled the president, calling on him to step down, and chanting, "Khatami, stop chanting slogans! Start acting!," and "Khatami, Khatami, Honesty, Honesty."[4]

Truth in Advertising: The Record of Iran Watchers and the U.S. Media

So is Khatami really a reformer, or is his reputation merely the result of a label arbitrarily bestowed by the Western media? To answer that question, it is useful to examine the track record of the Western press and some Iran experts.

In 1989, Ayatollah 'Ali Akbar Hashemi Rafsanjani ascended to the Iranian presidency. The Western press had already bestowed him with the "moderate" label. On October 24, 1988, a *Washington Post* headline referred to Rafsanjani as the "Voice of Moderation" in Iran, while *The Financial Times* called Rafsanjani the "pragmatic power behind the Revolution."[5] On August 5, 1989, *The Washington Post* published a front page article headlined, "After decade of enmity, a rhetorical reversal. New tone from Tehran raises U.S. hopes for normalizing relations." State Department spokesman Margaret Tutwiler was optimistic, though maintained a degree of caution, commenting, "President Rafsanjani's remarks appear to be moderate and are therefore encouraging."[6] Less than two weeks later, *The Washington Post* without any semblance of caution, declared, "Rafsanjani's ascendance to a new and more powerful presidencyÖindicated that more moderate forces were consolidating their control."[7] The proof? The appointment of "relatively moderate" Ayatollah Muhammad Yazdi to be head of the judiciary. If Yazdi is a moderate, then moderate in the Iranian context includes calls for banning reformist newspapers and executing Jews and Baha'is. One official within the Ministry of Culture and Islamic Guidance who had previously studied under Yazdi remarked to me shortly before Yazdi stepped down at the end of his 10–year term that no Iranian official "had more

blood on his hands than Muhammad Yazdi."[8]

So was Rafsanjani any more deserving of the 'moderate' label than Yazdi? Following the September 11, 2001 terror attacks in New York and Washington, Rafsanjani blamed the Zionists. Curiously, the Associated Press stringer in Tehran reported, "Iran's reformist and hard–line factions have found agreement by condemning Tuesday's terrorist attacksÖ."[9] (The Associated Press also missed the comments of both Foreign Minister Kamal Kharrazi and Khatami advisor and noted reformist Ataollah Mohajerani, both of whom blamed the Zionists and Jews)[10] as well as the hostile rhetoric of official Iranian dailies like *Keyhan* and the English–language *Tehran Times*).

Rafsanjani's again displayed his moderation when, on December 14, 2001, he mounted the podium at Tehran University to deliver the government's official weekly sermon. He slowly and purposely declared, "If one day, the Islamic world is also equipped with weapons like those that Israel possesses now, then the imperialists' strategy will reach a standstill because the use of even one nuclear bomb inside Israel will destroy everything."[11] Perhaps moderate would be an appropriate label so long as it includes advocacy of first strike use of nuclear weaponry.

The willingness by some State Department officials to ignore such high profile threats and statements is curious. Testifying before the Senate Foreign Relations Committee last December, State Department Policy Planning chief Richard Haass told the Senate Foreign Relations Committee that, "the pattern of Iranian behaviorÖdeserves to be labeled as constructive."[12] Then again, Haass has a long history of advocating engagement and rapprochement with Iran, albeit in reports and studies financed by oil companies.

Do the Experts Know How Iranians Feel?

Officials like Haass and politicians like Senator Arlen Specter (R–Pa.) advocate doing business with Iran. On October 24, 2001, after dining with Iran's United Nations ambassador at the Capitol, Specter declared, "We ought to consider turning over a new leaf and having a conversation with them."[13] However, the United States should base its policy toward Iran on reality rather than on the description of some experts and commentators, who have an unfortunate history of being completely wrong. Indeed, there is little accountability for commentators of the Iranian political scene. For example, in 1997, Gary Sick explained that Khatami's rise was made possible when "President Hashemi Rafsanjani, a highly popular figure, chose not to run again."[14] But if Rafsanjani really was so popular, then why during the 2000 parliamentary election did he come in 30th? Academics and journalists too numerous to mention uncritically accepted the heady rhetoric of Khatami's 1997 and 2001 election victories.

Students in Tehran stage a rally in front of the UN office urging action to release 10 Iranian diplomats held by the Taliban.

However, a far more glaring example of press misinterpretation of events in Iran came in *The New York Times'* reporting of the Iranian reaction to President Bush's "Axis of Evil" speech. In an article entitled "Millions in Iran rally against U.S.," correspondent Neil MacFarquhar reported:

The threats expressed by Mr. Bush and other administration officials over the last two weeks surprised many in Iran. In some ways, they have united the reformists and the old guard here in criticism of the United States; in other ways, they have strengthened the hand of the conservatives. "Any time we face international problems, democracy stops," said Ali Reza

Iranians no longer trust Khatami's sincerity; it is ironic that Western policymakers do.

Haghighi, a political science professor. "Now all the discourse must be against the Americans." Mr. Khatami worked to keep his reformist agenda aliveÖ "The stress on democracy is the soul of the Islamic Revolution."[15]

Unfortunately, MacFarquhar blindly accepted Iranian government estimates. Iranians who attended the rally estimated that no more than 200,000 were present. He also neglected to mention that most in attendance were state workers forced to attend. Most egregiously, MacFarquhar apparently did not realize that his source, Ali Reza Haghighi, is widely known to work for the Ministry of Islamic Guidance as the official in charge of foreign press. Thus, accepting the conventional wisdom of Khatami's reformism, *The New York Times* uncritically excepted the interpretation of Bush's State of the Union speech as explained to them by officials of the Islamic Republic. Based on the statements of Haghighi, the *Times* further editorialized upon Bush's speech, criticizing an American policy that was actually widely applauded by the vast majority of Iranians outside of the ruling circle.

Rather than being the personification of reform, Khatami unapologetically played a crucial role in the most damning human rights abuses of the Islamic regime.

Where Next for Iran?

Never in history has an ideological dictatorship voluntarily relinquished power. Iran has been no exception. Contrary to John Gaddis' assertion that Iran is moving toward democracy, the leadership of the Islamic Republic retains tight control over press and society. While Muhammad Khatami speaks eloquently of the need for reform and democracy, he has achieved little if anything in the space of nearly five years. Rather than being the personification of reform, Khatami unapologetically played a crucial role in the most damning human rights abuses of the Islamic regime. It is ironic that while many Iranians now question Khatami's sincerity, Western officials, commentators and journalists continue to judge Khatami by his words rather than by his actions. The resulting picture is often the Islamic Republic as liberal Westerners would like it to be, rather than Iranian society as it is. Acknowledging truth is the surest way to achieve real reform, rather than simply whitewash abuse.

Michael Rubin is an adjunct fellow at The Washington Institute, and the author of Into the Shadows: Radical Vigilantes in Khatami's Iran. *He is currently a resident at Hebrew University in Jerusalem, where he lectures in Iranian history and politics. A native of Philadelphia, he received a B.S. degree in biology from Yale University in 1994, and received a Ph.D. in history from the same institution in 1999.*

Notes

[1] Gary Sick. "U.S. can exploit peaceful Iran revolution." *Newsday*. June 11, 1997.

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[3] Muhammad Khatami, "A glance at the principle of the guardianship of the jurisprudent Islamology, the necessary and sufficient condition." *Keyhan*. November 25, 1980, as quoted in: Ladan and Roya Boroumand. "Illusion and Reality of Civil Society in Iran: An Ideological Debate." *Social Research*. June 22, 2000.

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[9] Ali Akbar Dareini. "Iranians condemn terror strikes." Associated Press. September 15, 2001.

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[13] Gary Sick. "U.S. Can Exploit Peaceful Iran Revolution." *Newsday*. June 11, 1997. A42.

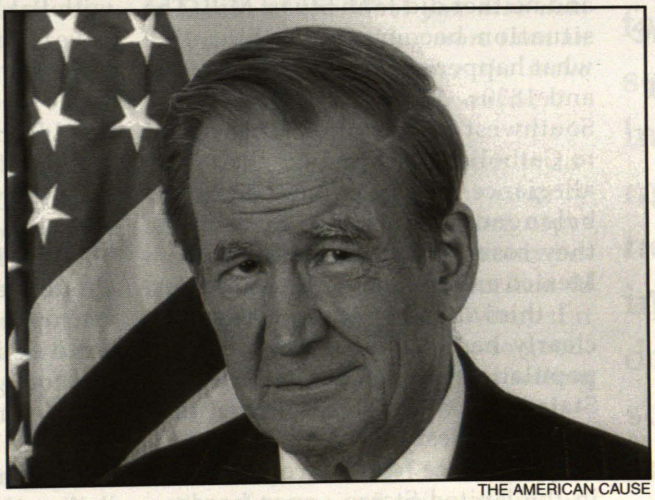
[14] Neil MacFarquhar. "Millions in Iran rally against U.S." *The New York Times*. February 12, 2002.

PAT BUCHANAN

HOW POPULATION DECLINE AND IMMIGRATION THREATEN WESTERN CIVILIZATION

AN INTERVIEW

Patrick J. Buchanan served as a confidant, assistant and speechwriter to Richard Nixon, an assistant to Gerald Ford, and from 1985 to 1987, he was the White House Communications Director under Ronald Reagan. Upon leaving the White House, Pat Buchanan became a nationally syndicated newspaper columnist, and a founder of three television talk shows: "Crossfire," "Capitol Gang" and "The McLaughlin Group." He is the best–selling author of Right From the Beginning, A Republic, Not an Empire, *and most recently,* Death of the West. *A three-time presidential candidate: twice as a Republican (1992, 1996) and once with the Reform Party (2000), Buchanan has garnered over seven million votes. On February 19, 2002, Pat Buchanan spoke with* The Politic *about his latest book.*



THE AMERICAN CAUSE

The Politic: Is the West Dead?

Patrick J. Buchanan: It is clearly dying. Not a single Western nation has emerged that will enable it to stay alive in its present form through the middle of this century. Europe's population, according to UN projections, will lose 125 million people by mid–century, which is the equivalent of the entire populations of Belgium, Holland, Norway, Denmark, Finland and Germany. Russia is going to lose 33 million people, and that may be a low projection. The Ukraine will go from 50 million to 30 million. Germany will lose 23 million people, and Italy will lose 16 million people. By mid–century, the median age of Spain and Italy, two of the most Catholic countries in Europe, will be 54 and 55 years old. That is almost 15 years older than the oldest country in the world today—Japan—and Japan is already dying. So clearly, the peoples of the West are dying out.

Your book argues that an erosion of Western values has taken place. Has this facilitated the population bust of Western Europe and America?

There is no question that there is a direct and absolute correlation between the death of faith and the death of a culture and its people. For example, in the town of New Square, New York, Judaism is a very vibrant, militant and orthodox faith. Families in New Square reportedly average 10 children. Whereas in secular Jewish communities today, they are among the oldest peoples in the United States. Like the rest of America's native born, they are dying out. In Utah, there is something of a baby boom, and that of course is the home of the Mormon faith, which is very dynamic today. Among Christian evangelicals, there is a healthy birthrate. But, it is among the secularized Americans who have really embraced this new faith of secularism, humanism, materialism, hedonism, individualism, *la dolce vita*, the sexual revolution and "let the good times roll" that all of these ideas are not reproducing themselves and dying out. I think that there is probably an even more absolute correlation than affluence to declining populations, the death of faith.

Many have argued that there has been a growing tolerance and acceptance of immigrants choosing not to assimilate into Western culture. What steps could western governments take to address what you label "the cracked melting pot?"

I think that the melting pot is broken. The Western

The problem is that the government of the United States, our "virtual democracy," does not reflect the desires or wills of the American family.

elites are now preaching "multiculturalism" and "multilingualism," and I think that leads to multi–nations. In the Southwest, the main problem is that you have what could be 25 million Mexican–Americans and Mexicans who are in this country, but want to remain proud Mexicans. They do not want to become American citizens. They want to retain their Spanish language and their Hispanic culture and heritage and not be part of an English–speaking nation. I do not see how the nation survives with two languages, and neither did John Stuart Mill. The situation becomes something like what happened in Texas in the 1820s and 1830s. Americans moved to the Southwest and nominally converted to Catholicism and nominally swore allegiance to Mexico, but their hearts belonged to America. Eventually, they rose up and broke away from Mexico and joined the United States.

I think the Mexican government clearly has in mind using this vast population of Mexicans in the United States as a fifth column. When they receive amnesty and become citizens, they will vote for Mexico's interests in the United States—open borders, dual citizenship, the right to vote in Mexico as well as the United States—and I think that when that happens, the United States ceases to exist.

You have proposed limitations on immigration through increased border security and immigration caps. How far can the United States go without compromising our nation's fundamental commitment to hope and economic opportunity?

AFP/HECTOR MATA

A sign at the U.S.–Mexico border near San Diego.

Between 1924 and 1965, the United States maintained its commitment to hope and opportunity and we had virtually zero immigration. That was a timeout. Every nation has a right to protect its borders. This is our national family, our national home. We decide who comes in, and when. We decide who will be adopted into the family and when. The problem is that the government of the United States, our "virtual democracy," does not reflect the desires or wills of the American family.

On the issue of open borders, the vast majority of Americans agree with Pat Buchanan, that we ought to have a moratorium on legal immigration. A halt for a period of years while we decide whether we are indeed losing the country we grew up in. With regard to illegal immigration, they want it halted even if it means using American troops on the border. I believe that both steps should be taken, and then we should attempt to integrate—and I use that word deliberately—the 30 or 40 million foreign born in this country right now, by immersing their children not only in the English language from kindergarten and the first grade, but in American history and teach them the glories of Western civilization and the United States of America. If we do not do these things, we are going to cease to be one country and one people. We are going to become an empire, rather than a republic, and that is not what the Founding Fathers intended.

In your book you state, "If America has ceased to be a Christian country, it is because she has ceased to be a democratic country," and on the following page you contend, "We do not live by majority rule in America. We live under the rule of minorities whose vision of what America ought to be is shared by five justices on the Supreme Court, most of whom not one in ten Americans could name." Is America no longer a democracy?

I think America, in the social and cultural realm, is living under a judicial dictatorship. We wait for the first Monday in October and subsequent Mondays to learn how we may be al-

lowed to live and govern ourselves. America was a Christian country; all of its institutions reflected this. Its presidents so stated—Harry Truman wrote to Pius XII in 1947 saying, "America is a Christian Country." He was echoing Woodrow Wilson. America's colonies and early states were founded as Christian endeavors. In the last 50 years, the Supreme Court has systematically de–Christianized America's public square, public institutions, and public schools. And since the government now consumes 33 percent of the GNP, this has been an extraordinary de–Christianization of America—as successful as what Stalin did in the Soviet Union.

All the prayers, the Our Fathers, the bibles, bible readings, bible study, the Christian holidays, Christmas carols, Easter vacations—all these have been expunged from the public schools and the public square by order of the Supreme Court; but 90 percent of the American people did not want it done. I believe the Supreme Court did it by a gross usurpation of power and a perversion of the Constitution, basically heeding a tiny minority, centered in the ACLU, which brought these cases before the Supreme Court. The Supreme Court would subsequently hand down these heedings to the entire nation, which essentially had no say in what it wanted done.

I think we are living under a judicial dictatorship, and it has been imposed by the Supreme Court. This is why we need justices who are counterrevolutionaries—justices who will overthrow this illegitimate revolution that has been imposed from above on the American people.

Has political correctness destroyed our ability to address such issues constructively?

Indeed it has, but it is our own fault. As I write in *The Death of the West*, we are an intimidated majority. We have allowed this soft tyranny to rise above us, to intimidate us and to threaten us with various brands of heresy—whether it is a homophobe, a racist, a sexist, a xenophobe—and these terms are used to brand people who bring up issues that are very much on the minds of American people, and they demand a course change in American Democracy.

Unfortunately, the fault lays, "Dear Brutus, not in our stars, but in ourselves"; that we are so meek and cowed. But there is no question that this is a very intolerant system, this political correctness, and if the American people will not stand up and overthrow it, they are going to lose their country.

In* Death of the West *you also ask, "Is our country nothing more than an economy?" yet you leave the issue unresolved. What is your answer?

The purpose of an economy is to advance the well being of the country and its people. And too many, especially Republicans, have not only become economists, but subscribed to the heresy of economism. Where if it adds to the GDP, it is de facto good. In so doing, I think they are selling out the interests of their nation—American sovereignty, the ideas of community, the belief in the preservation of towns and cities and industries, the ideas of economic patriotism—all these have been sacrificed on the alter of "the global economy," and we are giving up things far more valuable than all the Chinese goods down at the mall put together.

You point out some staggering population predictions for nations across Europe. What implications do these numbers hold for European security and stability?

I think Europe is dying, much faster than the United States. Overall, it has a birthrate of 1.4 children per women, which is about two-thirds of what you need to survive, and so there is not a single European country—except for Muslim Albania—where the population is not stagnant, aging and dying. In 20 countries already there are more burials than births. What does this portend for Europe? I think one of the things it portends is foreign policy paralysis, because the people coming in to re-

It is among the secularized Americans who have really embraced this new faith of secularism, humanism, materialism, hedonism, individualism, la dolce vita**, the sexual revolution, and "let the good times roll" that all of these ideas are not reproducing themselves and dying out.**

I think we should withdraw to the United States and we should adopt a foreign policy more consistent with what the Founding Fathers envisioned—of staying out of other nations' quarrels. If we do not, we shall know no end of war and no security or peace in our own homeland.

place the dying Europeans, the vanishing Europeans, are coming predominantly from the Islamic world, where you cannot find a single nation that is not exploding. As they move into Britain, France, and southern Spain and Italy from Albania, and come through Istanbul into the Balkans, these countries are increasingly paralyzed in dealing with the security threats coming from the Middle East and the near east, and we see Europe today breaking apart from the United States on the issue of sanctions on Iran, Iraq and Libya.

We see all of Europe bitterly opposed to another war on Iraq. We see all of them holding out their hand and trying to take the hand of the Mullahs in Iran, and one of the reasons they are is because they are far more vulnerable to terrorism since, relative to the US, they have very large Muslim populations. As the churches empty out and the mosques fill up in Europe, I think you are going to see a Europe unable to have a foreign policy because there will be deeply divided countries. Countries divided between the Islamic world and their own dead Christianity.

I see Europe really becoming sort of a boutique—one that is more interested in getting and spending than in the ideas and issues that animated the British, French, Russians and these countries a century ago. It is startling to realize that these countries like Britain, France, Germany, Austria, Italy, Russia, put into the field armies of millions of men earlier in the century. Now all of the European Union, with all of its wealth and population, has spent three or four years trying to dig up a Rapid Reaction Force of 60,000 troops. I think as major power players, the Europeans are finished.

If these major powers are finished, what does this spell for our own security and stability?

Well, I think the United States should have left NATO after the Cold War was over. It was a Cold War alliance designed to prevent the Red Army from overrunning Western Europe. With that threat removed and with Europe far more affluent than Russia, far more populous than Russia, and with Russia back inside borders smaller even than those that Peter the Great knew in 1715, I think Europe should be called upon to provide for its own defense and the United States should withdraw all forces from Europe. We are not the Romans; we are not going to stay there for 400 years. I think we should withdraw to the United States and we should adopt a foreign policy more consistent with what the Founding Fathers envisioned—of staying out of other nations' quarrels. If we do not, we shall know no end of war and no security or peace in our own homeland.

As these expanding populations in the Muslim nations immigrate to Europe, will this result in a conventional war?

I really do not think there is going to be a war. I think that Europe is dying. As it ages, and its median age rises—by mid–century, for example, there is going to be 60 million people over 80 years old—they are going to need people to take care of them. In Italy, for example, they are debating a law to deport illegal aliens; however, exceptions have been made for nannies who take care of the remaining children, and for caretakers who take care of the elderly. Secondly, Europe is going to need workers to pay the pensions and medical care for retirees and for the elderly. So they are going to need hundreds of millions of workers to replace the diminishing working population, and take care of the exploding elderly.

I do not see any great war coming, but I think you are going to have anti–immigration parties. The conservative parties will be very tough on immigration, but ultimately I think the need for workers is going to override the antipathy towards immigration that many Europeans feel. So, I think it is going to be, if you will, a peaceful conquest—similar to the current conquest of the Southwestern United States.

What can be done to prevent the Death of the West?

AFP FILE PHOTO

I do not know if anything can be done. But stopping the dying populations and raising the birthrate at least up to stabilization levels necessitate the massive conversion of tens of millions of American and Western women away from a belief system they have embraced. American and Western women now feel that *la dolce vita* is the good life. They want to participate fully in the economy, they want the same independence and freedom as men, and they do not want to stay home and raise children. Their idea of the good life is far different from that of their mothers and grandmothers. It is going to take a massive conversion in the area of religion or some great awakening. I do not think politicians of any stripe can do that, and no democratic government is going to force women to have children if they do not want to. I see this as somewhat inevitable in the absence of some great religious conversion, which I do not see right now. With regard to immigration, there are a lot of things that can be done to preserve the Western character of the American nation, but I do not know if the will is there.

I think economic interests, together with the steady and growing supply of low–wage labor competing with American labor, are overriding the national interest. It dominates both parties. Mr. Bush himself wants to give amnesty to illegal aliens, and if you do that you will have more of them. I do not think the will is there in either party. I am a moderate pessimist about the future of the West.

As a moderate Republican, how is Colin Powell handling his position as Secretary of State?

I think Powell has one foot in the traditionalist conservative camp in foreign policy, very much in a tradition I would call "modestly Buchananite" in that he believes we ought not to get involved in wars that are none of our business, and when we do go to war, we ought to go in and finish the job with overwhelming force and then get out and come home.

On defense and foreign policy, I count him as a conservative, but on social issues and even moral issues, he is very much a child of the counterculture and the Cultural Revolution in this country. He is pro–abortion, pro–affirmative action and pro–condoms in the schools. He is the Republican Party's responsibility, not mine.

As the churches empty out and the mosques fill up in Europe, I think you are going to see a Europe unable to have a foreign policy.

SEX: AN OUTLOOK ON CHANGING NORMS IN THE 21ST CENTURY

A GLOBAL SURVEY OF SEXUAL ATTITUDES

By Barbara Yu

From taboo to dinner table, censored to Skin-o-max, and Sandra Dee to Pamela Lee, people are talking about sex. Undoubtedly, the 21st century promises to continue to have us exploring, imagining and redefining this indelible force of human interaction. What trends do we currently see? Which factors are responsible for the continually morphing face of sexual relations? What are the implications within individual societies as well as between them?

For change to occur, it must hail from a distinct canvas projecting the scope and direction of sexual attitudes and evolution. Around the world, different societies have been shaped by varied collections of culture, politics and history. These contributions certainly overlap, forming an aggregate over time that comes to characterize each society.

An integral part of changing sexual norms in the United States involves an increasing acceptance of homosexuality. The highlighting of same-sex relations follows other movements related to empowering marginalized groups. Mobilized groups of African-Americans, women and the elderly have fought and achieved substantial rights through lobbying, demonstrating, and the passage of legislation. Increasingly, liberalized generations are creating a less judgmental society, where tolerance is widespread and advocacy is possible. In other words, the right to celebrate one's lifestyle has been incorporated into modernity. As a result of these generational changes, the rainbow triangle currently identifies more than one's homosexuality. It has turned into a prideful symbol, a reclaiming of self, and an unabashed affirmation of a pluralistic society.

At the same time, with increasing awareness of AIDS and other sexually transmitted diseases, sexuality as a private, moral judgment has been replaced by its position as a public health issue. At the Center for Disease Control's National STD Conference in San Diego earlier this year, findings indicated an increased health risk associated with homosexuality. A study conducted from 1988 to 1994 with 83 homosexual men found that 38 percent of these individuals were infected with HPV-16. This rate was five times that of straight men.

Public health in America has made its way onto the agenda of President Bush, who has been advancing an initiative to spend up to $135 million of 2003 federal funds for an abstinence-only campaign among the nation's youth. With an eye on eliminating unwanted pregnancy and climbing STD rates among young people, Bush's zero-tolerance message aims to curb the freedom that young people have been experiencing since the sexual revolution of the 1960s. However, this hard-line bill has not been fully embraced in Washington. Opponents in Congress have been pushing for an alternative bill that calls for $100 million to be spent on "abstinence plus contraception" education programs. Which plan is more effective? Certainly, the answer lies in the degree to which the state sees itself as involved in private decisions.

Across time and national boundaries, governments have often sought to exert their own judgments regarding the sexual behavior of their citizens, although this is not done explicitly. The results remain significant.

Take the China case. Under Chairman Mao Zedong, the Cultural Revolution that began in 1949 sought to eradicate prostitution and concubinage. Consequently, sex was effectively eliminated as a commodity. As China in the early 1980s entered an era of market socialism, state control over such matters decreased. The commercialization of sex emerged once again, and the increasing mobility and success of Chinese businessmen led to the proliferation of brothels and high-class bars, especially in rural/urban divide areas such as Jinghong in Yunnan province. After successful meetings and long work-hours, Chinese employers often reward their employees with rest and relaxation in places like Jinghong, where the consumption of women turns into a commercialized luxury and a symbol of socioeconomic prestige.

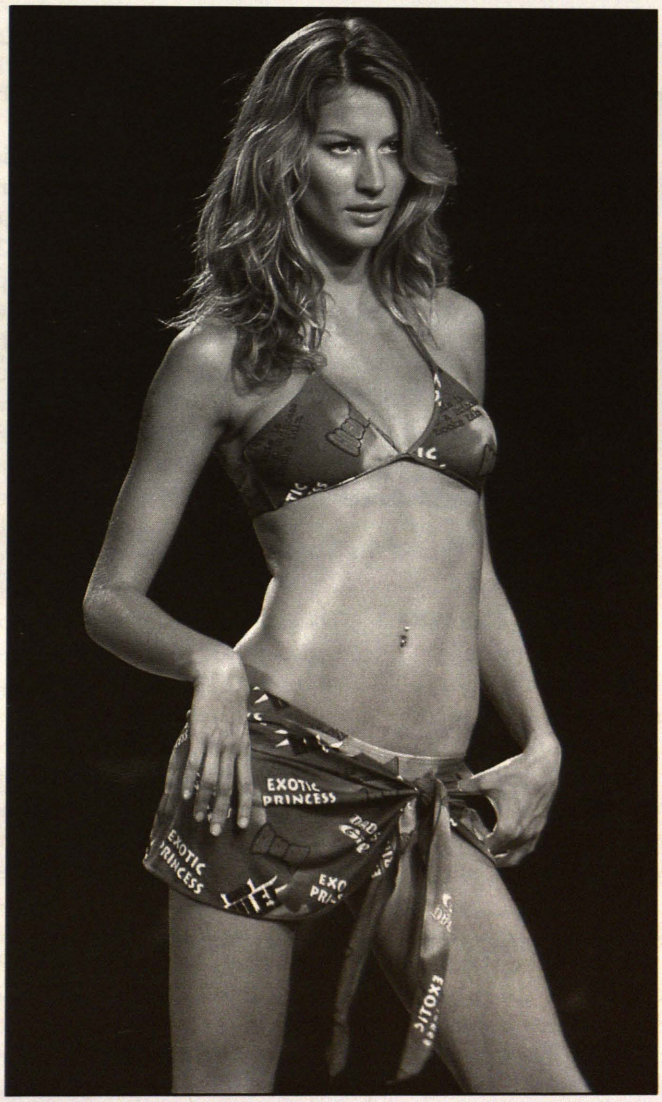
Despite the prevalence of these brothels and other sex tourism practices that are seen most commonly during wartime, the idea of sex as a socially unrestricted phenomenon is not entirely accurate. For example, in both China and Japan, few children are born

out of wedlock. These Confucian-based societies place a great emphasis on the value of family. Therefore, children born outside of marriage are stigmatized and virtually ignored by the government in terms of welfare policies. This seeming disparity seems to indicate that sex is a function of personal pleasure and reward, while family is a concern of the state.

Alternatively, in France, nearly 40 percent of children are born out of wedlock. Often, partners may live together until childbirth, after which they get married. However, the French government views all children as citizens, and help is given to those in need, regardless of marital status. Why does the state play such an important role? Sociology Professor Deborah Davis of Yale University argues that France embodies "a long, conservative tradition and cultural pride in the strength of family." Here we see two separate methods of government involvement in maintaining a strong family ideology. The explicit notion of sexual responsibility, however, is unmentioned.

In the United States, independence is valued above all else. Open discussions about sexuality are commonplace, even celebrated. The current legislative initiative to introduce a campaign targeted towards abstinence is a step towards governmental involvement, but the primary aim is to educate rather than enforce. In a hegemonic society, where Planned Parenthood clinics, sex chat rooms and a Rolling Stones feature on "Being Gay at Yale" are possible, any higher level of government involvement, even under the pretense of strengthening the family, would be irrelevant and met with harsh opposition.

As we look towards the future it will be interesting to observe whether these societies continue to develop along their respective trajectories. Or, on the other hand, we may find that within each society, the cultural and government norms regarding sexuality are not so embedded that sexuality among different countries will ultimately become less differentiated and more globalized.



AFP / MAURICIO LIMA

From taboo to dinner table, censored to Skin-o-max, and Sandra Dee to Pamela Lee, people are talking about sex. Undoubtedly, the 21st century promises to continue to have us exploring, imagining, and redefining this indelible force of human interaction.

Barbara Yu is a sophomore in Silliman College and business manager of The Politic.

LE MALAISE JAPANAISE

AN ECONOMIC DIAGNOSIS

By Arthur B. Laffer

It's common knowledge that Japan's economy and stock market are in a tailspin and have been for a long time. The facts raise serious questions: Exactly why is the Japanese economy so sick? By analogy, is there risk for the U.S. economy?

AFP / TORU YAMANAKA

Quite simply, Japan's cumulative unfunded liabilities quite simply are the reason for its poor economic performance. When viewed through the lens of demography, unfunded liabilities are magnified manifold in Japan. Large unfunded liabilities in Japan produce enormous disincentives to work, produce and invest—both in the present and in the foreseeable future.

Fortunately, the United States is light years ahead of Japan with respect to avoiding large unfunded liabilities and their consequences. In addition, whatever unfunded liabilities do exist in the United States are far less toxic than they would be in Japan because the demographic profile of the U.S. magnifies unfunded liabilities far less. Therefore, to extend the Japanese experience to the U.S. economy would be a mistake.

An existing unfunded liability in the most basic terms means that the present value of all currently obligated expenditures (employee benefits) exceeds the present value of all future employee contributions plus the current market value of pension assets. A deficiency (e.g. an unfunded liability) has to be eliminated by i.) reducing future benefits to retirees, ii.) increasing future contributions (taxes) or, iii.) an unanticipated rise in the value of pension assets.

My concern with the Japanese economy stems from the fact that unless future benefits are reduced dramatically, asset values in Japan will fall even further, thus forcing ever-larger increases in taxes to eliminate the unfunded liabilities. Of course it's a catch-22, because ever-higher taxes in turn reduce asset values, reduce employment, and encourage capital flight, all of which increase further the unfunded liabilities. If left to proceed on its own account, this vicious cycle becomes a death spiral.

Japanese demographics, consisting of low birth rates, a population projected to shrink starting in 2005, and increased life expectancy, come into play with unfunded liabilities because those ever-greater unfunded liability costs will be spread over ever-fewer workers, thus magnifying the implosive tax effects of the death spiral. In Japan it's analogous to putting your TV in your microwave. You can watch 60 minutes in thirty seconds.

The Japanese malaise did not occur overnight. It has accelerated during the past 13 years, exacerbated by a "triple whammy." First, assets backing Japanese corporate pensions are heavily invested in Japanese equities, which have fallen in value by some 75 percent since 1989. (During the same period, U.S. asset values rose 280 percent.) Second, because of Japan's rigid adherence to defined benefit plans, and their unwillingness to back them up with sufficient contributions, unfunded liabilities would have skyrocketed even without the fall in the value of pension assets. And thirdly, Japanese demographics imply that this huge surge in unfunded liabilities will fall on the shoulders of fewer and fewer workers in years to come. Will Japan come to its senses and legislatively eliminate the unfunded liabilities by moving to defined contribution plans, or will Japan eliminate its defined benefit plans by bankrupting the country? The plot thickens.

Contrast my view of Japan to how the rest of the world views the same data. It's fascinating to see how stark the differences are. The three conventional villains are:

i.) Monetary policy isn't stimulative enough, hence the "deflationary spiral"

ii.) Fiscal policy isn't expansionary enough, hence demand is falling

iii.)Banks and other institutions haven't "marked their assets to market," hence credit is contracting.

Without spending excessive time on the conventional wisdom, these ideas not only won't help Japan, but that they will make things considerably worse. Here's why:

i.) Expansive monetary policy will mean high inflation, a weak currency plus a bad economy. Japan, meet Jimmy Carter.

ii.) Marking Japanese bank assets to market will allow Japanese banks to make a whole lot of new bad loans. If that's not doubling down, I don't know what is.

iii.) Increasing deficits through government boondoggle spending only increases the fiscal overhang on future production. This precisely amounts to throwing kerosene on the fire. Enough's enough already.

All told, these altered incentives in Japan discourage participation in the Japanese economy, encourage emigration from Japan by young workers, and precipitate a steady stream of capital exiting Japan. These capital and labor outflows in turn reduce the productivity of the workers and capital which remain, creating a self–fulfilling downward death spiral. Every machine and every worker who leaves Japan increases the burden on those who remain.

Rising unemployment rates, and sustained Japanese trade surpluses/capital account deficits, are simply some of the visible symptoms of these changed incentives. They are not the cause of the problem. The cause of Japan's problems is the large unfunded liabilities and the future tax hikes they imply.

The economies of Japan and the U.S. have been moving in opposite directions for a long time. Almost to the point of being a cliché, commentators repeat the fact that the Nikkei was at 38,900 in December of 1989, while the Dow was at 2,750. Today the Nikkei is roughly equal to the Dow.

A change in Japan's pension plans is the *sine qua non* for a return of Japanese prosperity. Japan has a system of pension funds that is virtually all defined–benefit plans, rather than defined–contribution plans.

The problems stemming from defined benefit plans cannot be overstated, especially within the context of eroding demographics. With a defined benefit plan, a person contributes a percentage of his or her own salary to the company's pension fund during that person's working years. The company takes these contributions and invests them in all sorts of financial

A change in Japan's pension plans is the sine qua non **for a return of Japanese prosperity.**

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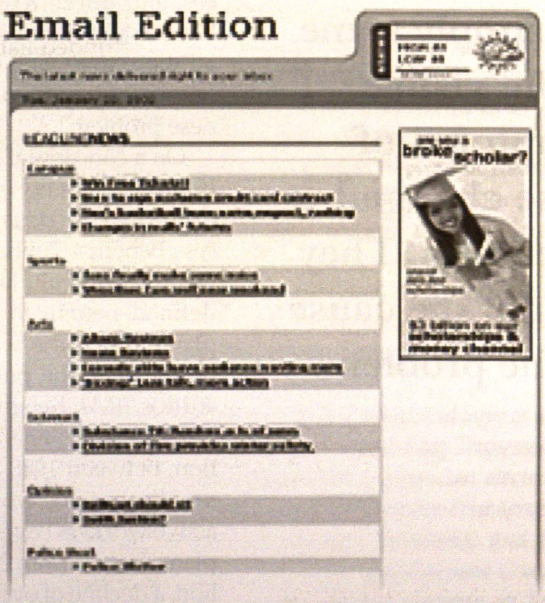

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Every machine and every worker who leaves Japan increases the burden on those who remain. Rising unemployment rates, and sustained Japanese trade surpluses/capital account deficits, are simply some of the visible symptoms of these changed incentives. They are not the cause of the problem.

assets including stocks and bonds. By the time the person gets to retirement age he or she will be guaranteed retirement benefits of various sorts until death. The theory has it that the worker's contributions to the pension fund plus the cumulative earnings on those funds will precisely cover the worker's benefits when retired. Now, of course, some workers live longer than others, earn more than others, etc., so the theory also asserts that overages and underages basically net out. When these actuarial overages and underages net out a pension fund is considered fully funded. And, as is the case of Japan today, when assets plus the value of future contributions are greatly deficient relative to the value of future benefits, the pension system is considered to have unfunded liabilities. Thus, if the economy of Japan weakens and asset values fall, any shortfall between what the retiree had put aside for retirement and what the retiree was promised would be made up by taxes on current employees or reduced profits of the company.

Given that a country's pension system has unfunded liabilities and that retirees' future benefits will be honored, then either contributions have to be increased, benefit deficiencies have to be financed out of company profits, or taxes have to be raised to finance the deficiencies. Given Japan's unfunded liabilities, the increases in taxes, future increases in contributions by employees, and future reductions in profits will have to be astounding. In fact, the sum of all these may well exceed total Japanese output for years and years. This is the Japanese problem.

On a conceptual level, getting rid of an unfunded liability is pretty simple. All the country has to do is legislate away the excess benefits. Politically, however, it may be quite difficult: Japan must move from defined–benefit to defined–contribution plans, much the way the U.S. has been doing over the past two decades with 401(k)s, IRAs, Keoghs, etc. According to the U.S. Pension Benefit Guaranty Corporation, between 1988 and 1996 (a period of rapidly growing workforce) the number of active workers covered by defined benefit plans *dropped* from 27.3 million to 22.6 million, a decline of over 20 percent. Total employment in the U.S. rose by 17 percent during this same period.

Even where the U.S. has not moved from defined–benefit plans to defined contribution plans, there have been major positive policy changes. For example, the age of retirement has been extended for Social Security, benefits have been cut (by taxing them), and the disincentive effects of retirement tests have been phased out.

Japan has only begun to make similar adjustments, and most will not be fully in place for 20 years or more. For example, the retirement age in Japan is scheduled to rise from 60 to 65, but the phase–in does not start until 2018. Benefits will be cut 20per cent, but slowly over the next 20 years. Mandatory employer/employee contributions are to increase by over 25 per cent, but again the full impact is not scheduled until 2025.

Japan has huge unfunded liabilities both in the corporate and public arenas, somewhere north of a trillion dollars in my estimation in the corporate sector alone. Just moving from defined benefit to defined contribution plans would on a static basis increase Japanese asset values by over a trillion dollars, bingo. That alone would constitute a 50 percent increase in Japanese equity values. But that's just the beginning. A much bigger Laffer Curve dynamic effect would also raise asset values further. And then just imagine what would happen if the public sector were reformed as well.

So would I recommend investing in Japan? Absolutely not. The unfunded liabilities are bad enough to deflate Japanese equities, but the "solutions" serve to make an already bad situation worse. However, don't think this pessimistic outlook will last forever. It won't. Someday, and that day may come sooner rather than later, the Japanese will figure out what's causing their malaise and then they will take the necessary steps to set things right. And when they do you won't believe the bull market Japan will experience. But don't hold your breath—it's not happening today.

Arthur B. Laffer, Ph.D., is the founder and chairman of Laffer Associates, an economic research and consulting firm. Dr. Laffer's economic acumen and influence in triggering a worldwide tax-cutting movement in the 1980s have earned him the distinction in many publications as "The Father of Supply-Side Economics." He is also a founding member of the Congressional Policy Board.

THE CHALLENGE OF THE 21ST CENTURY

THE SCOURGE OF AIDS

By William Frist

Each year, a staggering three million people die of AIDS and an additional six million more are infected with HIV–mostly in poor countries. Over the next 10 years, AIDS will have claimed the lives of more people than all those, both civilian and military, killed in World War II. In fact, AIDS is the greatest health challenge we will face in the 21st Century.

On a recent trip to Africa—one of the hardest hit regions—I learned firsthand about the human impact that a simple virus is having on the destruction of a continent. Globally, as many as 40 million are infected, and of those, 70 percent are in Africa. In Botswana alone, one out of every three individuals is infected.

The toll on families is incalculable. Thirteen million children have been orphaned by AIDS, mostly in Africa. Projections for the next 10 years are sobering. The orphan population may well grow to 40 million – a number equivalent to all children living east of the Mississippi River.

But Africa is not alone. India, with over four million cases, is on the edge of an explosive epidemic. China is estimated to have as many as 10 million infected persons. The Caribbean sadly boasts one of the highest rates of infection of any region in the world. Eastern Europe and Russia report the fastest growth of AIDS cases, increasing more than tenfold during a three year period. What's most shocking is that 90 percent of those infected do not know they have the disease.

As a ranking member of the Foreign Relations African Affairs Subcommittee, I have made a commitment to increase public awareness of the HIV pandemic in Africa and, most importantly, to develop a strategy to combat and eradicate the disease from the continent and the world. Just as our great nation is the leader in the war on terrorism, we must also continue to lead in the global battle against AIDS as we work to build a better, safer world.

A combination of leadership, prevention, treatment and funding will be necessary to fight the scourge of HIV/AIDS. In east Africa, I saw firsthand that many of the best ideas come from those working in the trenches to fight this disease. Local community participation is essential to this process, and local leadership is critical, as we work to prevent and treat HIV/AIDS.

AFP PHOTO

An AIDS patient in Cape Town.

With this in mind, leadership at all levels is needed to ensure that our efforts are well coordinated, and to enlist all stakeholders in the fight against HIV/AIDS. Coordination must come from within national governments as well as across them to ensure that resources aren't duplicated and that they are put to the best use.

Financial support is equally important. The United States' investment of $120 million over the last 10 years for Uganda has been instrumental in bringing new infection rates down from 32 percent to just over six percent in that country. We must continue to embrace the new Global Fund for HIV/AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria, and encourage other nations to provide resources to fight this disease. It is not a "UN-only" fund or an "American fund." It is a new way of doing business. Because science has been unable to produce a vaccine, prevention and treatment must be emphasized. With a combination of comprehensive national plans, donor support and community-based organizations, progress can be made. Pharmaceutical companies have already sent a message of hope by slashing prices on anti-retrovirals for poor countries. By focusing our efforts on supporting health care delivery systems – with a special emphasis on personnel training – we can help ensure effective treatment programs.

We must encourage people to be tested, for here is our real opportunity to save countless lives. The more people know about infection, the more likely they are to do something about it.

We should increase investments in rapid HIV testing kits and counseling for developing countries. Access to these testing tools helps reinforce prevention messages and guide treatment options.

As I saw in Africa, testing centers become havens of hope for a community – a place where those struggling with HIV/AIDS can share ideas, support each other, learn coping strategies, and receive medical treatment and nutritional support. I firmly believe that further support of their efforts is critical.

We face a long road ahead in the fight against HIV/AIDS. History will judge us as to how we as a nation – and as a global community – respond to the most devastating and destructive public health crisis we have seen since the bubonic plague ravaged Europe over 600 years ago. The task before us looms large, but by pulling together, with leadership from all, we will eliminate the scourge of HIV/AIDS from the face of the earth.

William Frist is in his second term as a United States Senator representing Tennessee. He is the first practicing physician elected to the Senate since 1928. Senator Frist serves on the Budget; Foreign Relations; and Health, Education, Labor and Pensions Committees, and is the ranking member on both the Subcommittee of Public Health and the Subcommittee on African Affairs. In 1999, he was named Deputy Whip of the Senate.

THE END OF IRRATIONAL MEDICARE

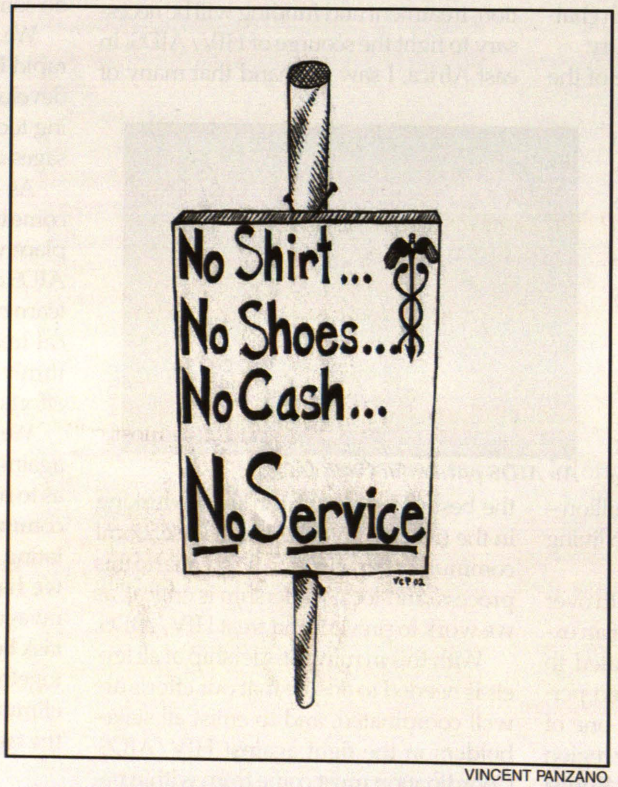
REFORMING U.S. HEALTH CARE

By Howard Forman

Rational members of the U.S. Congress are rightfully approaching the current budgeting process with trepidation, as many fiscal and economic threats have conspired to eliminate our budget surplus even before we get a chance to marvel at the accomplishment. There are many new demands on our budget, not the least of which evolved from our September of Infamy. In this climate, social services are fighting to keep their head above water and governmental agencies are fighting extinction or destruction. Thus, it would be surprising to hear that some of the most moderate members of Congress are proposing a prescription drug benefit expansion for Medicare that will likely require $500 billion or more, over the next decade. The AARP has, in fact, quoted a figure of $750 billion for this new plan and other needed reforms.

Why now? Why change Medicare at a time when the so-called "locked-box" of social security and Medicare has already been picked? Why risk an increasing debt burden for future generations for a new benefit for the elderly? What could possess rational people to want to go shopping when we reached our credit limit?

The answer to all these questions is quite simple: because it is the right thing to do. Because it is a historical accident that we do not already include prescription drug insurance in the safety net for our elderly. Because the growth in out-of-pocket expenses among the elderly for prescription drugs is already so wildly out of control that, each day, thousands and thousands of our most vulnerable citizens make a choice between food or healthcare.



VINCENT PANZANO

In just the two decades that I have trained in and practiced medicine, prescription drugs have radically altered our treatment and management of most diseases. For those who have access and can afford it, it means a far better quality of life, with less depression, heart disease, fewer complications from diabetes, and a markedly reduced need for hospitalization and doctor's services. When an elderly person has to make a decision between an anti-depressant and food, he or she might wisely choose food. Ultimately, however, complications of depression can lead to further medical illness or hospitalization, both of which will be covered, at far greater expense. When patients have mild, sub-clinical heart disease, it is hard to demand that they should buy expensive drugs, when rent payments are due. Ultimately, congestive heart failure, a heart attack or a stroke may ensue and the costs to society, let alone the person and his or her family, will be ever greater.

In the next decade, prescription drug costs will surpass all other components of our health care spending, other than hospitalization. There is no one, of any political persuasion that would argue that prescription drugs were intentionally left out of Medicare and, similarly no rational person would ever want to be forced to do without these life-saving medications. Irrational exuberance is ending; Let us start talking about rational health and welfare for our elder citizens. There will never be an easy way or time to do it. That's why we need to do it NOW!

Howard P. Forman, MD, MBA, is a Health Economist and physician at Yale University. He is an Assistant Professor at the School of Management. He is also the Vice Chair for Finance and Administration of the Department of Radiology at the Yale Medical School.

GLOBAL WARMING

COPING WITH THE REALITIES OF CLIMATE CHANGE

By Francis Beinecke

Global warming is one of the defining problems of this century. If we do not act to curb it, it will become *the* defining problem of the next century. In 1995, the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change—an international committee of more than 2000 scientists—determined that "the balance of the evidence" showed that global warming is upon us. In 2001, the panel found that "an increasing body of observations gives a collective picture of a warming world," and that new, stronger evidence indicated that most of the warming is caused by humans. The panel also found that the earth is warming faster than earlier estimates predicted. Its projections of an increase in globally averaged surface temperature—1.4 to 5..8 degrees Celsius from 1990 to 2100—sound small in terms of local surface temperatures. But that increase is two to ten times larger than the warming we have already experienced in the past century. In fact, the speed of the warming will probably be faster than anything in the past 10,000 years.

Global warming has the potential to bring change everywhere on the earth—change of the most varied kind, from local ecological disturbances to national catastrophes. In Alaska, there are roads that have buckled and streetlights that lean at drunken angles because the permafrost is melting. In the northeastern United States, insurance companies have begun to charge extra for hurricane coverage. In England, the ranges of many birds have shifted northward. In Bangladesh and India, the worst monsoon floods in a century took place a year and a half ago, killing more than a thousand people and driving 2 million people from their homes in late 2000. In Antarctica, an ice shelf that existed for 12,000 years recently disintegrated at a speed that stunned scientists.

It is impossible for scientists to determine whether these phenomena were caused by global warming. What is certain is that these are precisely the kinds of events we will see in a warming world. If global warming continues unchecked, it may bring suffering and death to many thousands of people in poor countries through flooding and drought; erase small island nations from the map; cause untold numbers of extinctions; spread tropical diseases beyond their historical boundaries; and transform ecosystems across every continent.

Americans account for 25 percent of the world's use of fossil fuels and 25 percent of the world's emissions of carbon dioxide, the main greenhouse gas trapping heat in the atmosphere. Because we are the biggest culprits, Americans also have the most power to solve the problem. Energy efficiency measures and renewable energy technologies– such as solar and wind power and fuel cells– can be put into place immediately to reduce our dependence on fossil fuels (the principal cause of the warming). In the long term, we can build these technologies into the energy foundation of our economy.

The two most critical sources of U.S. carbon emissions are power plants, especially coal–fired power plants, and gasoline–powered automobiles. These are heavily polluting technologies—major causes of ozone smog, acid rain, fine particle pollution, and environmentally destructive drilling and mining, as well as global warming. By all rights, they should be obsolete by now.

Electricity

Electric power plants generate 40 percent of U.S. carbon dioxide emissions– more than any other source in the United States. In the near term, we must build economic incentives for efficiency into the electricity system, so that utilities are rewarded for helping their customers save energy and not just for selling their customers more energy. In California, for instance, energy efficiency investments have saved $2.8 billion statewide in electricity bills since 1990. We must also start getting more electricity from plants running on natural gas, which is the cleanest fossil fuel. The new "combined–cycle" natural gas plants put out about 60 percent less carbon dioxide than coal–fired power plants.

But natural gas should only be an interim transition to an electricity sector based on wind, solar, and geothermal power,

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biomass, and fuel cells. At prime sites, the cost of electricity from wind turbines is now on the verge of matching or beating the cost of electricity generated with fossil fuels. The costs of solar and geothermal power are also coming down as photovoltaic technology and geothermal plants improve; California gets 5 per cent of its electricity supply via heat from the earth's core. Environmentally sound biomass–generated electricity can emit zero carbon dioxide and very low levels of other pollutants. Serious federal R&D investment in these technologies will bring the costs down dramatically.

Automobiles

Ending our gasoline habit will not only help stop global warming, but it will also give us energy security. This country has only 3 percent of known oil reserves, so the idea that we can drill our way to energy independence is a mirage. The only way for the United States to become independent of the oil–producing nations is to become independent of oil. To do so, we must start driving hybrid vehicles, powered by electricity as well as gasoline, as a transition to the carbon–free automobile of the future: the solar–powered fuel cell car.

We can cut our oil demand in half by 2020 if we build better vehicles and make better fuels. Automakers have all the tools they need to boost the average gas mileage of new passenger vehicles—that are both efficient *and* safe– to 40 mpg. By increasing their production of gas–electric hybrid vehicles, they could raise the overall fuel efficiency of new vehicles to 55 mpg by 2020. We can also cut our petroleum use by changing our gasoline mix–steadily increasing the percentage requirements for ethanol made from crop waste, for example.

National incentives and requirements for building hydrogen–powered fuel–cell vehicles could ramp up production to 100,000 vehicles by 2010 and 2.5 million by 2020. These vehicles will use one–third the energy of today's cars and produce near–zero harmful emissions. Ultimately, fuel cells running on hydrogen derived from solar power, rather than natural gas, will require zero fossil fuels.

Getting these two solutions on track will require intensive political work in Congress. To start changing the electricity generation industry, we need legislation that requires power plants to cut their carbon dioxide emissions. Voluntary measures have not and will not work. The point isn't just to reduce pollution. It's to get carbon legally recognized in this country, for the first time, as a dangerous pollutant. Senator Jim Jeffords (I–VT) has introduced just such a law: the "4P" or "four–pollutant" bill, named for the four major coal plant pollutants (mercury, sulfur oxides, nitrogen oxide, and carbon dioxide). We must also move Congress toward passing stronger fuel economy standards for passenger vehicles. A recent far–sighted bill sponsored by Senators Kerry and McCain would have saved two million barrels of oil a day by 2020, more than we now import from Saudi Arabia. The Senate voted it down in March.

Enormous political obstacles continue to block the way. The oil industry's battalions of lobbyists and considerable campaign donations have secured large–scale subsidies and privileged access to public lands for the industry. The auto industry has blocked automobile fuel economy reform by successive administrations and in Congress for many years. Under President George W. Bush, the executive branch is made up of friends and executives of the oil and coal industries. The administration drafted its national energy plan in consultation with fossil fuel interests, and rushed it through Congress as an energy bill that provides billions of dollars in subsidies for the fossil fuel and nuclear energy industries but little for energy efficiency or renewable energy. The administration has also released a "global warming plan" that calls for carbon dioxide emissions to *increase* by 14 percent over the next ten years. That is exactly the rate of increase of the past ten years.

But we also have many dedicated environmental champions in Congress. And we have the tide of public opinion swinging our way again, as the shock of September 11 subsides and people begin to refocus on their traditional priorities. With more information coming out every day, as the temperature records keep breaking and the ice shelves keep melting, these trends will accelerate. Environmental groups will push the process by shining a light on just how wrongheaded U.S. energy policy is.

Yes, this is a hard time for the environment. But I believe this is the last time the American people will stand for delay on global warming. We must—and we can—make sure that these years are the last hurrah of the fossil fuel cowboys.

Frances Beinecke is the Executive Director of the Natural Resource Defense Council, a non–profit organization dedicated to public health and environmental issues.

NADINE STROSSEN

CIVIL LIBERTIES IN THE NEW CENTURY

AN INTERVIEW

The Politic: What do you consider the most glaring and dangerous examples of how racial profiling is applied in society today?

Nadine Strossen: The most obviously publicized example is "driving while black." However, that issue has become almost passé, not in terms of the problem having gone away, but rather it was the issue to which we were able to initially draw the most public awareness. From this stepping–stone, we were able to acknowledge that the problem occurs and that it is wrong. The ACLU actually had a poster that made that point very effectively, and the poster has been shown to galvanize a lot of concern and interest in racial profiling. However, this example of its application continues to be a problem, for only yesterday I read of difficulties in racial profiling on a section of New Jersey roadways.

The application of airport security, as well, has always been a challenge to civil liberties when racial profiling is used. The problem had originally been specific to African-American women, and we have had a couple of lawsuits against various airports, government officials and airlines on that very issue. Alongside these court cases, the situation has improved dramatically since Ray Kelly took the helm of the U.S. Customs Agency under the Clinton administration. He really took these issues in stride, changing internal policies and directives quite successfully to prevent such flagrant abuses. I personally believe that the problem is under control, but I cannot comment if things have regressed with the changing of administrations. Kelly was excellent, and he is taking the same strong stand against racial profiling as the New York City police chief. Only a few weeks after taking the job, he issued a very strong statement to New York City Police condemning the use of racial profiling. That is the first time that it has ever been done.

In the end, however, all of these fairly traditional pitfalls and examples continue. The fanged version of it, post 9/11, is profiling based on national origin and religion. This 'screening' has been seen in multiple contexts, most notably in airports, where many people are being singled out for a particular level of surveillance. In the worst cases, these people are being removed from planes simply because they "make people feel uncomfortable." All of these cases have resulted in a number of lawsuits that are currently making their way through the legal system. Congressman John Conyers held a hearing in January in which there were powerful testimonies given by some of the plaintiffs in those lawsuits. The U.S. government itself has engaged itself in profiling while exercising of its powers of surveillance, detention and interrogation. Such inequitable profiling is present in the government's power to enforce immigration laws, which are applied in a selective manner, becoming restrictive on those individuals from countries which are known to, or are believed to, train or harbor terrorists.

With each of these examples you have mentioned litigation. Does the ACLU believe that this is the most effective strategy in challenging racial profiling, or does it rely more heavily upon legislative lobbying and other tactics?

We really rely upon a mixed bag approach on all issues and major fronts—from litigation, to legislation, to public education. Our campaign against racial profiling, which started several years ago, is multi–pronged. However, it began with a heavily focused communications campaign. In that effort, we started placing eye–grabbing advertisements in major national newspapers, while also targeting minority neighborhoods in various cities via billboards, radio and television. All of these ads had 1–800 numbers so people could call to forward descriptions of their experiences with racial profiling, generating a tremendous response in several ways: First, it provided the initial exposure to what would become several public lawsuits. Second, it generated momentum for legislative reform at national, state and local levels, galvanizing community organizing and activism. Finally, it helped propel an ongoing form of activism.

We have worked very closely with many agencies—federal, state, and local—around the entire country. Often the various police departments will contact us, asking us to provide training, material, and sessions on how to combat racial profiling. These actions are all interconnected, victory in one arena propels progress in others. I would say litigation, from my experience, is more difficult than some of the other strategies. Such suits serve their purpose, however, in bringing attention to an issue and showing the need for reform, even if under what I believe to be the law's unfair standards the

lawsuits are harder than they should be to prove.

Many people hold the position that while racial profiling is an evil, in the face of current global challenges to security, it is an acceptable evil that provides more for the common good than harm. Along the same lines, despite its often–vocal criticism, the successes of crime prevention in New York have led many to applaud the stricter policing tactics in the Guiliani era. How do you respond to such a criticism?

That philosophy is of the sort that I have had to face when addressing all violations of civil liberties post–9/11. Of course, any rational person would be willing to give up some freedom to gain security, unless that is you have some suicidal tendency—which I certainly do not. However, correspondingly, no rational person would be willing to give up any freedom, and should not tolerate forfeiting of other people's rights if no national security benefit is gained. It is essential on all of these issues to make the point that these measures are no more effective in terms of promoting security than they are defensible in terms of civil liberties. Thus, they are the worst of both worlds.

Look back at WWII where 110,000 Japanese–Americans lost their freedom, not to mention their property, with no countervailing gain to national security. There was no evidence of them posing any threat to our security. We would be foolhardy to repeat the same mistake.

Many national security experts and law enforcement officials have been highly critical of ethnic and religious profiling post–9/11, specifically from a security point of view. In fact, many have said that one of the main reasons for our government's colossal failure to protect us on September 11 is that it relied too heavily on racial profiling, focusing more on who people are, rather than what they do. I don't see the two as a trade off, it is a situation that is violating rights without security gain. Look back at the WWII situation of 110,000 Japanese–Americans losing their freedom, not to mention their property, with literally no countervailing gain to national security. There was not one iota of evidence of them posing any threat to our security. We would be foolhardy to repeat the same mistake.

Looking back on our national history, the infringements on civil liberties that have taken place during national crises, like in the case of the Japanese–Americans you just described, always seemed to have resolved themselves due to the finality of the situation. The nature of our current situation shows itself to be a long, protracted struggle ahead of us, with no immediate resolution in sight. Should we be more weary in turn, and what does that mean for the ACLU and the road ahead for all Americans?

I don't see a declared end to this war, like we saw with other past military campaigns. Bush has said that this will go on for a long time, making it much more analogous to the war on drugs. Congress, despite heavy lobbying by the ACLU and other groups, did not put sunshine clauses in the vast majority of sunshine provisions in the so–called anti–terrorist laws. That is one of the reasons I refer to it as a "so–called" anti–terrorist law, because it is clearly going to be used against all kinds of crimes having remotely to do with terrorism, and will come at a cost to all law enforcement.

The fact that we have this legislation that is the basis for civil liberties violations is also something that distinguishes the WWII situation, the McCarthyism situation and other past violations of civil liberties. All of these instances, enacted under the auspices of executive order or by a legislative committee, could be rescinded with one stroke of the pen or when the committee goes out of existence. It is much more difficult to turn back civil liberty violations held up in statute. When things have changed enough or the political situation has evolved, it then becomes a challenge to get the law taken off the books. So yes, the non–finality of our current crisis does not afford more leeway to such infringements, but rather should cause you to be more weary and on edge.

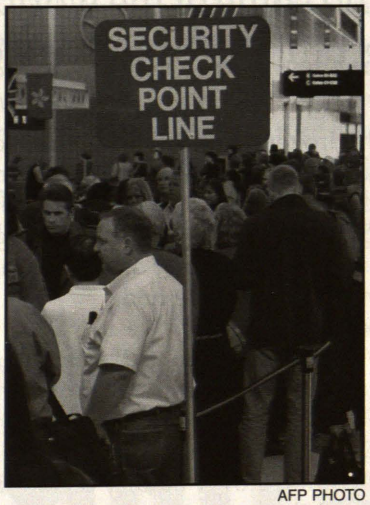
I really believe racial profiling will be for your generation what the Vietnam war was for mine, except worse, for our struggle finally did come to an end. With no immediate conclusion in sight, it is your generation that will bear the burden of these pervasive violations if they are not questioned now.

RACIAL PROFILING IN OUR NATION'S AIRPORTS

THE WRONG NAME FOR A JUSTIFIED PRACTICE

By David White

In the mid–1980s, racial profiling arose when the Drug Enforcement Agency responded to the street violence of the crack epidemic by enlisting local police forces to seize smugglers, who were importing drugs to the southern United States, and moving them to major American cities by car. Referred to as "Operation Pipeline," drug arrests in New Jersey soared. Relying on "drug courier profiles," New Jersey state troopers so often stopped and searched the cars of black men that victims referred to the practice as "driving while black."



AFP PHOTO

No studies have convincingly proven that racial profiling on our roadways is, or ever was, successful. Focusing on white drivers could have arguably yielded as many drug arrests. Airport passenger profiling, on the other hand, is amazingly successful in other parts of the world. Israel, the prime target of Islamic extremists, has only suffered one hijacking. It occurred in 1968, and Israel subsequently designed the industry's most impenetrable flight security—a system that included what civil libertarians would surely label "racial profiling."

In an October 24 editorial for the *Wall Street Journal*, senior editorial writer Jason Riley stated: "Of the 19 hijackers responsible for last month's [September 11] calamity, all were Arabic, all were practitioners of Islam and all came from known state incubators of terrorism in the Middle East. Of the 22 suspects on the FBI's "most wanted" list of international terrorists, all are Arabic, all are practitioners of Islam and all come from known state incubators of terrorism in the Middle East." Since the October 23, 1983 murder of 299 French and American peacekeepers in Beirut, Lebanon, most evidence suggests that every single suicide bomber has been Arab, a practitioner of Islam, and from known state incubators of terrorism in the Middle East.

Although these facts would seemingly result in any domestic attempt at uncovering terrorists to focus on particular groups driven by their faith and ethnicity, many prominent leaders—from Senator Russ Feingold all the way to President George Bush—continue to label racial profiling in our airports as unjustified and morally reprehensible. Do such persons fail to see the numerous reasons behind such a practice?

Across the Arab world, the term "suicide bombing" has been replaced with "martyrdom operation." Figures not disputed by Yasser Arafat indicate that 78 per cent of Palestinians support these "martyrdom operations." Recent events in the region suggest that the number has probably risen. Islamic extremists find sympathy across the Arab world, and see a hero in Osama bin Laden. Bin Laden has made no secret of his anti–American, anti–Western and anti–Israeli sentiments. In 1998, bin Laden issued an edict to his followers, "to kill the Americans and their allies, civilians and the military is an individual duty for every Muslim who can do it in any country in which it is possible to do it."

Many point to Timothy McVeigh as an example of why profiling in our airports is pointless. Such an argument is ludicrous. First, Timothy McVeigh was not a suicide bomber. Secondly, many argue that McVeigh represented the "right–wing militia" sentiment of our nation, whose numbers peaked at about 30,000 in 1995.[1] The one and only militia McVeigh was ever a part of dishonorably discharged him after only one meeting, while our own military gave him an honorable discharge after four years of service. So how many "followers" does McVeigh actually have? How many Americans support McVeigh? The number is probably miniscule, while bin Laden finds support and sympathy across the Arab world.

Numbers from the Congressional Research Service suggest that Al–Qaida cells have been identified in 34 nations. Every Al–Qaida suicide bomber has been Arab, a practitioner of Islam, and from known state incubators of terrorism in the Middle East. Given that there could be millions who hope to become "martyrs" like the September 11 hijackers, airport security screeners should pay closer attention to Arab travelers.

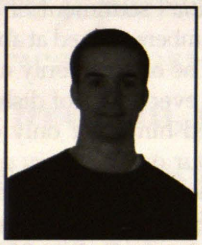
In the abyss of politically charged racial rhetoric spewed by political leaders across the spectrum, the term "racial profiling" has been applied to practices within our nation's airports, in spite of the dissimilarity to the true origins of racial profiling. Given our knowledge of the adversary in our war on terror, paying special attention to Arab, Muslim, Middle Easterners is a logical and legitimate response. Employing race in law enforcement efforts to slow drug trafficking is in many ways unjustified and illogical, but it should not be confused with a reasonable effort to prevent another September 11.

David White is a sophomore in Pierson College and international editor of The Politic.

THE ROAD AHEAD

FUEL CELL TECHNOLOGY IN THE 21ST CENTURY

By Kevin Davies



Recently, there has been a lot of hype surrounding fuel cell technology, with Secretary of Energy Spencer Abraham's announcement of the FreedomCAR program and some of the world's largest companies spending billions of dollars on fuel cell research. The development of fuel cells and the associated transition to a hydrogen based fuel infrastructure will be extremely expensive. The technology is advancing rapidly, but fuel cells may be decades away from widespread use in certain applications. Fuel cells hold many promises for enabling us to improve environmental quality, reduce our dependence on oil, and sustain an increasingly mobile society in the 21st century, but fuel cell development is only part of an expensive and time-consuming shift in our energy network.

The rate at which we are depleting the earth's fossil fuel reserves and the extent to which the use of fossil fuels harms the environment are continuously debated, but we all know that petroleum is a finite resource. The most accessible fossil fuels are generally consumed first, leaving the more expensive oil to be pumped later. We see evidence of this with increasing offshore drilling and arguments over opening the Arctic National Wildlife Refuge to the oil industry. Oil prices will continue to rise and competing energy sources will capture the energy market.

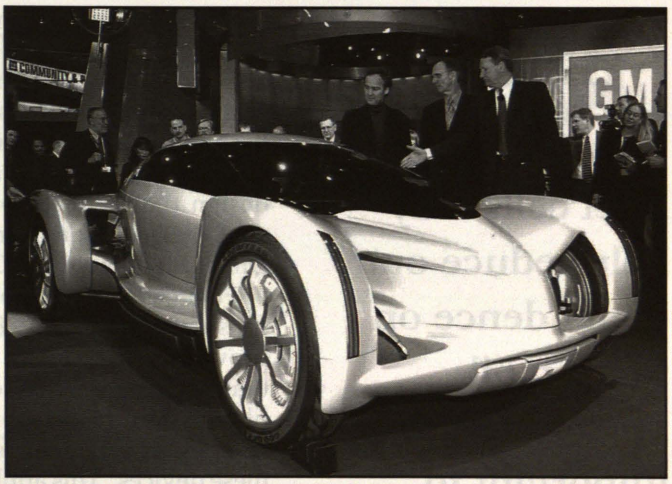
There are currently many prospects for the energy sources of the future, ranging from solar, geothermal, wind and hydroelectric power sources to biomass. The beauty of the fuel cell is that it will enable any of these technologies to provide the energy our modern culture requires. The predominant fuel cell being considered is the hydrogen fuel cell, where hydrogen atoms combine with oxygen to produce electricity, heat and water. The oxygen generally comes from the atmosphere and the hydrogen is supplied as a fuel. This hydrogen may be produced by reforming petroleum and natural gas at first, which hardly solves the fossil fuel problem. However, hydrogen can also be produced from water and electrical energy by electrolysis, from methane produced by decomposition, or from algae through photosynthesis. Scientists at the National Renewable Energy Laboratory and the University of California, Berkeley recently discovered the last method.

Much of the energy we use goes to transportation, where it is not possible to draw power directly from the electric grid. Previously, battery electric vehicles were the only possible enablers, which have not been able to meet most customer expectations. Fuel cells offer a distinct advantage over battery technology. Battery technology, while improving, is fundamentally limited by the fact that the electrodes and structure of the battery are part of the energy supply system, which is an overhead in terms of weight, volume, and cost per unit of energy stored. Fuel cell technology is similar (it also utilizes a chemical reaction to produce a voltage across electrodes); however, the fuel can be replenished independently of the system used to convert the energy.

The fuel cell will enable a shift from the internal combustion engine (ICE) back to electric motors in the transportation sector (some of the first automobiles were electric). The ICE, fundamentally a chemical and mechanical device, has its limitations. Although tremendous advances have been made over the past century and continue to be made, it is limited by two fundamental factors. First, it is a complex mechanical device that undergoes extreme stresses and is thus prone to degrading function and eventual failure. Second, it is a heat engine, so it is limited in efficiency by the Second Law of Thermodynamics to that of the Carnot cycle (which is equal to one minus the lowest temperature divided

by the highest temperature in the cycle). The fuel cell converts chemical energy directly to electric energy without the use of a heat engine. For applications in transportation, this electric energy is converted to mechanical energy by an electric motor. The resulting system uses significantly fewer mechanical parts and can be much more efficient in the conversion of energy. We are already seeing the beginning of a shift to the electric motor in automobiles. Two hybrid electric vehicle models are in production (the Toyota Prius and the Honda Insight) and many more are in the product development pipeline. These hybrid vehicles are an intermediate step on the path to a fully electric propulsion system.

As promising as fuel cells may be for transportation, they are still at the minimum a decade away from significant market penetration. First of all, there still are technological hurdles to be overcome. Among these are improving hydrogen storage methods, reaching the reliability standards that consumers expect, and reducing fuel cell system weight and size. All of the major automotive companies have fuel cell programs and are making impressive advancements in these areas. However, as with all new technologies, the shift to fuel cells will be determined by economics. Presently, fuel cell stacks are very expensive (the leading fuel cell architecture requires platinum as a catalyst). Even more importantly, the current fueling infrastructure for vehicles is liquid based. There has been tremendous investment into this infrastructure and it will require a tremendous investment to shift to hydrogen as a fuel, which is a liquid only at cryogenic temperatures. There are alternatives,



AFP / JEFF KOWALSKY

GM unveils the AUTOnomy, the first car designed around a fuel cell propulsion system.

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Fuel cells may help reduce our dependence on foreign oil. However, it is important to realize that fuel cells are only an enabler of a sound energy solution.

but these present other difficulties. One of these alternatives is to use onboard chemical reformers to break hydrocarbon fuels (gasoline, methane, propane, etc.) into hydrogen for use by the fuel cell. Another alternative is to design the fuel cell so that it will accept hydrocarbons directly, as in the Direct Methanol Fuel Cell (DMFC).

Fuel cells are also being applied to consumer electronics. The fuel cell may provide an alternative to the batteries that provide energy for laptops, cell phones and other portable devices. Swapping fuel canisters could recharge these devices. This application requires much less of a shift in existing infrastructure as compared to other fuel cell applications and may be economically feasible much sooner.

Another application of fuel cell systems is residential and commercial power. Presently, fuel cells are used in some locations as a power backup and may offer heat for buildings as well. The fuel cell power systems are particularly useful where it is cost prohibitive to run utility lines. In other locations, fuel cells may supplement utility grid power. During peak demand, the fuel cell system may provide energy in parallel with the utility. At low demand, it may send power out to the utility grid. Such systems may use natural gas as the hydrogen source. Weight and size are less of a consideration, so reformers may be used more readily to produce hydrogen.

Fuel cell technology holds a great deal of promise for the future. Fuel cells may help reduce our dependence on foreign oil, our destruction of priceless ecological habitats through domestic drilling, and our atmospheric pollution. However, it is important to realize that fuel cells are only an enabler of a sound energy solution. As with any device, they only convert energy. It will require intelligent political and economic decisions to use fuel cells to protect our future and the future of the planet.

Kevin Davies graduated from Carnegie Mellon University in 2001 with a degree in Electrical and Computer Engineering. He currently works at Ford in its alternative fuel vehicle division.

Silliman College Master's Tea

Bryan Riggs '96
Author

Hitler's Jewish Soldiers

The Untold Story of Nazi Racial Laws and Men of Jewish Descent in the German Military

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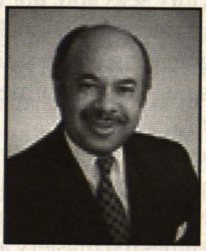
AFFIRMATIVE ACTION UNDER FIRE

WHY THE LAW SHOULD BE COLOR BLIND

By Ward Connerly



Eight-year-old Cristina Capacchione of North Carolina and 47-year-old Barbara Grutter of Michigan have something very unique in common: both were rejected from schools to which they had applied, seeking admittance on the claim that the schools needed diversity.

They, along with Cheryl Hopwood of Texas and Katuria Smith of Washington State, are in the middle of what will likely be the most controversial Supreme Court case of George W. Bush's first term. If the Court remains consistent with the principles of the Equal Protection Clause of the 14th Amendment and with their own recent rulings in similar cases, the use of racial classifications and preferences to achieve "diversity" in our nation's schools and universities will come to an end.

At issue are conflicting interpretations of the 1978 case of Board of Regents of the University of California v. Bakke, in which the Supreme Court offered only a muddled answer to the question of whether the pursuit of "diversity" in school admissions justifies racial preferences. In Bakke, a sharply divided Court struck down a California medical school's admission quota for minority students; however, Justice Lewis Powell's separate opinion declared that the pursuit of a "diverse student body" was a valid reason to use race as a "plus" factor. Even though no other justice concurred with that opinion– some in the legal community have said this case gave a ruling without a decision– it has been interpreted by most of the education establishment as controlling legal doctrine.

While nearly every college admissions officer in the country has interpreted the Bakke case to permit them to use racial classifications and preferences, the courts have not made this permission clear. Late last year, a Detroit federal judge ruled in a case challenging the undergraduate admissions policies at the University of Michigan that achieving racial diversity in the freshman class was so important– the legal term is "compelling – that the school was justified in using race as an admission criterion. However, in a similar lawsuit decided a few months later, another Detroit federal judge examined the diversity rationale for admissions to the University of Michigan Law School and arrived at the opposite conclusion. A full panel of the US Court of Appeals heard these completely conflicting opinions late last year. Regardless of how the Sixth Circuit rules, most legal observers agree that the U.S. Supreme Court will likely be called upon to sort out the conflicting legal opinions in Michigan and throughout the country. Regardless of how the legality of racial diversity will be settled by the courts in the future, race remains a polarizing social issue constantly debated in public and in no place more than in our nation's schools. It is in schools that "diversity" has become most emphasized, driving everything from student admissions, to faculty hiring and promotion, to curriculum. Yet, according to the results of a massive diversity poll commissioned by the Ford Foundation a few years ago, most Americans are unsure of diversity's real meaning, let alone how it is to be implemented and achieved by our institutions of higher learning. If diversity means racial integration, then most Americans support it; but if it means a system of racial classifications and preferences that must be recalibrated periodically to reach a target "goal," then most Americans are opposed.

Regardless of what the proponents of affirmative action try to sell the to public and the courts, "diversity," as practiced by our nation's colleges and universities, is little more than a Potemkin village of strict racial proportionality. In this respect, diversity has become un-tethered from integration and has assumed a life of its own. For the racial advocacy groups and their allies on the left, diversity is now integration's rival. The University of Michigan's legal defense of racial preferences in both cases went a step further by adding social science to its justification. A mammoth study was produced by Patricia Gurin, a University of Michigan psychology professor, that purported to prove the compelling benefits of a diverse student body. Her methodology centered on interviews with students admitted under the school's preference regime. The judge in the undergraduate case cited the study as "solid evidence" that students "who experience the

most racial and ethnic diversity" exhibit superior cognitive skills.

The compelling benefits of diversity proven in Gurin's study would undoubtedly have been different if students who were rejected from University of Michigan because of their skin color had been interviewed as well. In any event, basing racial classifications and preferences on this type of social science study should never be allowed to circumvent the timeless principles of equal protection under a color-blind Constitution. If the Supreme Court accepts a study which "proves" that educational and life experiences are improved by diversity, would they accept one that demonstrates just the opposite? It would not be difficult to devise a study in which the sharp racial disharmony so prevalent on some college campuses "proves" that diversity is harmful to educational development.

By defining diversity in this manner, the University of Michigan and dozens of other elite schools have concluded that a person's skin color dictates unique group qualities. But is this true? If so, what personality characteristics and life experiences do all black students have in common that are not to be found in their white classmates? Are there certain personality characteristics, cognitive distinctions, and life experiences that are found in all Hispanics? All Jews? All Asians? If there are, what are they? Of course, when asked to list traits unique to blacks or Hispanics, the diversity mavens go silent. All policies that classify people and then treat them differently based on race are a form of stereotyping. Achieving diversity in this manner assumes that all minorities are simply interchangeable with one another. Indeed, the opinion in the UM law school case had merit when the judge wrote that "viewpoint diversity" is completely different from "racial diversity."

"While the educational benefits of viewpoint diversity are clear, those of racial diversity are less so. The University of Michigan's witnesses emphasized repeatedly that it is a diversity of viewpoints, experiences, interests, perspectives, and backgrounds which creates an atmosphere most conductive to learning. As Dean Lehman testified, it is primarily a 'diversity of viewpoints' that the law school seeks."

The opinion continues by accurately noting, "The connection between race and viewpoint is tenuous at best. The defendants walk a fine line in simultaneously arguing that one's viewpoints are not determined by one's race but that certain viewpoints might not be voiced if students of particular races are not admitted in significant numbers."

In essence, what the university argued is that any black student in a college class will bring a "black" perspective to the discussion and the learning experience – it does not matter if he attended an impoverished inner-city high school or a chic prep school. Black skin creates diversity.

By doing this, the University of Michigan has done little more than "profile" their applicants no differently than some law enforcement officers do when they stop motorists for questioning because they are black or Hispanic. The American justice system does not allow a lawyer to use a prospective juror's race as a factor in jury selection, nor does it allow a jury to consider an individual's race during criminal sentencing. These racial presumptions violate our sense of fairness and color-blind justice.

Achieving diversity by stereotyping students based on their skin color does not enhance anyone's educational experience– it diminishes it. It belittles the mystery and the wonder and the dignity of each individual.

Achieving diversity by stereotyping students based on their skin color does not enhance anyone's educational experience—it diminishes it. It belittles the mystery and the wonder and the dignity of each individual.

One cannot help but recognize also that Justice Powell's racial diversity rationale for preferences coincided with the growth of racial separateness on campus. Ethnic dorms, black graduation ceremonies and race-based student activity centers are the norm at elite schools today. When universities bow to the creed of racial diversity, perhaps that is when students start to notice– and heed– skin color.

Fortunately, these cases are approaching the day of judicial reckoning. It would be tragic, and dangerous, for the Supreme Court to allow universities to use race in admissions, even as a "tie-breaker" in a contest between qualified applicants. If it does, it will be endorsing the belief that race really does tell us something fundamental about an individual. This idea is hauntingly comparable to arguments made by Bull Connor 35 years ago.

Even if the high court rules in favor of colorblind principles and strikes down race-based admissions policies, the nation's real work will have just begun. Closing the academic achievement gap between whites and Asians on the one hand, and blacks and Hispanics on the other, is the unspoken reason these policies exist in the first place, and is the real compelling governmental interest.

Ward Connerly is the founder and chairman of the American Civil Rights Institute, a national organization aimed at educating the public about the problems created by racial and gender preferences.

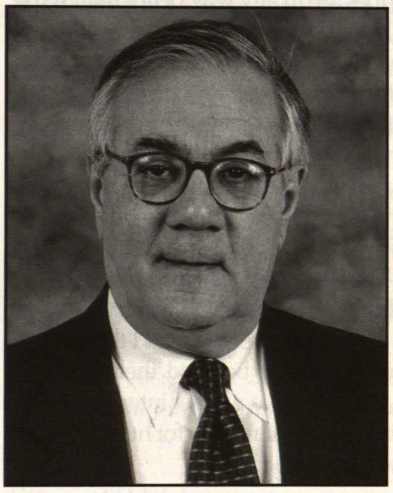
BARNEY FRANK

INSIDE CONGRESSIONAL POLITICS

AN INTERVIEW

Barney Frank has been representing Massachusetts' 4th Congressional District since 1981. Before that he served in the Massachusetts House of Representatives and as an assistant to the Mayor of Boston. During his service in Boston, he taught at several Boston area universities.

In the 107th Congress, Congressman Frank serves on the Committee on Financial Services where he is the senior Democrat on Housing Programs. He also serves on the Committee on the Judiciary. On February 23, 2002, Barney Frank sat down for a conversation with **The Politic.**



The Politic: Considering the recent bipartisanship exhibited by Senator Kennedy and President Bush concerning education reform, do you think we can expect something similar with a "patient's bill of rights"?

Barney Frank: Not necessarily, nor is that something that people can hold up as the model. The notion that partisanship is bad really ignores the history of democracy. Parties are not a bad thing; they are not something that people put on earth to corrupt the political process. Parties are, in fact, a necessary element in self–government. You cannot find a democracy of any size in the history of the world that did not have political parties, and its not because anybody decided to create them, they just have been organic growth. There are differences between the parties, and they ought to be argued out. In fact, what happened on education is, its one of the few areas, the only one I'm really sure of, where George Bush deviated from the conservative position. The Ronald Reagan position was to abolish the Department of Education. The education bill that Kennedy and Bush worked together on is the greatest insertion of federal authority into state education matters in American history, and it is only possible because Bush broke with his party's position. If you want to do that, that's fine, I know how Republicans were grumbling as they voted for that bill.

On the other hand, Bush has reverted to type in this, because—and I think you've seen Kennedy complain about this—one of the parts of that agreement, as Kennedy thought, was a significant increase in funding for education. That didn't happen. So Bush got part of what he wanted and did not supply the rest. But no, I don't think that that will be or should be the model, because I think it is legitimate in a democracy for people to debate about different conceptions about how we are to govern ourselves.

What will be the implications of the Shays–Meehan campaign finance reform bill?

Not, unfortunately, as much as some enthusiasts think. The problem is the United States Supreme Court has put limits on what we can do. We can not go as far as almost any other democracy in regulating campaign spending because the United States Supreme Court has said that that's part of the first amendment. I disagree with that interpretation but we're bound by it. On the other hand, Shays–Meehan goes pretty far within the boundaries that the court has set. Getting rid of soft money will be very helpful. First—and this is the most important thing—it will just reduce money in general. And the most important issue here is not a case of corruption as much as it is basic philosophy.

We have two systems in America. We have an economic system—capitalism—that is a wonderful system, it produces a great amount of wealth, but it requires inequality. If people are not unequally rewarded, then the capitalism system doesn't function. So you need inequality in our economic system. We have, side by side, a political system that is based on equality—one person, one vote—now you don't have one person, one dollar; that wouldn't work. But you do have one person, one vote. To the extent that money has come to have more of a role in our political process, the unequal element of the society has overshadowed the equal element.

What you really want is a tension between the two; you want the inequality of the capitalist system and the more equalizing element of the political system working together. And what Shays–Meehan will do is to reduce the extent to which the unequal element of the system unduly impacts the equal element, and therefore make it a more democratic society.

I think basically the Chinese get what they want from us in the relationship, and don't respond in turn. After all, we are by far China's best customer. We have with China the largest balance of payments deficit in the history of the world. The Chinese gain more from their relationship with us than any country has ever gained from any other country.

Why do you oppose permanent normal trade relations with China?

For several reasons. First, of course, they are the greatest oppressor of human rights in the world. I do not understand why Iran is evil, and China gets the good conduct medal. I understand why Iran is evil, the religious leaders are running around, running it very badly, and are in fact repressing the democratic elements that have begun to come out. But China is terribly repressive, it's very brutal towards religion, it also sends weapons to other people. I mean it's very hard to understand in some ways why the things that China does are in any way better than what North Korea does. I think we should have trade relations with China, but I don't think we sufficiently use our influence. I think basically the Chinese get what they want from us in the relationship, and don't respond in turn. After all, we are by far China's best customer. We have with China the largest balance of payments deficit in the history of the world. The Chinese gain more from their relationship with us than any country has ever gained from any other country. I think there is more leverage to be used there, both in getting them to behave better internationally, and in terms of their respect for human rights at home.

As globalization leads the free market to expand to a world level, what role do you see for the United States?

I would like us to play, internationally, a more balanced role. Up until the middle of the Clinton administration, the notion of globalization that was representative of the establishment of America was very simple: let capital go wherever it wants to—that is, even when we talked about trade, we weren't talking about trade primarily in the sense of the physical exchange of goods the way you would have been talking about trade fpur years ago—when America talked about trade, even with China, we were talking about removing all restraints on capital. Letting the owners of capital invest that capital, wherever, and under whatever terms, would be the most profitable. Now that's a good thing, but it's not a good thing unrestrained.

I think we should instead say that we want to promote the movement of capital, but we want to accompany that with respect for the rights of workers and for environmental protection. So I think that the role of America should be to promote globalization, but to promote globalization in the way that Franklin Roosevelt promoted capitalism. And we really have these two models. You have the Reagan model, which says, explicitly in Reagan's first inaugural, "government is not the answer to the problem, government is the problem." And under the Reagan model, you just remove the restraints on capital, and let it go wherever it wants. And if it wants to go there for a week and pull back out again, countries have to allow that to happen. I think it can be destabilizing. It produces wealth, but it also can produce instability. And it can undermine the efforts of communities to promote quality of life. Because capital will say to them, "Hey, if you make me recognize the union, I'll go over here where I don't have to." "If you won't let me hire 9–year–olds, I'll go over there where I can hire them." "If you make me worry about global warming, I'll go over there were I don't have to worry about it." And I think America ought to be pressing for the kind of synthesis that Roosevelt had—capitalism, but with some respect for other values.

I'll give you a specific example of this, and it's a catch–22 that the republicans are using. George Bush announces that he cannot support the Kyoto treaty to reduce global warming, because, for among other reasons, he says explicitly, it exempts China and India. And this gives China and India a potential competitive advantage over American companies. Then he says, however, while we allow China and India to trade with us, we should not impose on them any environmental requirements because that's an interference with their rights to make up their own minds. Well no. I think the two positions are inconsistent. Yes, China and India have a right to do what they want. We have a right to set conditions on people who want access to our markets and our capital. And on the one hand to say that we can't do anything about global warming because China and India aren't doing it, and on the other hand to say that we're not going to do anything to make China and India do anything about global warming, reveals what the real agenda is. Namely, use the fact that other countries don't have good worker rights, and don't have good environmental standards, as an argument for reducing them at home.

How do you evaluate President Bush's performance concerning gay rights?

It's pretty bad. The country as a whole has gotten a lot better, so you don't have the kind of gay bashing that you might have had before. Essentially what Bush has done is, he has not undone any of the progress we have made, but he hasn't made any progress either. Bill Clinton issued several executive orders—ending the policy that said if you're gay you couldn't get a security clearance. That was an outrageous policy for forty years, Clinton ended it. Clinton said if you're gay you shouldn't be discriminated against in the civil service, and if you're gay and you're being persecuted overseas you can get asylum. Now Bush would not have done any of those. His father, in fact, refused to do all of them when we asked him. But Bush won't undo any of what Clinton did.

On the other hand, he did appoint to administer the civil service—which deals with the non–discrimination in appointment—a woman that used to work for Pat Robertson, one of the great bigoted fools of our time. So, Bush didn't undo what Clinton did, but he won't go any further. He's certainly gone back on Clinton—Clinton spoke out against anti–gay prejudice—Bush won't do that. Clinton promulgated gay pride day—I was invited to speak at gay pride day at the C.I.A., I thought that was pretty important in terms of dispelling the prejudices we have had—Bush refused to allow the promulgation of gay pride days except in the case of his one democratic appointee, Norman Mineta—who went ahead and did that. Clinton appointed a number of gay and lesbian people to important positions, Bush has appointed one openly gay person to a mid–level position, and he allowed a gay ambassador whose rank in the Foreign Service had put him at that point to go ahead with it. That's better than everything we would have gotten under Ronald Reagan and George Bush, but a lot worse than Bill Clinton.

How do you see the Massachusetts governor's race shaping up, and what do you think about Robert Reich entering the contest?

I think the democrats have a very good chance, and I think Governor Swift has been very inadequate. As to Robert Reich, I agree with what he says. We have three very strong candidates—Shannon O'Brien, Tom Birmingham, and Robert Reich—who are all very similar. We have a couple of others, Steve Grossman and Warren Tolman—the striking thing is that all five of the candidates for governor are similarly positioned ideologically. Reich is very articulate. I have questions about his temperament. He wrote this book when he left office—I should add that it's a book in which he takes some very savage shots at me—I was kind of puzzled because he's now saying that he's very upset because the democrats are not willing to be far enough to the left, but in his book he attacks me as being too far to the left—over an issue he now takes credit for—trying to get the Clinton administration to be better about the minimum wage. But the book was full of attacks on people who had simply disagreed with him; attacks that he himself has admitted were unfair and inaccurate. And he has now been caught misinterpreting what Bill Clinton said to him. So I'm not convinced yet that he is temperamentally suited for elected office. It's a pretty unpleasant place and there's this sensitivity and a degree of temperamental response that makes me a little nervous.

How do you see the 2002 congressional elections shaping up for the Democratic Party?

If it were held right now, it wouldn't go very well for us, I'm afraid. You know, George Bush had this tremendous political advantage. It's not one he asked for, I mean everyone deplores the fact that so many people were murdered—but in any organization, in any society, if there's something everybody wants to be done, and you get to be the one that does it, you are the hero. I mean, anybody who was president on September 11th would have benefited from this response. I think George Bush did a good job at it, but I think Bill Clinton and Al Gore would have done essentially the same job. In fact, one thing that should be noted is that the military that won the war so decisively in Afghanistan is exactly the military that George Bush kept telling us was so weak and depleted during the 2000 election. George Bush won the war in Afghanistan with the military he inherited from Bill Clinton. But still, he's got this popularity. On the other hand, we don't know what the economy is going to be like between now and then. So I'd say that at this point it's uncertain. The Republicans are probably ahead today, but the events that are going to determine November have yet to have happened.

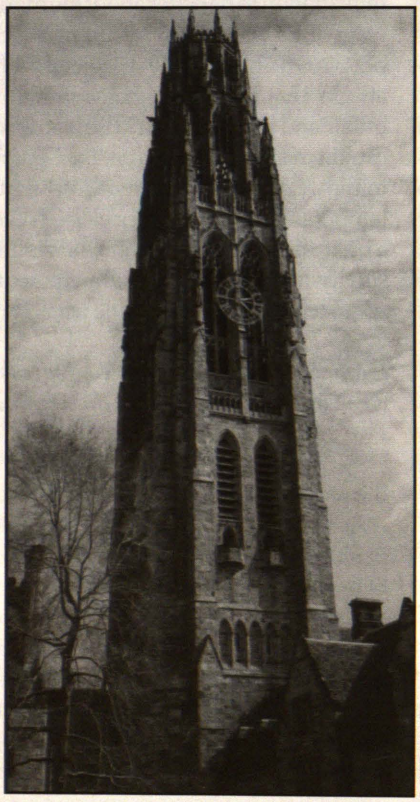
One thing that should be noted is that the military that won the war so decisively in Afghanistan is exactly the military that George Bush kept telling us was so weak and depleted during the 2000 election. George Bush won the war in Afghanistan with the military he inherited from Bill Clinton. But still, he's got this popularity.

RICHARD SHAW

SHAPING A NEW YALE

AN INTERVIEW

Richard Shaw is the Dean of Undergraduate Admissions and Financial Aid. He sat down with The Politic on February 7th to discuss the changing face of college admissions.



DAVID WHITE

The Politic: Throughout the 20th century, the opportunities for women and minorities to attain college education have increased dramatically, resulting in changes in the general college scope. What are the major changes you foresee taking place in the 21st century in the college process?

Richard Shaw: There has been incredible change really since the Presidency of Kingman Brewster when there was a paradigm shift in terms of the work that we do. I think the goal has been, and probably will continue to be, to enroll students from all over the world. During the period up until three to five years ago, we really were somewhat insulated. We have now opened up our horizons to the world at large and acknowledged that globalization is a reality. You can see the Globalization Center and World Fellows Program here at Yale as reflections of what I think will be a future attempt not only to serve the populations of this country by attracting the best and the brightest to Yale, but we will take it one step further to include now the world at large.

We have done that and will continue to do that by recruiting on multiple continents. To date, we have covered all the continents and the effort again is to attract young people from everywhere with the idea that the Yale experience will be a foundation for them to lead. I think that is part of the issue, whatever they do – whether they teach, whether they go into government, whether they go into medicine or law or economics, the foundation that they have here in terms of a broad liberal arts education and the opportunity to be in a college system like ours will give them the necessary tools to be very flexible in terms of how they approach their futures.

We want to continue to be very aware of all the populations that we serve in this country and beyond. We will continue in this century to pay close attention to the effort to have a diverse student body in all the different ways that represents. That means that diversity of perspective is maybe the most important part – bringing students together who come with many different opinions that will hopefully become part of our political efforts to debate, to argue, to look for and learn how to reach consensus, and to develop solutions to a lot of the significant problems that we face.

I am a product of Vietnam and that era. I was part of an activist generation. Though it was a different time, we dealt with some of the issues that you are thinking about as well. I see September 11 as being one of those extraordinary events that really does influence and impact students' evaluations of the world in which they live and their part in it. That is a good thing in a lot of ways. Yale students have always been extraordinary about community service, but I see that recently these things are being even more strongly focused on by students. People will realize it is not a perfect world. There are some serious issues of security at play here and people will ask what they can do to help find solutions for very complex problems. As we move into this century, part of it will be that this focus on globalization and the interconnectedness of the world at large will have influence on the education enterprise.

The other part of this next century is the focus on the sciences. Yale has made a huge commitment into developing and researching the hard sciences. We will intently

work to attract powerful scientists and we will create facilities that are really attractive. These projects will broaden the involvement of the student body in physics, chemistry, and biochemistry and in the New Haven context, in things like pharmaceutical research and engineering. The issue of being the best we possibly can be in all the fields we choose to be a part of will contribute to the students' experience. So, I do not see radical changes, but I think there are changes in the horizon.

What exactly do you think the role of college is and what do you look for when you are trying to build a Yale college class when you go through your college process?

I think our goal is to attract a broad diversity of opinions, ideologies and experiences. We are not in any way discriminating against people because of their individual opinions. We are interested in accepting students with lots of interesting perspectives and, in fact, the more you add to the mix, the more one would hope that a more interesting dynamic occurs in both the classroom and the dinning halls. To have that broad conversation I think is a critical role of universities. This is the kind of environment we should be creating, one that is open so that all voices are heard. The first answer is to try to serve the country and the world through all sorts of dimensions- racial, religious, socio-economic and political. So when you bring them to this environment, it provides a rich foundation for trying to figure out the answers.

Yale is actively trying to recruit international students. How do you reconcile this desire for diversity with America's new security threats and fears?

It is true that September 11 probably has had an impact on many who believed in isolationism because they were afraid. They want to close out the world. For example, there will be some impact on government responses to the granting of visas. It will become a much more difficult process for students who will now have to go under more scrutiny. But maybe we should have done that to begin with. I am hoping that is not a limiter, in that it forces people to be kept out rather than encouraging them.

On the other hand, it is important for us to be sensitive. I do not think it has had significant impact on our goals. I still think we need to acknowledge the world as interconnected. That is part of our current effort, bringing together students from different parts of the world. These international students will bring their perspectives that help us understand the world at large, but we will also give them an opportunity to learn about our culture and things that are strong and positive about it. We have a very special experience that is different than most of the world. This environment, these residential colleges, this liberal arts experience, is so enriching and empowering. So, I think we are going to continue to recruit worldwide and we are going to try to develop a student body that is representative across the world.

On the domestic front, there is an ongoing national debate regarding the diversity policies of state universities, specifically those in Michigan and Texas. As a private university, what is the University's policy in terms of admitting students of different backgrounds? Can you make a case that this is the best possible method of dealing with diversity on college campuses?

There have been an unbelievable amount of legal cases in terms of this issue. There is a case in the district court of Michigan that, I think, will go to the Supreme Court. There is also a referendum in California and a legal case in Texas. I would say our policy is that we are committed to affirmative action and we will continue to be. The consideration of race is a factor among many that we take into consideration. If there is an issue of serving populations and diversity of this country, we are committed to doing that. But I think these court cases could have huge repercussions down the line. Whatever the outcomes may be our goal will always be to attempt to have the most widely representative classes coming in that we can.

I think our goal is to attract a broad diversity of opinions, ideologies and experiences. We are not in any way discriminating against people because of their individual opinions.

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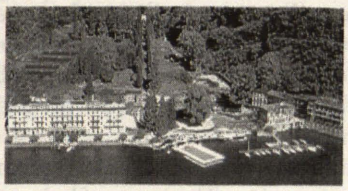

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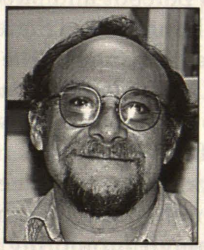
MEDICAL NECESSITY AND CIVIL RIGHT

HARM REDUCTION FOR INJECTING DRUG USERS

By Robert Heimer



The war on drugs costs the taxpayers of the United States nearly $40 billion annually. It is a losing battle. Despite this cost and the imprisonment of more than one million Americans on drug or drug-related offenses, the number of people using illicit drugs has not decreased since the mid–1980s. The best evidence for the failure of the supply reduction strategy of the war on drugs is that over the past 20 years the prices of drugs like heroin and cocaine purchased on the street have steadily declined while their purity has increased.

The fundamental reason why the war on drugs is a losing battle is because it adopts a prohibitionist position that tries to solve what are essentially social, medical and mental health problems through the legal system. Until recently, the opposition to prohibition focused entirely on repeal or relaxation of the drug prohibitions. No middle ground between these two positions seemed possible. Even those politicians who recognized the futility of the war on drugs were unable to abandon the prohibitionist line for fear of being labeled as soft on crime. Almost forgotten in this stalemate between a reasonable policy and political suicide is the fact that prohibition is essentially a 20th century phenomenon.

Recently, however, the biggest challenge to the dominance of the drug warriors has not come from the political libertarians who wish to stop government supervision of private lives nor from the civil libertarians who argue that the war on drugs has eroded the protections of the Constitution. Rather, the challenge has come from the public health sector, prompted by the emergence of the AIDS epidemic. In 1981, the discovery of an acquired immune deficiency afflicting young gay men was followed immediately by the recognition that a similar syndrome was afflicting previously healthy intravenous drug users. While some people argued that such plagues were the natural outcomes of antisocial behaviors (be they drug use or homosexuality), the vast majority of the medical and public health community realized that a virus caused the disease. In the case of intravenous drug use, it came to be recognized that the sharing of syringes among injectors was responsible for virus transmission.

The recognition that dirty syringes transmit HIV among drug injectors led to the origins of a public health–focused approach to preventing such infections. Its fundamental tenet is that the behaviors that transmit the virus are created by the interplay of personal behaviors, social norms promoting these behaviors, and structural factors operating at a legal or cultural level reinforcing the risky behaviors. Because disease transmission is promoted by factors operating at multiple levels, a comprehensive response is necessary. Nonetheless, this approach remains firmly anchored in the idea that the infectious disease harms associated with drug use are separable from the use of the drugs themselves. Furthermore, it is possible to undertake public health programs that reduce those harms without mandating a cessation of drug use. This approach has, therefore, come to be called harm reduction. Its name conveys the idea that it is gradual, not absolutist. As a leader of this movement is fond of saying, "prevention is never perfect and never–ending."

The primary practical expression of this tenet has been the establishment of programs that make sterile syringes more available to those who, for whatever reason, continue to inject drugs. In cities like Liverpool in England, Glasgow in Scotland, Amsterdam in the Netherlands, and Sydney in Australia, the initial response took the form of syringe exchange programs, beginning in the mid 1980s. The operations of these programs were based on replacing potentially infectious syringes with clean

The fundamental reason why the war on drugs is a losing battle is because it adopts a prohibitionist position that tries to solve what are essentially social, medical, and mental health problems through the legal system.

ones and on the acceptance that injectors would continue to inject until they were ready for treatment. In most of these locations, syringe exchange programs became integrated into a comprehensive harm reduction strategy that coupled syringe exchange with other programs that increased access to substance abuse treatment. It is generally agreed that harm reduction includes four distinct components: (1) syringe exchange, (2) increased syringe access through other means such as pharmacy sales or physician prescription, (3) educating injectors in steps to prevent infectious disease transmission and drug overdose, and (4) effective substance abuse treatment on request. In Britain, Holland, Switzerland and Australia, harm reduction has become part of national drug policy and was recently embraced by the World Health Organization.

Such has not been the case in the United States, but it could have been. The United States was among the first countries in which prevention for injectors was attempted and evaluated. The first syringe exchange program was established by active users in Amsterdam in 1984, and was rapidly adopted as public health policy by the city's health service. The first syringe exchanges came to the United States in Boston and New Haven in 1986, but for political reasons these were forced to operate illegally until 1990 and 1994, respectively. In this nation's capital and its largest city, public health advocates and officials proposed syringe exchange pilot programs. Political opposition resulted in the establishment of short–lived and completely ineffective programs.

For example, fewer participants were enrolled and fewer syringes were exchanged after a year's operation in New York in 1989 than after the first week of the city–run program in New Haven in 1990 despite the fact that there were more than 50 injectors in New York for every one in New Haven. A rule of thumb in harm reduction is that prevention programs have to meet injectors where they are and accept them for whom they are. For the New York program, the rules (only injectors awaiting entry in drug treatment programs), the setting (in a downtown health department office across from a police station), and the judgmental attitudes of program operators doomed that program to failure. Despite official opposition, underground syringe exchange programs burgeoned in New York in the early 1990s, and as a result of these efforts, the epidemic of HIV transmission among injectors finally appears to be under control, twenty years after the epidemic first arose. Our work in New Haven has demonstrated that publicly accepted, citywide syringe exchange programs can decrease HIV transmission rates by 40 percent and save millions of dollars. If the United States had adopted syringe exchange at the same rate as Australia, 10 to 20 thousand cases of HIV could have been averted in the decade of the 1990s.

Increasing syringe access need not occur only through syringe exchange. It can occur through promoting over–the–counter sales at pharmacies and through doctors' prescriptions. The first campaigns to actively increase syringe access through pharmacy sales were begun in Edinburgh, Scotland in 1985 and in Australia soon thereafter. The case of Edinburgh makes a good illustration of the foolishness of restricting syringe access. The epidemic use of heroin in the United Kingdom, aptly described in the book and movie "Trainspotting," occurred during the Thatcher era of the early 1980s, and was particularly severe in the Scottish cities of Edinburgh and Glasgow. One should note that Edinburgh is a predominantly middle–class university city and Glasgow is a poorer, less educated, blue–collar city. Such socio–demographic differences might lead on to expect a more severe HIV epidemic among injectors in Glasgow. However, in Edinburgh, pharmacists, concerned about the growing number of heroin injectors, decided to withhold sales of syringes. As a consequence of the resultant syringe scarcity, HIV prevalence increased rapidly, and in some medical practices more than 45% of injectors became infected with HIV in a period of just 18 months. Once these findings were reported and publicized, Edinburgh reversed course, embraced harm reduction, and the incidence of new infections rapidly decreased.

In contrast, the United States took the opposite course. In response to the United States heroin epidemic, a dozen states prohibited syringe sales or possession without a prescription and all but three states allowed syringes to be used as evidence of a felony for drug possession. Many of these states passed their statutes even in the face of evidence that shared syringes were responsible for the transmission of HIV. No state reversed a prohibition policy of 'sale and possession without a prescription' until 1992. That change, undertaken in Connecticut, has set a precedent that has been repeated in all but five states. Unfortunately, those five states include California, the state with the most injectors, and New Jersey, the state with the highest rate of new infections among injectors.

Reducing harm occurs not only through increasing access to syringes. It also occurs when people put themselves at lower risk for syringe–borne transmission of HIV by reducing the frequency at which they inject, replace injection with other forms of drug use, or stop illicit drug use entirely. This is clearly a gradualist approach in which abstinence is the best, but not the only endpoint. Such an approach has been institutionalized in the Netherlands, beginning in Amsterdam in 1979. Recognizing that the best form of drug treatment for long–term heroin users is methadone maintenance, the Dutch have created a four–tiered treatment system which now covers more than 70 percent of the nation's estimated 24,000 heroin addicts. Just under one–fifth are in drug–free, abstinence–based treatment programs and nearly three times that number is receiving some form of methadone maintenance.

Methadone is administered in three ways. Low threshold programs are operated by the municipal health service and are designed to contact active heroin users and often provide only enough methadone to avert symptoms of withdrawal and reduce injection frequency but not enough methadone to block heroin's effects. Medium and high threshold programs are operated by general medical practitioners and specialized treatment clinics, respectively. Issues of drug diversion were handled by creating a central methadone–dispensing registry and expanding the number of people prescribed the drug. Recognizing that their programs still did not reach the most problematic heroin users, the Dutch recently completed a trial using heroin to treat heroin addiction. The evaluators reported that the health of the individuals completing 18 months in the heroin arm was indistinguishable from that of the general Dutch population

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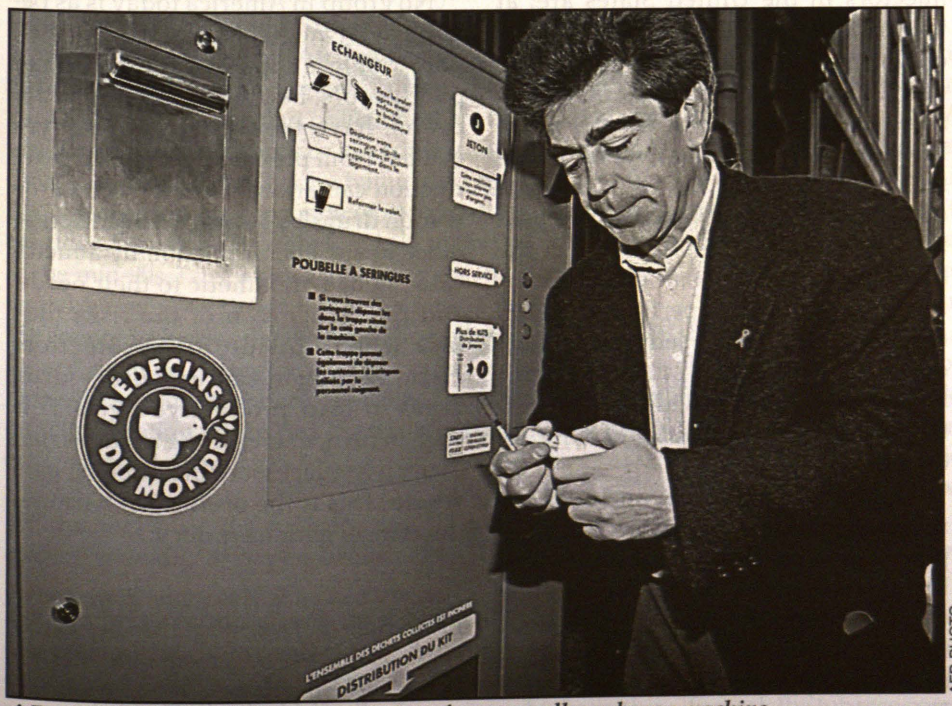


AFP PHOTO

A French physician obtains a new syringe from a needle exchange machine.

The drug war's legacy includes unreasonable searches and invasions of privacy and widespread erosion of civil liberties, all in the name of controlling the harm that one does to oneself by taking psychoactive drugs.

and suggested that the Netherlands join Switzerland in making medically prescribed heroin the treatment of last resort for those who have proven methadone–resistant.

In contrast, the treatment of heroin dependent persons in the United States has been far less successful. Less than one-quarter is in methadone programs, and these programs are high threshold. Pilot programs offering general practitioner–based treatment have only been initiated in the past few years. Not only are low threshold programs not even envisioned, but American methadone programs dismiss patients who fail drug tests, even though medical professionals acknowledge that addiction is a chronic disease in which relapse is expected. Some methadone programs even expel patients who use other illicit drugs, even as they acknowledge that methadone is treatment only for opiate dependence. It seems that the logic of the drug war, with its no–tolerance litany, supersedes sound medical practice. There is unequivocal evidence that methadone maintenance reduces crime, unemployment, and the spread of disease. Nevertheless, methadone fails to meet its potential in preventing HIV transmission among injectors in the United States.

All of the difficulties that I described in combating the spread of HIV among injectors in the United States are, at their root, a consequence of the war on drugs that has become a war on drug users. Users have been demonized and stigmatized. Their medical dependence has been condemned as a moral weakness, equated with the worst kind of turpitude. Presumption of use had led to punitive drug testing even in the absence of evidence that drug use has reduced the ability to perform at school or on the job. Use has led to denials of opportunities, such as student loans or housing, despite all evidence that better education and stable housing reduce illicit drug use.

The drug war's legacy includes unreasonable searches and invasions of privacy and widespread erosion of civil liberties, all in the name of controlling the harm that one does to oneself by taking psychoactive drugs. But there is another way to decrease these harms. It involves accepting drug users as people worthy of support. Their drug use may range from occasional to out of control and the reasons for their drug use may vary. Some take drugs for pleasure, some to medicate mental health problems, some to alleviate hopelessness or despair. Some people are more prone to becoming dependent and losing control of their drug use. But the excesses of those out of control do not give us the prerogative to deny sympathy to drug users. On the contrary, it should impel us to seek solutions, to keep them safe from disease, and to find solutions that allow them to monitor and control their drug use. This is the realm of harm reduction. It is part compassion and part practicality, neither of which can be found in any measure in the dominant American response to illicit drug use.

A black minister from Nashville, Ed Sanders, has likened the current harm reduction movement to the civil rights movements of the 1960s. These were vibrant, ad–hoc associations of people struggling to expand democracy to the oppressed, the under–privileged, and the marginalized. Forty years later, many of the hopes of the civil rights, gay rights and women's liberation movements have been realized. But throughout this period, the drug war has been raging, mostly against America's poor.

No group in America today is as penalized or neglected as drug users. They can lose supports afforded other poor people, be denied loans for education, have their innocent relatives evicted from public housing. Harm reduction can afford them a truce in the war on drugs by giving them an acceptance in society, protection by a medical system sympathetic to their needs, and the recognition of the risks they face when outside that protection. Harm reduction can encourage drug users to lead productive lives. This will, in turn, decrease the burdens that drug use places on the society as a whole. This is the promise of harm reduction as national policy.

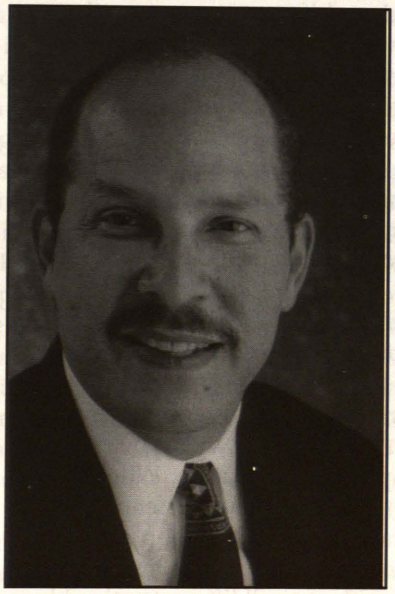
Robert Heimer is Associate Professor of Epidemiology of Microbial Diseases at Yale University. He is Director of Yale's Emerging Infections program and has numerous studies on HIV prevention.

DONALD WATKINS

ON POLITICAL AND ECONOMIC EMPOWERMENT

AN INTERVIEW

Donald V. Watkins, an Alabama Civil Rights attorney who has begun a second career as a banker and a business entrepreneur, is attempting to become the first African-American owner of a major league baseball team. Mr. Watkins spoke with The Politic *to discuss his business and political experiences.*



The Politic: When you talk about economic empowerment, what do you really mean?

Donald V. Watkins: We, as African Americans, enjoyed great success in battling segregation in the courts and ultimately in the U.S. Congress. Yet, we had not achieved comparable economic progress. I began to think about economic empowerment and how its attainment could carry the civil rights revolution on into the 21st century. I saw that business would be the pathway to the next level of growth and progress for African-Americans. When I talk about economic empowerment, I mean one's ability to favorably impact the quality of life of others by handing out vendor and service contracts, awarding jobs, reinvesting in communities, and networking within the broader economy. My first focus in the corporate world was to develop business interests where I thought I could both find and add value. In the mid-90s, I discovered that there was tremendous potential for empowerment through strategic investments in the energy industry. The demand for energy is global, and money spent on energy products by consumers and corporations is non-discretionary. We cannot go without fuel for our cars, heating oil for our homes, and basic utilities like electricity and natural gas.

What would you tell a graduate starting out who wants to achieve your kind of success in business?

If you want to create substantial personal and business wealth, find a paradigm shifting technology developed by sophisticated entrepreneurs, who have a well documented record of success in creating valuable businesses, and who have the deep pockets necessary to achieve the highest level of performance and the deployment of a global application. Ideally, you would like to be invested in the first generation of such a technology. Make sure that the technology produces revenue streams that are capable of enhancement and multiplication around the globe. This is how fortunes were made in the cable, cellular, telecommunications and electronic security businesses. You must be there first with a technology and product that consumers must have. They become lifetime subscribers of the technology and its products.

Tell us about the political news service you founded, the Voter News Network?

Voter News Network (VNN) is a political news service that focuses on pocketbook issues of interest to independent voters such as tax reform, affordable healthcare, economic empowerment and quality education. It had instant success. VNN was originally intended to target black voters, and convince them why they should be independent voters. Within two or three months of its inception, VNN developed to the point where it is 60 percent white, 35 percent black and five percent no designation. Remember, this is Alabama where people generally vote along racial lines. No one thought we could develop a political news service that could reach across racial lines. But, pocketbook issues tend to unite people; social issues tend to divide them. We decided that VNN would not cover social issues. I find, however, that the more secure voters are with the financial situation within their households, the more tolerant they are with differing opinions on social issues.

What got you started on the VNN project?

You cannot be successful in business if you ignore your political environment. Whether you like it or not, politics impact the business environment in very fundamental ways. Just ask the tobacco companies, who at one time had a prod-

The greatest force for equal opportunity is the globalization of commerce. The world is multicolored, and if you are a person that can bring value to the bottom line of a global corporation, then no one cares about your race, gender, political affiliation, religious preference, lifestyle choice or any other artificial consideration.

uct that was immune from political scrutiny and who wound up paying one of the largest settlements in the history of litigation because of changes in public policy in both Congress and various state legislatures. So, I realized if I am going to be in business, I have to work to make sure that middle-of-the-road economic policies are adopted which make it possible for success to occur.

Let me tell you how and why a good business climate is essential to the success of people of color like me. The greatest force for equal opportunity is the globalization of commerce. The world is multicolored, and if you are a person that can bring value to the bottom line of a global corporation, then no one cares about your race, gender, political affiliation, religious preference, lifestyle choice or any other artificial consideration. As a dynamic force for progress and equality, global commerce is far more potent than any statute or social protest movement.

How does Voter News Network have an impact on the political environment?

Politicians respect organized groups of voters. This element is more powerful than a campaign contribution. Whoever can deliver a bloc of votes has enhanced the political position of the group of people in that voting bloc. I see my interests coinciding with several different voting blocs. It is the job of Voter News Network to disseminate news of interest to independent voters, to communicate the political interests of our readers to political candidates, and to develop strategic political alliances with other political groups who share common interests. If this kind of effort can succeed in Alabama, I believe it is ripe for expansion into other states, which we are doing. It is my hope that Voter News Network can be a national force in politics by the next presidential election.

I see my political interests lining up with middle-class American issues. There are more middle-class Americans than there are rich corporations and special interest groups. The idea of VNN is to bring minority voters and others into the mainstream so that our views on pocketbook issues are heard in an effective way. There has been a tremendous growth in the black middle class since the Voting Rights Act of 1965. We can be even more effective in the political arena if we focus on pocketbook issues in the same way we focused on social issues in the '60s, '70s, and '80s. What I did not know when we started VNN was that it would be so successful. I was pleasantly surprised to learn that whites in Alabama warmly received our pitch to independent voters. So, we have 160,000 monthly readers to our service and we have only been on the web for a year. We have an active database that is very interested in our political news.

VNN will also spend $1 million during the 2002 election cycle on voter education and registration efforts, candidate endorsements and get-out-the-vote activities on Election Day in November. VNN does not accept money from candidates, political parties or their special interest group allies. We do not accept advertisements on the website or monthly printed edition. Candidates have to earn the support of Voter News Network by demonstrating a documented and meaningful record on pocketbook issues.

What would you do with the agenda of the black caucus if you had the chance?

I would diversify our political agenda. It is focused on the black underclass. We should expand our agenda so that it incorporates the interests of the black working and middle class. I do not hold that we abandon the underclass agenda; I hold that we should expand the agenda through diversification of economic interests. We have to focus on becoming producers of goods and services, and not just consumers of goods and services. We need to create jobs and award contracts at a much higher level than we are doing now.

What does acquiring a baseball team have to do with your overall philosophy?

The whole effort to acquire a team and own it represents an opportunity to break color barriers and create new economic empowerment opportunities. Plus, I have a personal passion for the sport. It is America's game. I get to satisfy a list of personal interests through one business transaction. If I had not pursued the wealth creation strategies we discussed earlier, I would not be in a position to buy a Major League Baseball team today.

HAVE WE GONE MAD?

REDEFINING INSANITY IN THE MODERN CRIMINAL JUSTICE SYSTEM

By Hans Alloff

On March 12, Andrea Pia Yates was found guilty of capital murder, by reason of not-insane-enough, for drowning her five children—four sons and a baby daughter—one by one, in a bathtub in their Houston home. She was convicted by a jury of eight women and four men. They needed just four hours to reach their verdict. It took them substantially less time—just about half an hour—to sentence Ms. Yates to life in prison.

In 1999, after her fourth son, named Luke was born, Andrea Yates was diagnosed with postpartum depression and psychosis. She had twice attempted suicide. She had previously been hospitalized and treated with anti-psychotic medicine. Ms. Yates explained her actions as only a mentally disturbed person would—Satan was coming after Noah, John, Paul, Luke, and baby Mary. Her parenting was powerless to help them. To save their lives, she ended them.

Under Texas law, however, and in most American states, whether Andrea Yates was sane or insane when she killed her children is not really what matters. What does matter is whether she knew it was wrong when she did it. And almost certainly, she did. It takes a while (certainly enough time to think hard about it) to fill a bathtub full of water to drown one's children in. So too, does it, to locate each of them, submerge them underneath for so long they die, and then, except for one left floating there, tuck them, side by side, into bed. Ms. Yates was alert and thoughtful enough to call 911, and her husband. Police would later testify to finding her in a calm and rational state when they arrived.

Should, however, only moral knowledge matter? Or should, more importantly, one's ability to act morally—in accordance with such knowledge—be taken into account? On precisely this question, psychiatrists, public health lawyers, and generally sympathetic people think Texas law is itself insane.

In a *Wall Street Journal* op-ed published on March 14, psychiatrist Sally Satel wrote, "In my opinion, [Yates] knew exactly what she was doing, but her purposeful actions were based on a deranged premise. Did she know it was wrong in this narrow sense? I suppose so, but this narrow legal sense is clinically and morally meaningless." What does it mean to be insane? To not know right from wrong? Or to know, but not be able to help yourself? Satel's answer is clear: "The jury's directive – to discern whether Yates knew killing her children was wrong – applies a mistaken conceptual framework to the mindset of a psychotic." To buffer her argument with another case, Satel cited Russell Weston, a high-profile mentally ill individual who shot two U.S. Capitol guards in 1998 en route to dismantling a time-controlling satellite he believed was housed there. Like Yates, Satel wrote, Weston's "actions flowed logically from his beliefs, but those beliefs were unhinged."

Andrea Yates is not merely Sally Satel's cause. A day before her piece ran, Jennifer Bard, a University of Texas professor of medicine, put forth an identical argument in a *New York Times* op-ed: "[Yates's plea of not-guilty by reason of insanity would have been highly persuasive if the standard were her ability to conform her conduct to the law. By the prevailing legal standards, however, how she felt and her ability to control her behavior could not be taken into account."

In opposition here are two conceptions of legal and moral culpability for Andrea Yates (and presumably others like her). One, embodied in Texas law, is knowledge-based. Another, argued for by Satel and Bard, is will-based. Only one, I would argue, is compatible with widely shared notions of moral responsibility and justice.

There is a rough parallel between these rival conceptions of culpability and two rival conceptions of human freedom—negative and positive liberty—as defined by Isaiah Berlin in his celebrated lecture "Two Concepts of Liberty." It might be instructive, instead of asking ourselves whether Andrea Yates was sane (or insane) when she drowned her five children, to wonder whether she was free (or not) to do what she did. It is not a silly exercise in thought. It is in fact how Charles Krauthammer, another medical professional who is sympathetic toward Andrea Yates, thought his way through her case. Wrote Krauthammer in his syndicated

Washington Post column, "Öto be guilty, one needs to have free will. How free is the will of someone who is seriously psychotic?" Answer his question: How *free* was Andrea Yates?

Was she forced to kill her children, or restrained from not killing them? No, she was neither. Rather, in a sphere of non-interference—as a mother, home with her children—she acted deliberately and as she pleased. If by "free" we mean close to what Isaiah Berlin meant by negative liberty—freedom from coercion or external compulsion of any kind—she ought to be held accountable for her actions. Was Andrea Yates, however, her own master? Was she, quoting Berlin on positive liberty, "moved by conscious purposes which [were her] own" and not by "causes which affected [her] from outside"? It is a lot less clear. Yates was not self-directed; killing her children was never a goal she conceived for herself in a state of detached and clear thought, and later, in a similar state, realized. Surely her delusions and psychosis qualify as causes extraneous to her true consciousness.

By one understanding of human freedom, then, Andrea Yates was free to kill (or not kill) her children, and by another she was a lot less so. So too with those conflicting standards of non-insanity—moral knowledge (embodied in Texas law) and moral will (advocated by Satel et al.)—one yields a conviction, another an acquittal.

There is a severe problem, however, with a positive liberty/moral will perspective on human action. A calculus of culpability by which these factors determine guilt risks pardoning for their moral transgressions anyone who, whether sane or not, just could not help themselves. If unless one is his own master, in complete and conscious control of his life, he is not "free" and therefore exempt from punishment for wrongdoing, then morality and moral responsibility are meaningless ideas. Indeed, true self-mastery, by definition, implies an inability to do wrong; a world of self-masters would be a wrong-less world anyway. A framework of human action wherein one either commits no wrongs because he is attained a certain level of self-mastery, or commits wrongs but is not held accountable for them because he is not yet reached such a level, does not logically allow for punishing people who act up.

Besides, one need not be insane to know right from wrong but lack self control. A moral transgression, by definition, is an act its agent is almost unable to help himself from committing. What to do, then, about Osama bin Laden, who believes in his heart of hearts it is his religious duty—indeed, his life's purpose—to slaughter infidels in Allah's name? What better example, Dr. Satel, of ill action proceeding necessarily and logically from "unhinged" beliefs? What about devout, devout Catholics who murder abortion doctors? What about animal rights activists and so-called "eco-terrorists" who trespass into, and then destroy, private property in pursuit of a supremely just social goal? I pose this question on down, albeit to a lesser extent, to wives who murder their husbands to collect on life-insurance money they desperately need. *Reductio*, are not most criminals insane? *Ad Absurdum*, are not most people insane, insofar as they are claimed by, and then logically and necessarily commanded by, principles of right and justice and good they hold to be transcendentally true?

If mental illness, as Yates's defense attorney argued, "is still not understood and still not appreciated" in Texas and elsewhere, then neither are religious devotion, allegiance to principle, moral belief, and just plain perversion, hatred, and anger.

If mental illness, as Yates's defense attorney argued, "is still not understood and still not appreciated" in Texas and elsewhere, then neither are religious devotion, allegiance to principle, moral belief, and just plain perversion, hatred, and anger. All, once real and understood, are not so different from psychosis and depression insofar as they motivate action in a logical manner. In what relevant way, after all, is Allah not bin Laden's delusion? If bin Laden is an unsatisfactory example, consider Tim McVeigh. Conversations conducted with McVeigh and those who knew him revealed how deeply held moral beliefs left him with no other option. He had to wage war against his government.

There are differences, to be sure, and most certainly with bin Laden. He is happily and consciously a Muslim. He embraces his ideology. His problem, in our eyes, is less one of not knowing right from wrong and more one of thinking right what we think wrong (and vice versa). Andrea Yates, by contrast, is unhappily a psychotic. Because in killing her children she departed from her typical self; she would never defend her actions as proper. Fi-

nally, in her case, unlike bin Laden's, a biochemical condition, reversible through medical treatment, caused her to commit a crime. McVeigh seems to lie somewhere in between. He was displeased to wreak havoc on Oklahoma City. He knew it was wrong. But how else to get his message across? Allow bin Laden Allah, allow Timothy McVeigh his anger, allow a radical environmentalist his Green vision, and they are not entirely self-directed. On a positive conception of freedom, they are not entirely free. On a moral will based understanding of sanity, they are not sane, and they are not guilty.

Perhaps Satel's and Bard's argument is not as invalid as it is incomplete. An inability to do what is right—or not do what is wrong—is alone too thin a standard of insanity. What is relevant is not *whether* a moral agent who knows right from wrong can act morally, but *why* he or she is unable to. Satel et al, to prevent against such slippage as I worry about, must stipulate and differentiate legitimate reasons from illegitimate ones in a principled fashion.

Andrea Yates is not a cold-blooded murderer. There are moral gradients of guilt even when legally no distinctions are made. She is clearly less guilty (and less repulsive) than a serial killer would be for doing exactly what she did, just because he felt like doing it. Still, American law is shot through with imperviousness to subtlety. Suppose I run a stop sign and drive straight through an intersection pushing sixty, only because my eyes and mind are elsewhere than straight ahead. Further suppose no other car is passing through this intersection, nor is there a bicyclist, nor is there a young boy chasing after a soccer ball. What happens? Nothing happens. Now suppose an hour later an equally careless driver speeds through this same stop sign, when another car is passing by, as is a bicyclist, as is a boy retrieving his ball. What happens? He is charged with several accounts of involuntary vehicular manslaughter. What differentiates us? Pure luck. Pure luck—perhaps average emergency medical care versus expert care—also differentiates those charged with first degree murder from those charged with attempted first degree murder.

Whether Americans are cognizant of this fact or not, their penal code routinely ignores relevant moral distinctions between cases. No two crimes are entirely alike, and no two criminals are equally evil. They are nonetheless prosecuted in identical fashion. Perhaps to justify punishing one mother, who unquestionably deserves it, for killing her children, we must be willing to punish all mothers who do so, sane or not.

Penal laws exempting insane defendants from real punishment, seemingly so right and fair, are less so once subjected to thoughtful scrutiny. Is it really unjust for Andrea Yates to spend her remaining years in jail, even though she committed her crime while in a deranged mental state? Otherwise put, is it truly just for a sane person to suffer and a less sane person not to suffer, though they committed identical crimes? Does this not complicate cherished notions of political and legal equality? Can we write exceptions to laws into law and maintain a consistent, coherent system of justice? To ask such questions is to begin to answer them.

AFP / STEVE UECKERT

Andrea Yates is not a cold-blooded murderer. There are moral gradients of guilt even when legally no distinctions are made.

Hans Alloff is a research assistant at the American Enterprise Institute for public policy research. He graduated from Brown University in May 2000 with a degree in political science.

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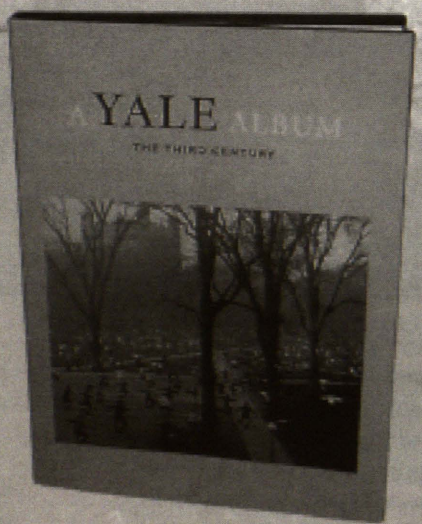

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INFOTAINMENT

THE DECLINE OF NETWORK NEWS

By Matthew Bloom

In the immediate aftermath of the September 11 attacks, Americans unabashedly turned to network news coverage seeking reasons behind the assaults and an allayment of their fears. The nation subsequently found in TV and in print media a source of not only information, but also of consolation. For a transitory time span of about a week, news anchors were for many a requisite component of the healing process. As was necessary, the media relinquished their scorekeeper role that is so often critical of the motives of government officials, and they helped the nation join together and become unified in grief and then in purpose.

AFP PHOTO

As the mood of the nation changed, though, a transition brought forth by George W. Bush's September 20 address to Congress, the media personalities that have been continually criticized as being unable to focus on hard news returned to the type of coverage reminiscent of the ratings-driven shows that in general characterized pre-September 11 broadcasts. "On September 11, America changed forever, but in the heart of TV talkland it's still September 10," said Michael Massing of the Columbia Journalism Review.

The adept foreign correspondents that have been prominent during other international crises like the Cold War were absent. The lackluster international news coverage that followed one of the most pivotal crises on American soil uncovered more than a decade of lapses in the international news industry. Due mainly to economics and corporate interests, these lapses have left international bureaus depleted and the American people ignorant of the world at a time when globalization obliges this very cognition. What, then, has led to this decay of serious, informative news broadcasts, and what can be done to reverse the trend?

TV news until the early 1970s had garnered prestige due to its reputation for seriousness. The broadcasts were characterized by a nonprofit existence and were subsidized by other, non-news programs. They were not expected to make money and were not concerned with ratings. They were thus free to follow the very stringent ethics of journalism, to carry out the gatekeeper role and to choose news free from influence by advertisers and investors. The TV news was the authority, and the public tuned in for hard news. Recently, the percentage of Americans who regularly watch the news has shrunk dramatically. According to Thomas Patterson of the Joan Shorenstein Center on the Press, Politics, and Public Policy at Harvard, from 1993 to 2000 those Americans who described themselves as "regularly watching the nightly network news" shrunk from 61 percent to 30 percent.

This downward trend has its roots in the end of the Cold War era. Many have cited the direct effects of 60 Minutes for this trend because it helped make entertaining soft news more popular and profitable than network news. According to *Atlantic Monthly* editor James Fallows, "60 Minutes changed TV journalism for one simple reason: it made money." CBS realized with this show that a news show could be both entertaining and earn more money than it spent. The formula for 60 Minutes quickly moved away from substantive stories concerning economics, the real workings of politics, or long-term issues of national or international significance, focusing instead on celebrity profiles and petty scandals.

Different developments pertaining to the economics of the late 1980s and early '90s, as well as the introduction of new competition to the major networks, such as 24-hour cable news and internet news sites, expedited the downsizing of the international bureaus of the major news networks and the subrogation of "soft" news in nightly broadcasts. First, economics is attributable as perhaps the causation with the biggest impact on international news. A trend toward going public put most of the biggest news companies into shareholder's hands. Then, in the mid-80s, each of the three network news operations went through a corporate takeover: CBS by Lawrence Tisch, NBC by General Electric, and ABC by Capital Cities and later by Disney. These corporate takeovers came in 1985 and 1986 when investing in the media seemed most promising as a business venture, as between 1976 and 1984 the networks' profits had increased 324 percent. "The eighties were a time when any remaining illusions about journalism as an enterprise different from other businesses were finally put to rest," according to Karen Rothmeyer of the Columbia Journal-

The only solution to stopping the prosperity of soft news and blathering talking heads focused only on ratings is a return to steadfast journalistic ethics independent of the need for profit. Corporate networks need to realize that newscasts are not meant to be profitable, but rather exist for public information and education.

ism Review. A recession soon followed the purchases and the media owners were hit hard. With the need to cut costs to satisfy investors, the first to go were the international bureaus, as it can cost in excess of $100,000 to keep a correspondent abroad for a year. The focus groups of advertisers, serendipitously to the owners, recommended increased local coverage. The trend was moved away from foreign reporting toward less costly and more profitable local news and human-interest stories, such as those that were profitable for 60 Minutes.

Besides the economics of the situation, one must consider the trends in the viewer's demands for serious broadcast journalism. The heyday of nightly news was during the Cold War. The subsequent downfall in this type of news coverage began as the Cold War ended. Is it then feasible that heightened public interest in meaningful foreign policies during this era was the anomaly and that the American public is actually isolationist in nature? In essence, why do we need foreign correspondences in the news? People find security in information.

According to Fallows, a life-long journalist, the news is necessary to put events in perspective and to give them a place in time. If these are two of the public's main uses of news, then the point at which TV journalism broke from public necessity is manifest. At the time of the September 11 attacks, the news was utterly out of perspective. The amount of air time given to a story and its position in the nightly broadcast denote its importance, and some of the most covered stories as of late have been scandals such as those pertaining to Monica Lewinsky and Gary Condit. Even the shows that are devoted to dealing with matters of policy and politics, such as the McLaughlin Group on NBC and the Capitol Gang on CNN, can be characterized more by partisan bickering than by substantial policy analysis.

Broadcasts also failed and are failing to give news stories a place in time, specifically the coverage of the September 11 bombings. It is this failure that is most troubling. News stories develop over time, and when they emerge in the headlines, teams should be able to provide the historical perspective necessary to understand the situation. However, they were unprepared, apparently victimized by a decade of cost-cutting in international bureaus. For example, in his September 20 address to Congress, President Bush's commitment to overthrowing the entire Taliban government raised some pressing questions. No post-speech commentator thought to examine these questions, though. "Alas," cried Massing, "they seemed interested only in one thing: Bush's performance. As for what to do about the Taliban, Afghanistan and the broader Islamic world, no one bothered to ask."

Even with the recent trends away from in-depth foreign news analysis, there are a few exceptions to these trends. A handful of shows have done a good job focusing viewers on pertinent information that is free from ratings-driven "soft" news and partisan squabbling. Jim Lehrer truly attempts to grapple with the overriding political questions on The NewsHour with Jim Lehrer. Nevertheless, the vast majority of news coverage at all times except in crises has been irrelevant to the domestic and international issues that are most important. "O.J. Simpson's trial one year, Lady Diana's death the next, the White House sex scandal the next," says Jonathan Randall of the Shorenstein School, "insinuate their way into what purports to be the most serious journalism in a media illustration of Gresham's Law, leaving little room for foreign news."

If bad journalism drives out good journalism as Gresham's Law would suggest, then the only solution to stopping the prosperity of soft news and blathering talking heads focused only on ratings is a return to steadfast journalistic ethics independent of the need for profit. Corporate networks need to realize that newscasts are not meant to be profitable, but rather exist for public information and education.

The problem, of course, lies in the fact that there are new methods, such as 24-hour cable news networks and the Internet, for obtaining the news faster than waiting for nightly news broadcasts. The major networks, though, still hold a tenuous, albeit fleeting, image in the public's mind as beacons of authority.

Their only hope, then, may be in seizing on this authority to return to serious broadcasting while offering close analysis of domestic and international "hard" news stories. So long as these corporations are publicly traded, though, ratings will continue to be foremost in the minds of executives and the decay of informative news broadcasts will continue.

Matthew Bloom is a freshman in Calhoun College and features editor of The Politic.

GEORGE W. BUSH

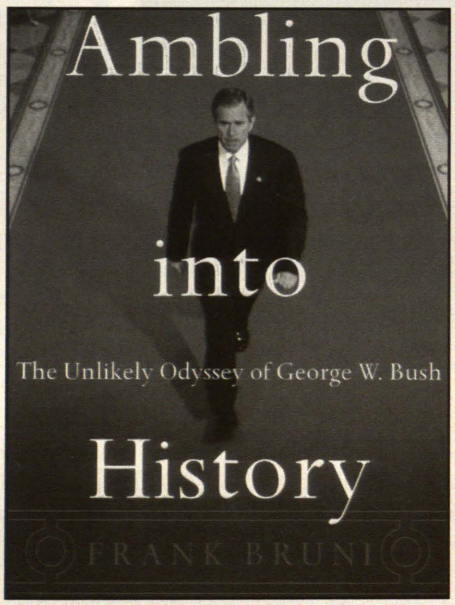
BEYOND THE CARICATURE

By Robert Wilkins

Ambling Into History: The Unlikely Odyssey of George W. Bush

by Frank Bruni
Hardcover, 288 pages
HarperCollins
$23.95

Throughout his campaign and early months as President, many questioned whether George W. Bush had the leadership capabilities or drive to be an effective Commander–in–Chief. Bush was seen as a man, who only recently developed presidential ambitions, and seemed uncomfortable in large, public venues. His mangled sentences and frequent speaking blunders led many to doubt his intellect. But was this an accurate and complete description of our 43rd President?



In *Ambling Into History*, Frank Bruni, a *New York Times* correspondent who covered the Bush campaign and presidency, presents a side of Bush readers have never encountered. The author documents Bush's often–parodied audible mishaps, while also acknowledging that Bush frequently surprised him with "flashes of cleverness."

Bruni extracts larger truths from the President's demeanor and mannerisms. He prefers not to focus on Bush's ideology, but instead analyzes the "small moments" that highlight the "offbeat character that flickered through the frippery and the pomp." He argues that Bush has evolved over time and has become able to adapt to his surroundings, to learn to stay within himself, and to develop a balance between who he wanted to be and who he was called to be.

The author depicts a man constantly grappling with his West Texas attitude and his political ambitions. He writes that Bush "caromed between who he needed to be and who he was, between the lofty duties and trappings of where he was going and where he had been, sometimes rejecting one or the other, forever seeking a tenable middle ground between the two." The author also presents a much–overlooked examination of Bush's deep religious spirituality and gives examples of how this faith permeates his daily life. Quoting an unnamed source close to the President, Bruni shows the significance of the 9/11 attacks: "Bush had come to believe that his action from September 11 on would define not only his presidency but, really, his time on earth." What emerged, Bruni argues, is a more committed and mature man—in short, more presidential.

Bruni also examines the people closest to Bush – portraying Karen Hughes as his most ardent fan and fiercest defender, Dick Cheney as one of the most loyal friends to the Bush family, and Laura Bush as an over–arching motherly presence for all to embrace. Emphasizing the people around Bush, Bruni cites the President's wife: "he chose people to accompany him through his life and career that invariably made him better and set him straight." He extends this analysis to the places most dear to the President: Camp David, his West Texas Ranch and the family home in Kennebunkport. Connecting his small interactions with Bush, Bruni displays a cohesive and intriguing account of the President. In the end, we are left with a description of both a fraternity boy simply having a good time and a nimble, instinctive politician who knows his limits and is finally coming into his own. Among all of the books currently available on the 43rd President, *Ambling Into History* is the best behind–the–scenes look of a man who has been hard to define and predict.

Finally, Bruni skillfully takes the reader through the chaotic and tiring life of a journalist covering a presidential race. Criticizing his own profession more often than not, he reveals in detail how reporters often do not think for themselves and skim over the substantive material in favor of more sensational stories. He chastises the "superficiality" of not only modern American politics, but the media as well. Bruni confesses that he is also at fault for dwelling on the entertaining and eye–catching items rather than on the issues of actual relevance. Remarking on journalists' ability to influence a political race, Bruni writes, "we were, in essence, covering ourselves."

Ambling Into History is an eloquent, objective and in–depth account that shows why *Newsweek* called Bruni "probably the most influential reporter on the Bush beat."

Robert Wilkins is a junior in Berkeley College at Yale and managing editor of The Politic.

STANDING ALONE

CAN AMERICA BECOME A RESPONSIBLE INTERNATIONAL CITIZEN?

In the still nascent 21st century, the question of the position of the United States with respect to its position as a world leader has been of central importance. In the modern global world, in which countries are increasingly interconnected, the United States still remains the de facto hegemonic power. However, history has shown that every dominant nation will eventually decline from power. Therefore, it is essential to find direction for the road ahead, reassessing the role of America in the global arena. The theory of regression proposes that over time the exception will recede to the mean. Thus, the question confronting the United States today is whether it will suffer the same fate as that of previously powerful nations.

ALYSON SUDOW

September 11 made Americans acutely aware of the resentment and anger, which parts of the world feel towards the United States. This frustration that has taken the form of anti-American demonstrations, flag burnings, and a pervading hostility towards American interests, however, is not a new phenomenon.

We often view ourselves as the "world's policeman," a qausi-big brother figure, who altruistically acts to aid struggling nations. However, this "aid" has often propped up dictatorial regimes and promoted militant factions that have little respect for democracy and the rule of law. The cumulative effect of this support and intervention has fed an animosity that now poses a threat to American security. As a result, the influence of the United States to forge coalitions and steer policy towards our interests has declined precipitously.

US foreign policy has for too long promoted the American way as the only way. The success of the American system has convinced us that adoption of American culture, democracy and morality is the only blueprint for success for struggling nations. The failure of American policy experts to understand that there is not just one model for development has played a significant role in weakening the American position abroad.

American style democracy, while an attractive model, is not a viable system in many countries. Geographic, cultural and ideological distinctions often complicate the ability to adopt American practice. In fact, these institutions often hinder the development that they were designed to achieve. This inability of previous world superpowers to understand the limitations of their societal constructions and context became the tragic flaw that contributed immeasurably to their downfall

In a modern, integrated world where boundaries between nations seem increasingly less defined, it is important that we address the causes that have fermented a resentment of the United States. If we do not, however, the 21st century will witness a decline in the international influence and prestige of the United States. In order to remain a leader in the modern world, it is important that America participates as a constructive voice in the world forum. By becoming a positive force in the United Nations, International Monetary Fund, World Trade Organization and other multi-national institutions, the United States can play an integral role in shaping the international world order without breeding the resentment that unilateral intervention often produces. In the transition period, many will still look to the United States as the only formidable mediating power. By moving toward a more pluralistic worldview, America can restore its position as a guiding force in global policy.

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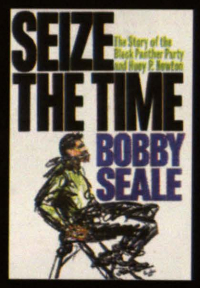

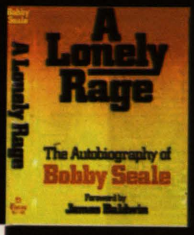

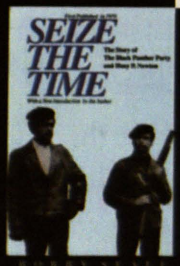

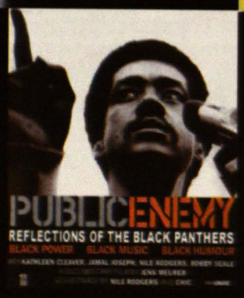

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